

CHESS99 BOOK 2 | ELO 300-700 | FREE

Survival Chess

Checks, captures, threats, loose pieces, safe kings, and the habits that stop beginner losses.

Contents

1. The Three Questions: Checks, Captures, Threats 24 min
2. What Is A Hanging Piece? 24 min
3. One-Move Attacks And One-Move Defenses 25 min
4. Safe Squares For The King 25 min
5. Capturing Wisely: Good Trades And Bad Trades 26 min
6. Basic Checkmates With Queen And Rook 28 min
7. Avoiding Stalemate 26 min
8. Opening Safety: Stop Moving The Same Piece 24 min
9. Blunder-Check Before Every Move 24 min
10. Ten Survival Games: Find The Safe Move 30 min

The Three Questions: Checks, Captures, Threats

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Build the CCT scan that protects every move.

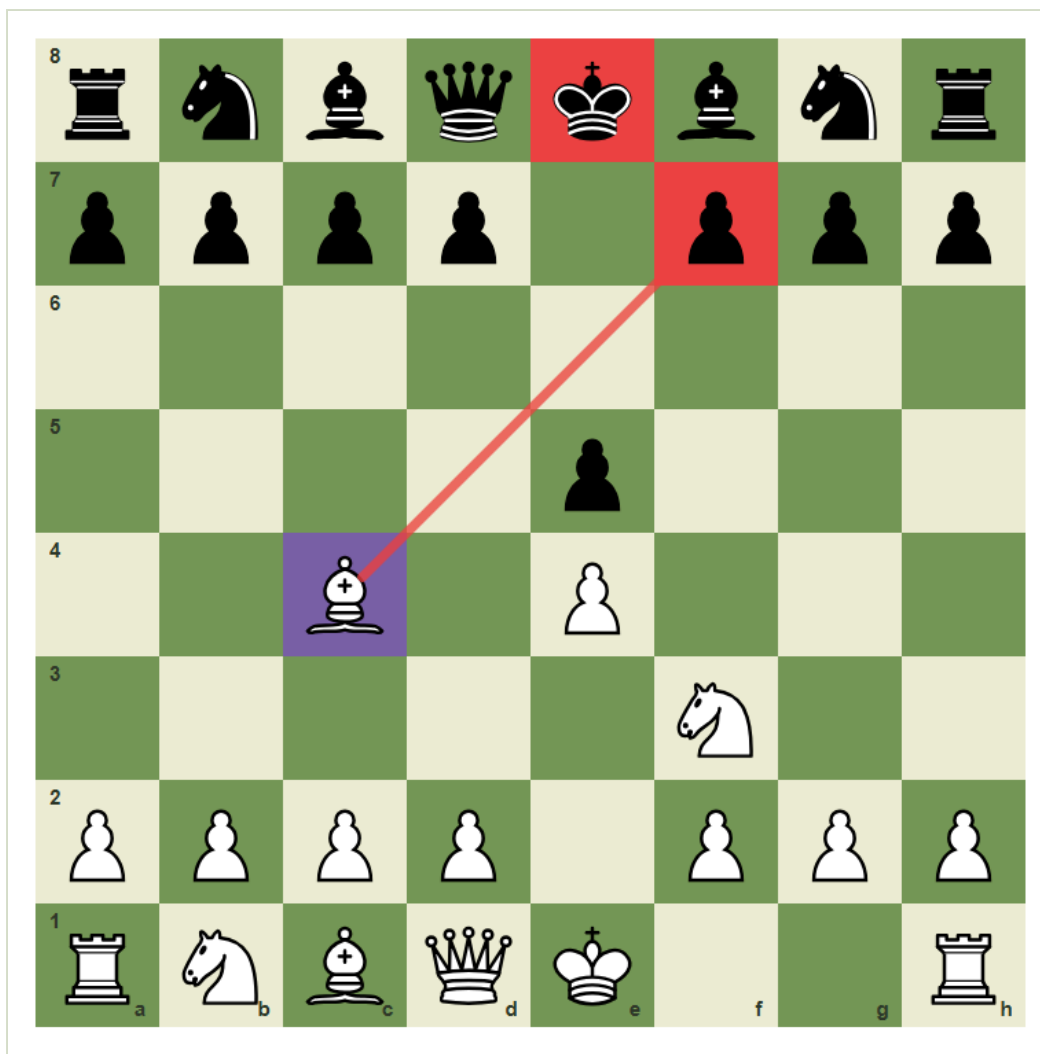
Learning objectives

- Scan checks before attractive captures.
- Spot free captures and direct threats.
- Use one checklist before choosing a move.

The Scan Comes First

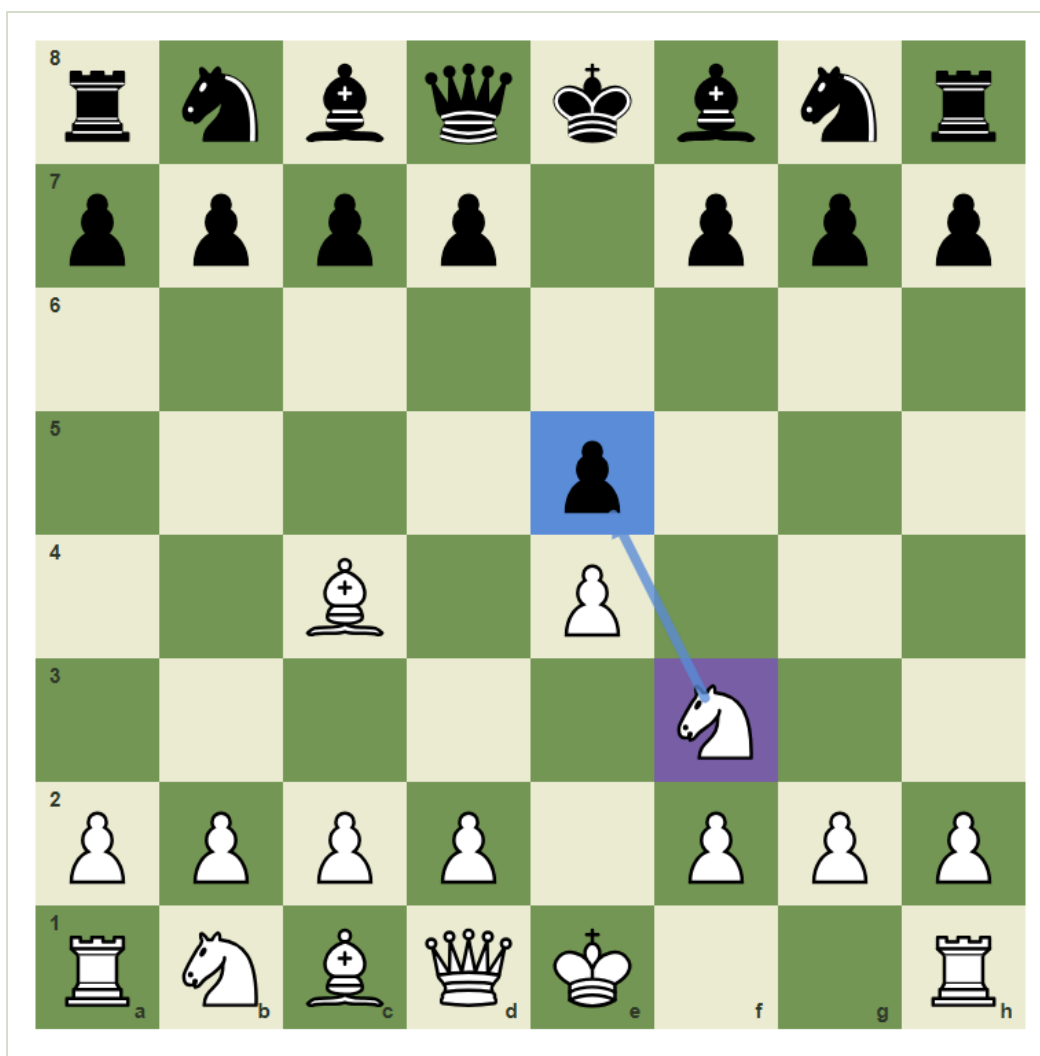
Survival chess begins before you touch a piece. Ask three questions in order: **What checks exist?** **What captures exist?** **What threats exist?** This habit stops many beginner losses immediately.

Check candidate on f7



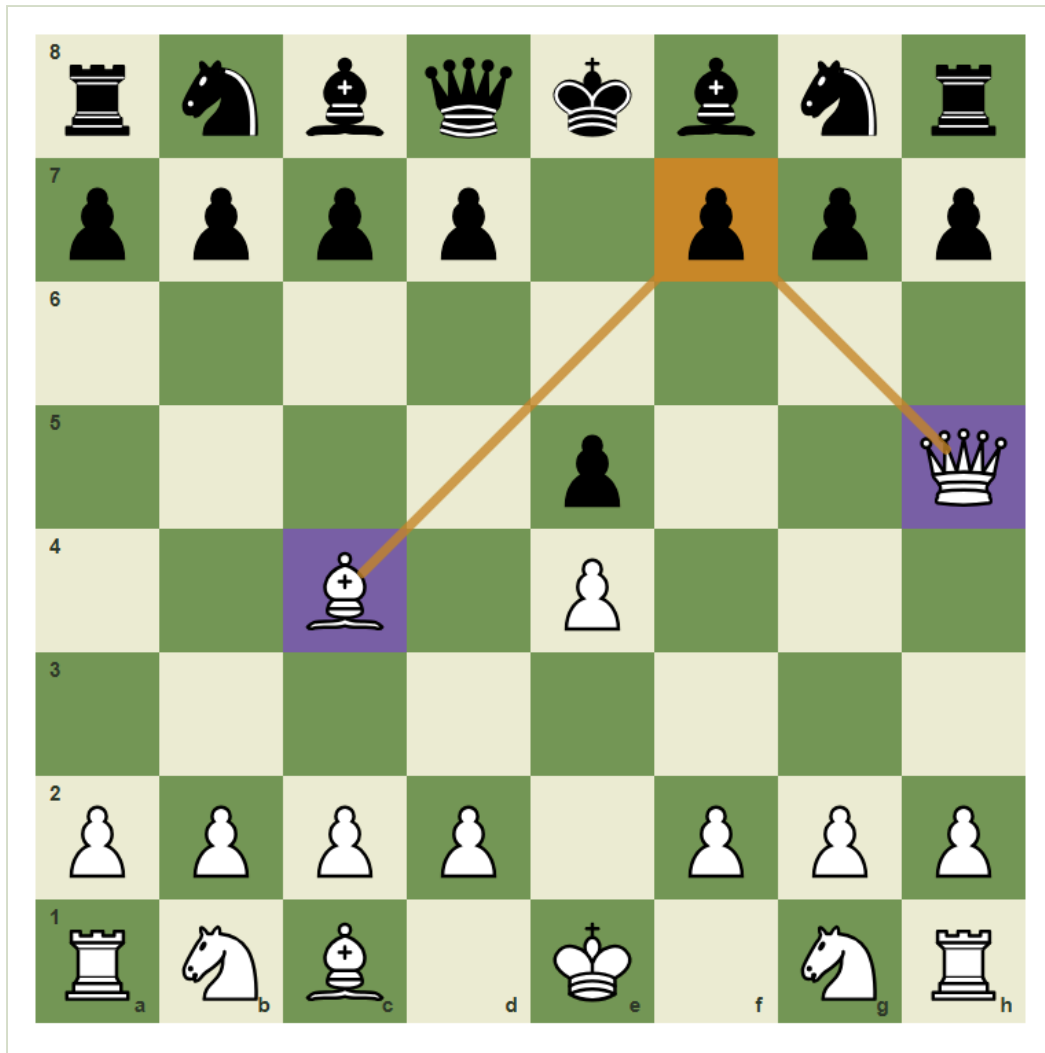
The bishop can check on f7. Checks must be seen before quieter moves.

Capture candidate on e5



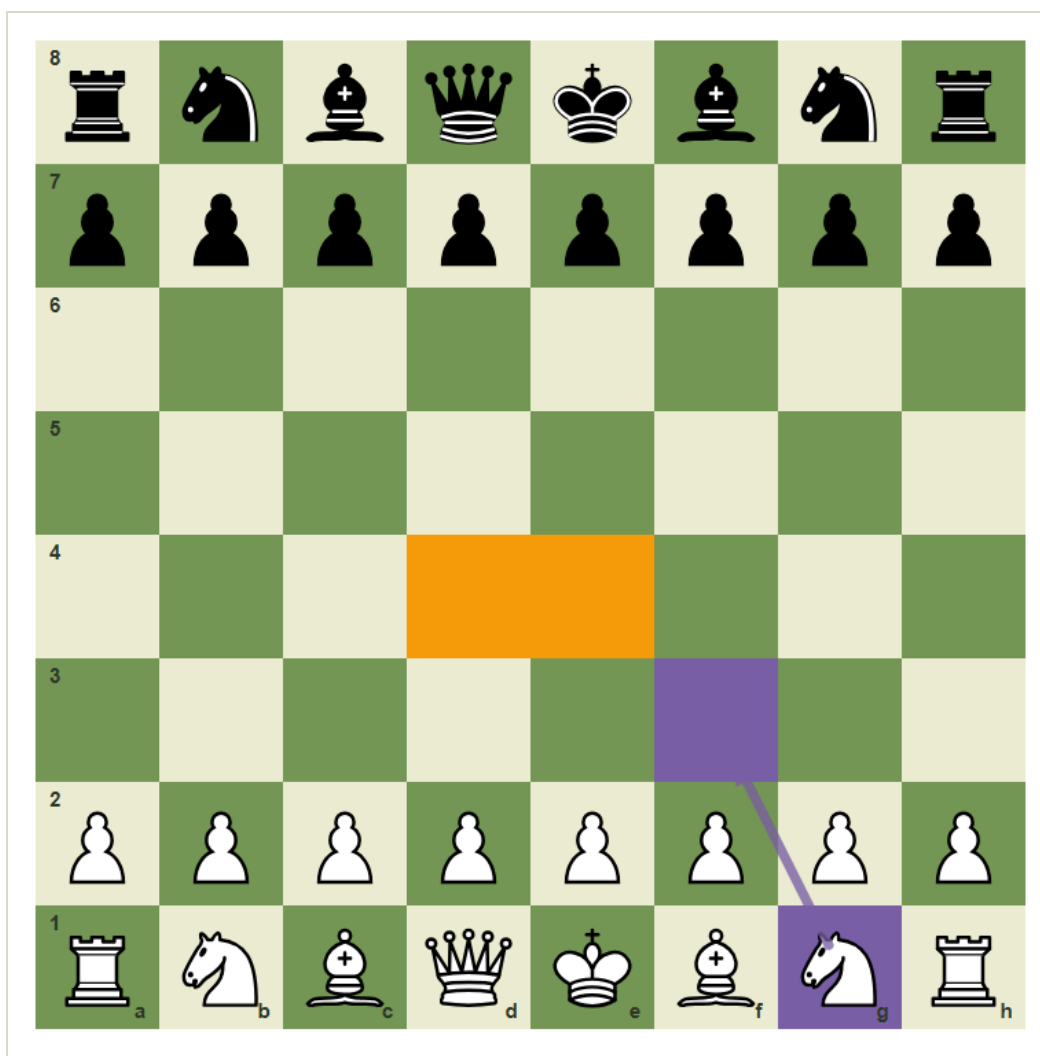
The knight also sees e5, but a capture is checked after checks.

Threat target on f7



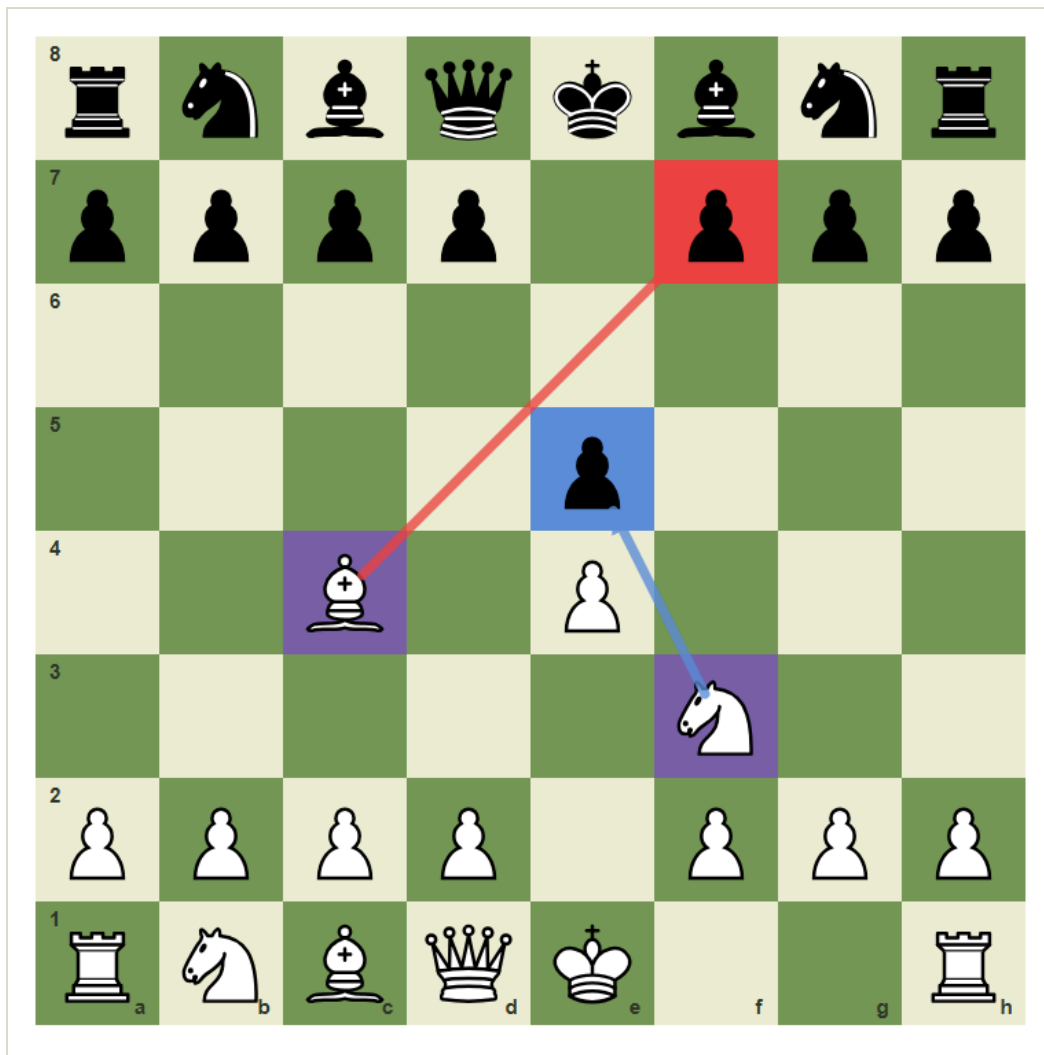
Queen and bishop both point at f7. That is a threat map.

A quiet start still needs a scan



Even the first move should be chosen after seeing the center and development squares.

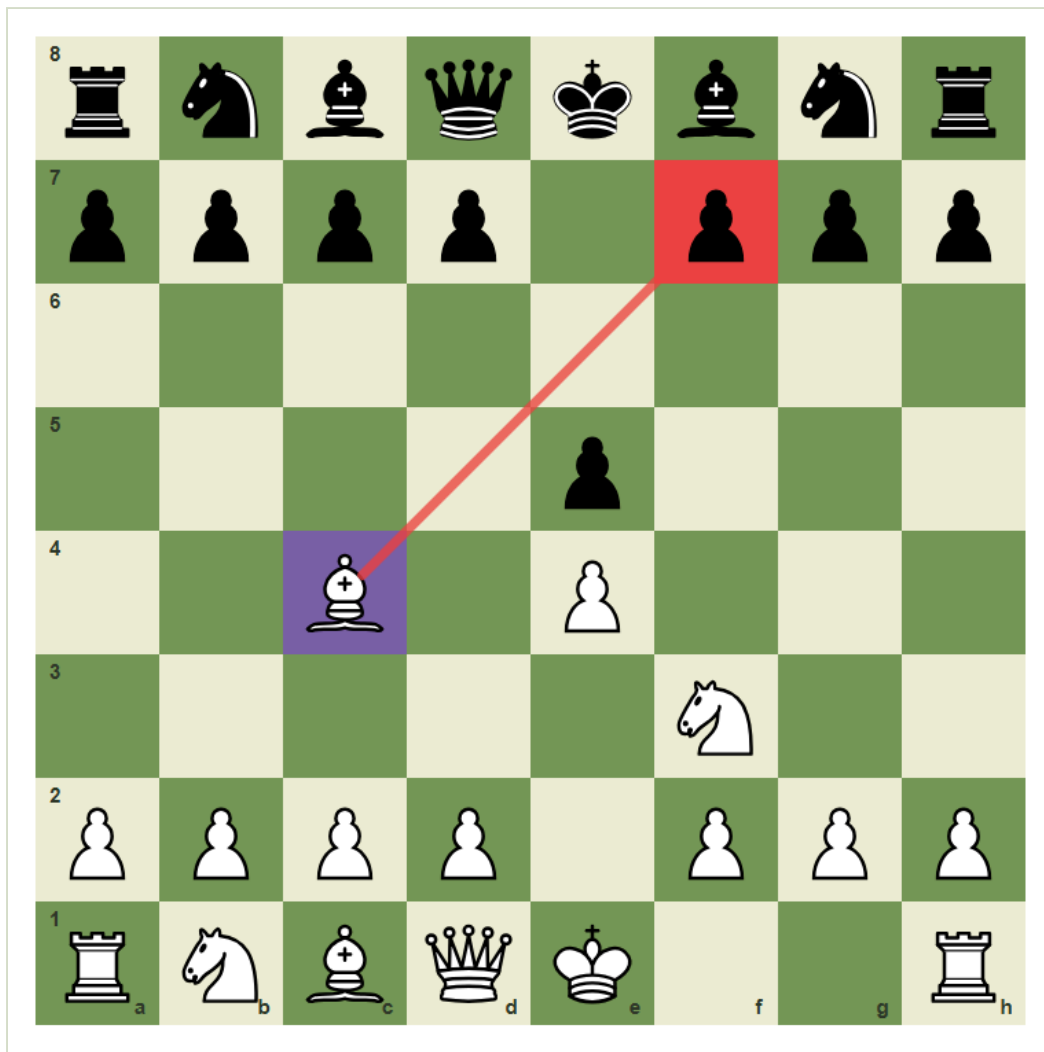
Rank the forcing moves



The scan finds both c4-f7 and f3-e5. The check has priority.

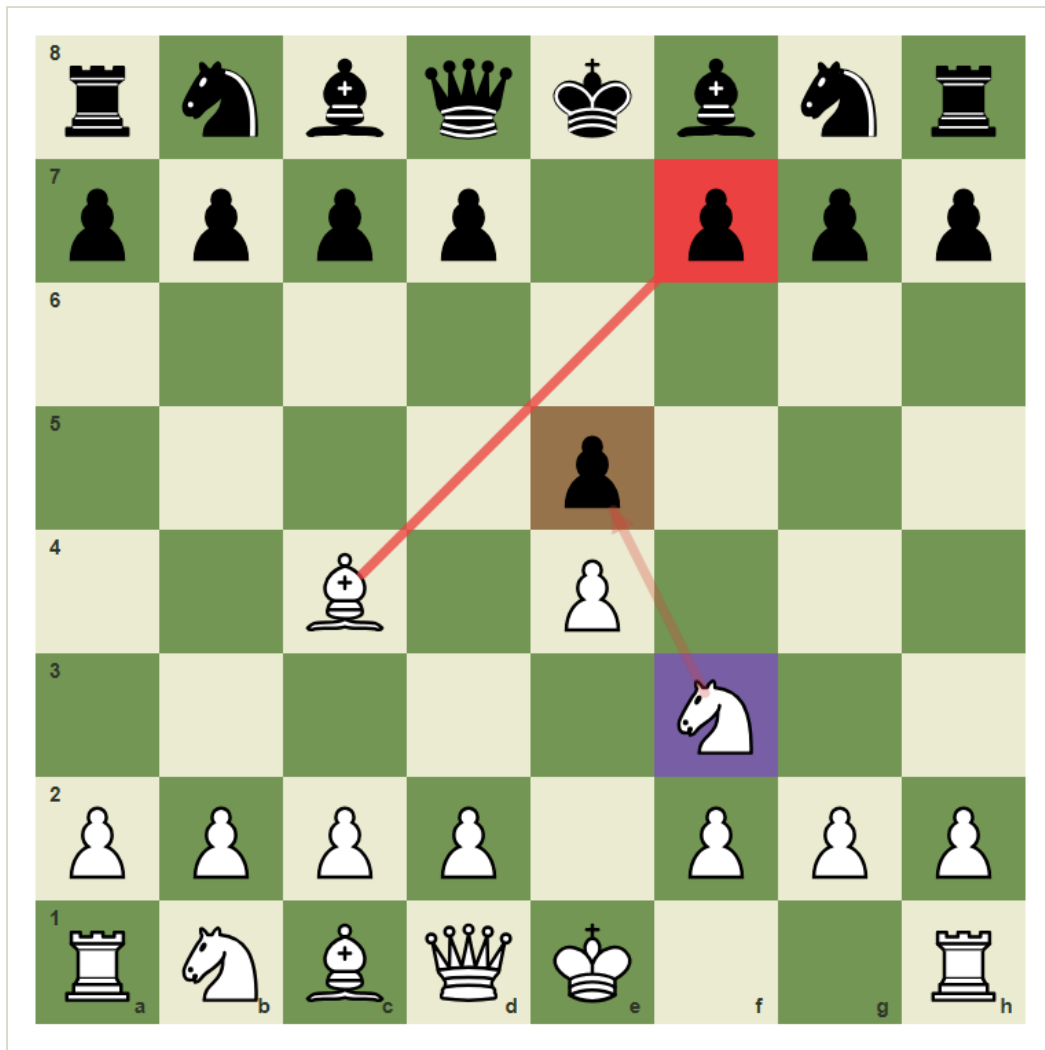
Play the forcing check

Use the CCT order and play the checking move from c4 to f7.



Common mistake: capture before checking

The natural capture on e5 may be playable, but beginners should train the scan order. Checks first, then captures, then threats.



The wrong order starts with f3-e5 while the forcing check on f7 waits.

Chapter Checkpoint

Which question comes first in the survival scan?

Which question comes first in the survival scan?

- a. Captures
- b. Checks
- c. Threats

A move that attacks the king is called a:

A move that attacks the king is called a:

- a. Check
- b. Trade
- c. Castle

After checks and captures, what do you scan?

After checks and captures, what do you scan?

- a. Threats
- b. Piece names
- c. Clock color

What Is A Hanging Piece?

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Stop giving pieces away for free.

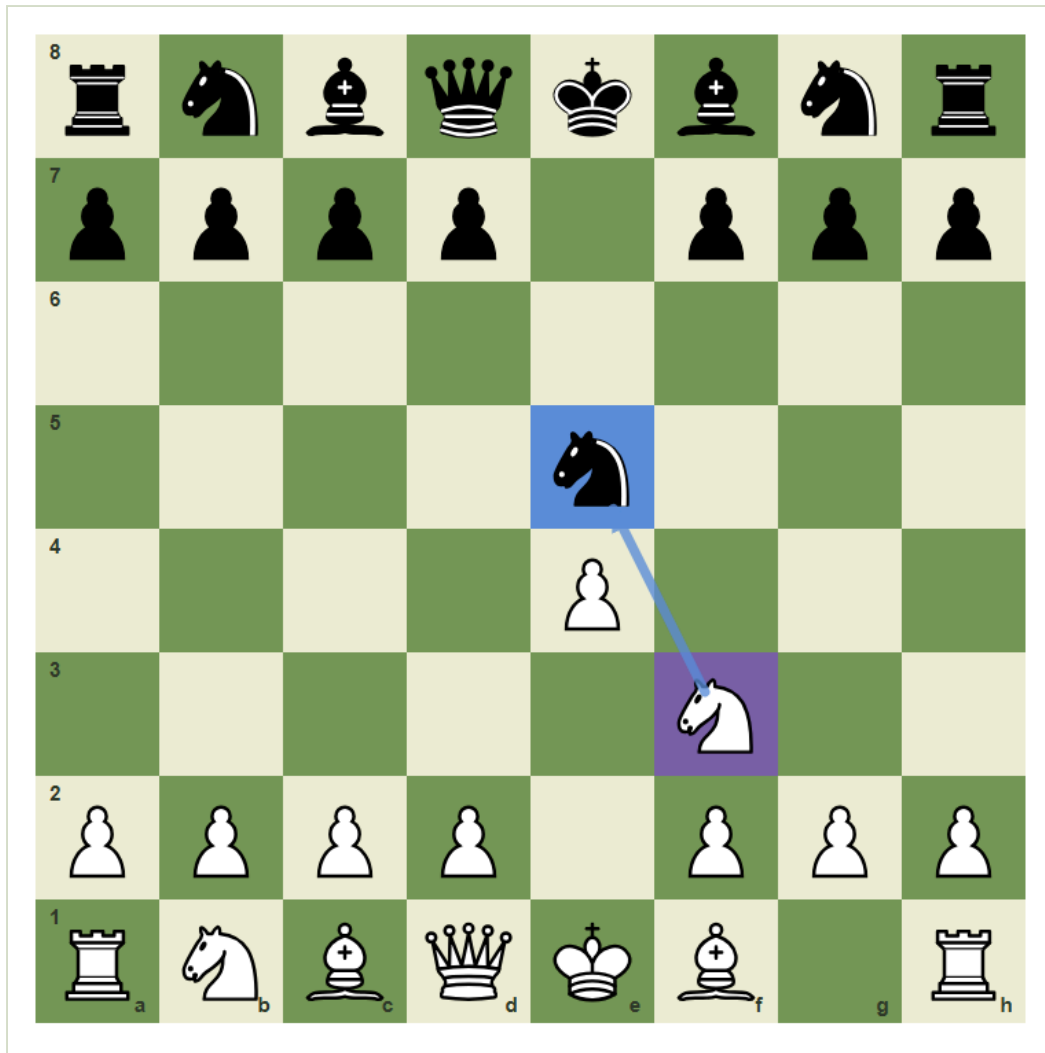
Learning objectives

- Define a hanging piece.
- Count whether a target is defended.
- Capture loose material without rushing.

Loose Pieces Fall

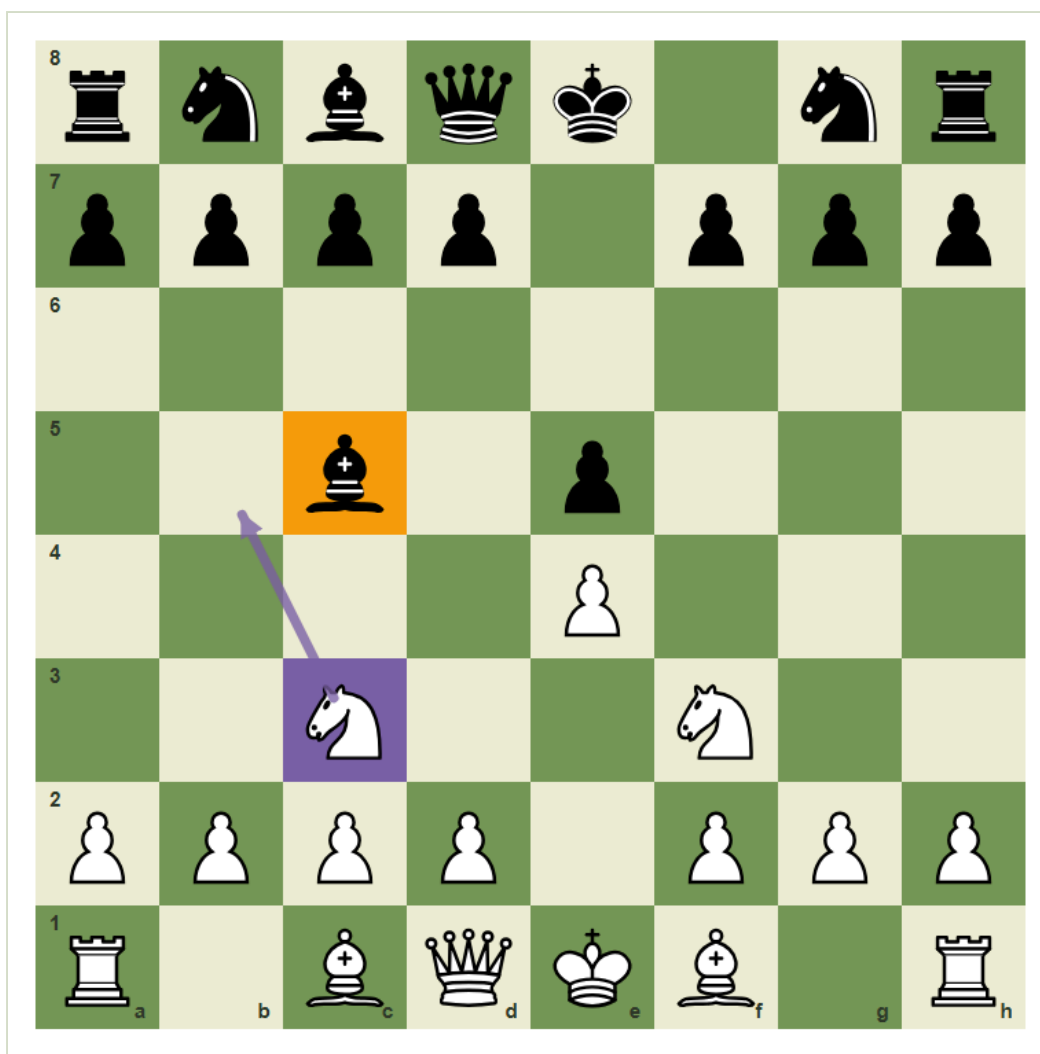
A hanging piece is attacked and not safely defended. At beginner level, many games are decided by one loose knight, bishop, rook, or queen.

The knight on e5 is loose



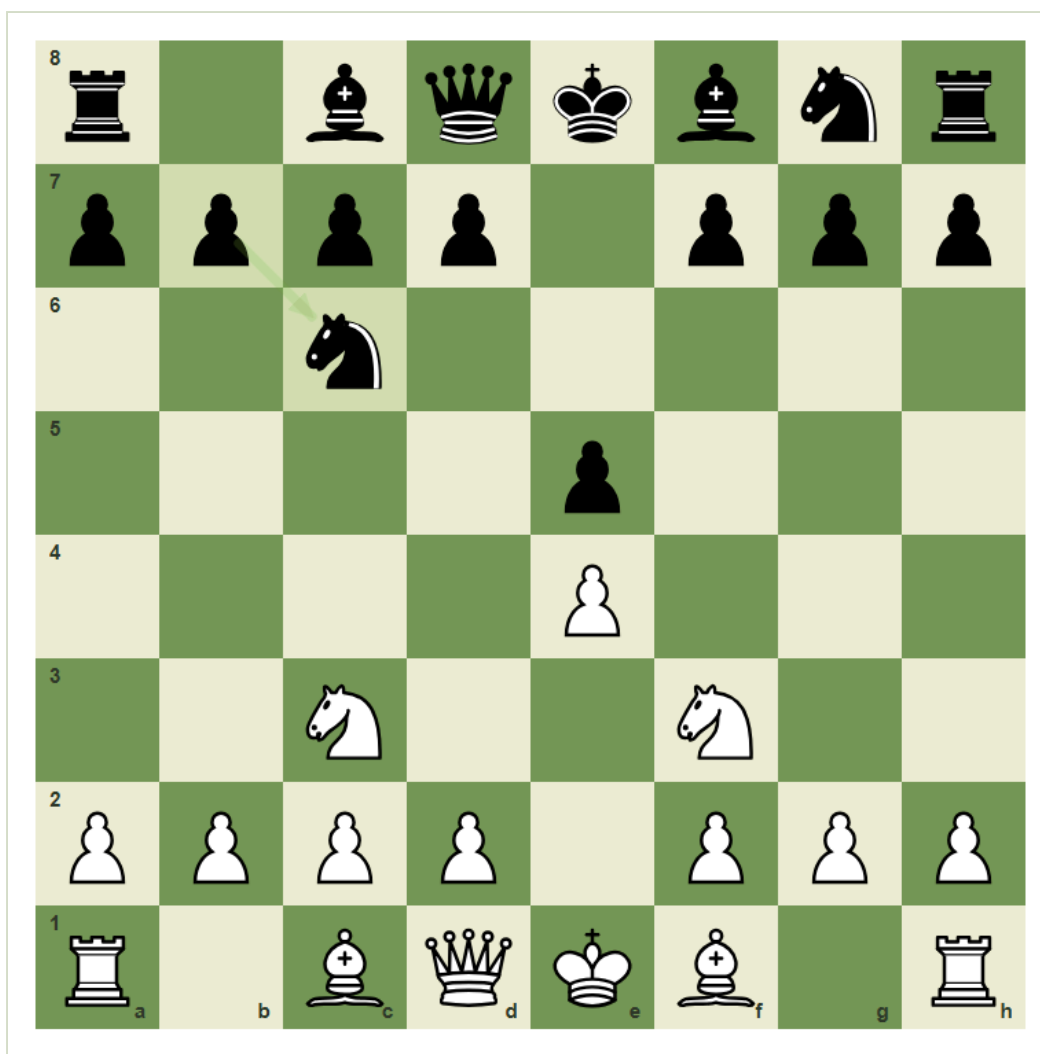
White can capture e5 because the knight is sitting in the open.

The bishop on c5 needs checking



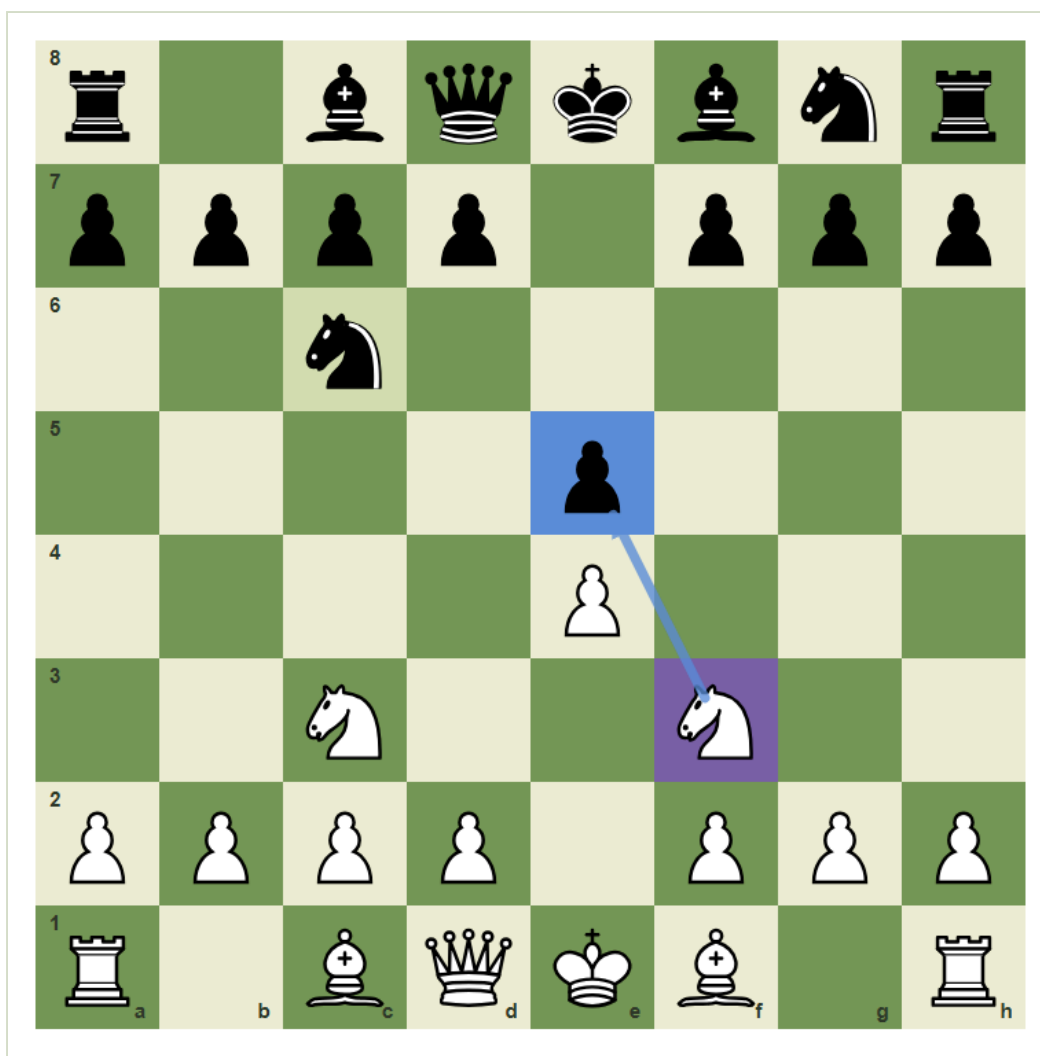
Do not call a piece loose until you count attackers and defenders.

Defended is different from hanging



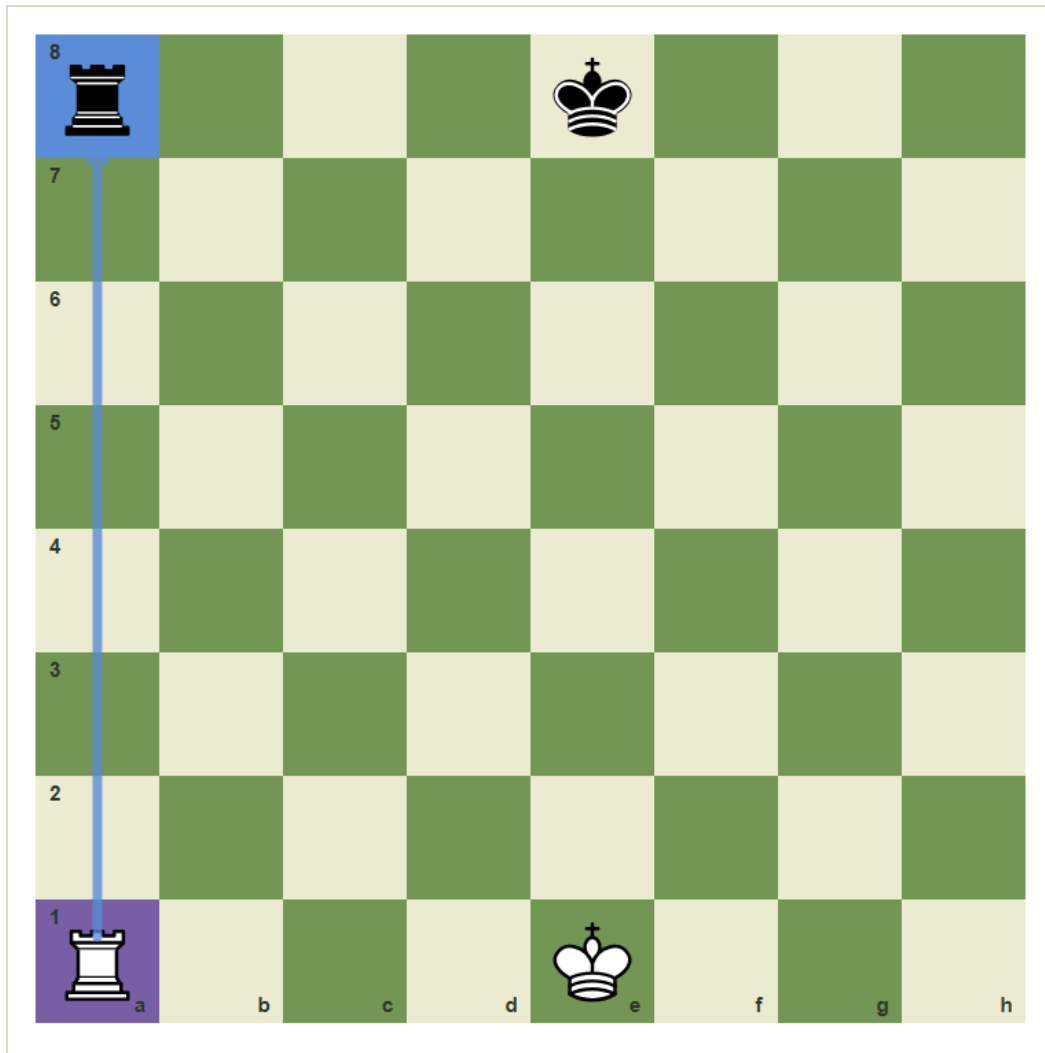
The knight on c6 has defenders. A target is not automatically free.

Count before collecting



The e5 pawn is a clearer target than the defended c6 knight.

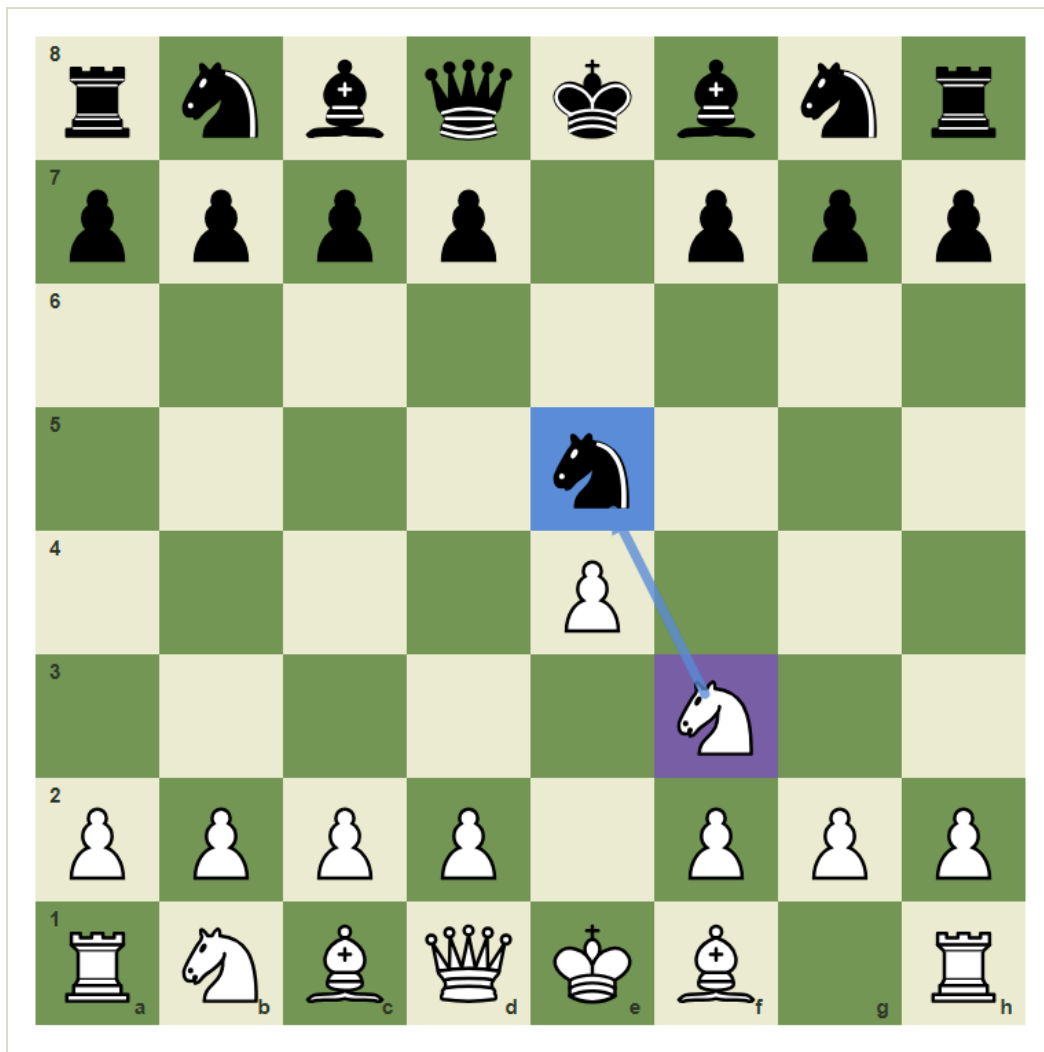
Open lines create loose rooks



The rook on a8 is exposed on the same file as White rook on a1.

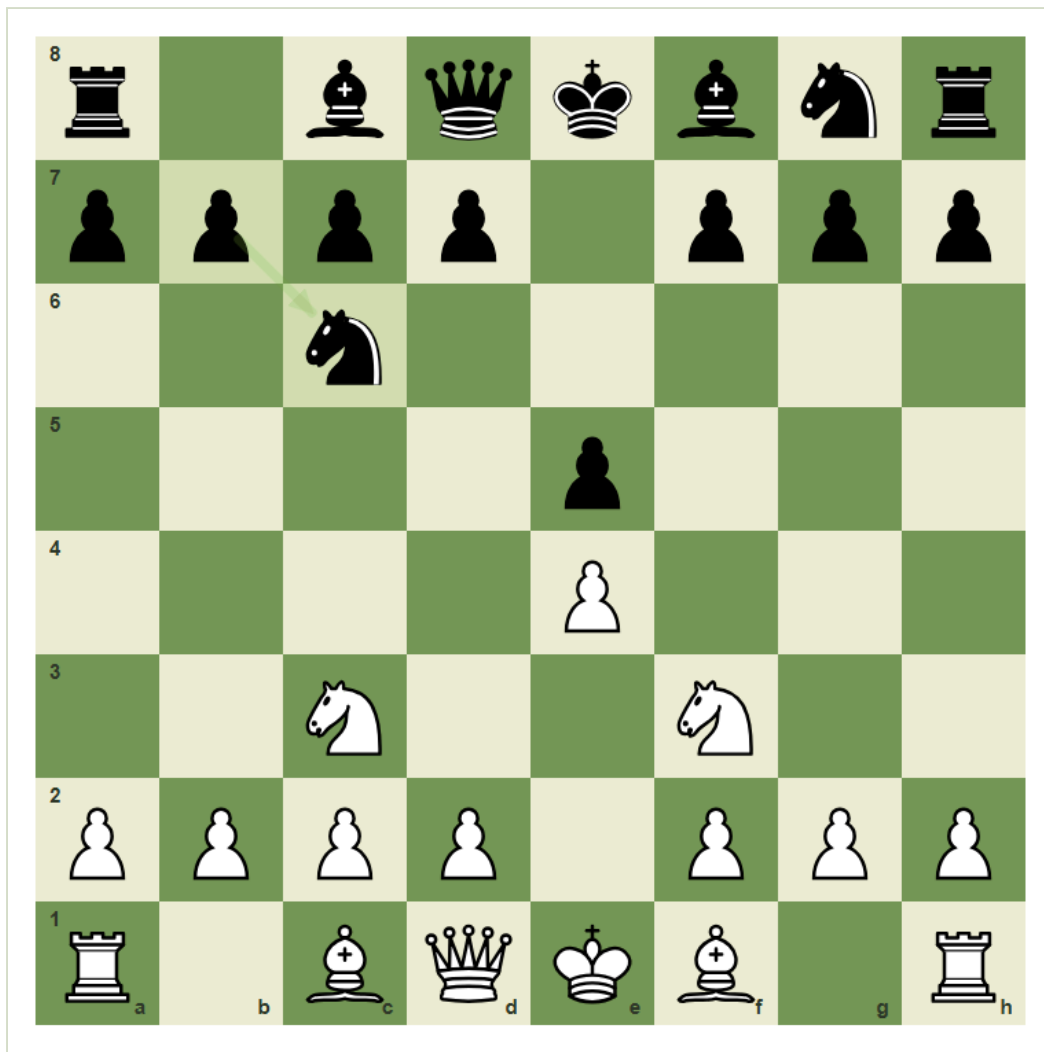
Capture the hanging knight

The black knight on e5 is loose. Play f3 to e5.



Common mistake: every attacked piece is not free

If a piece is defended, a capture may only trade instead of win. Count before you grab.



The c6 knight is marked safe because b7 helps defend it.

Chapter Checkpoint

A hanging piece is:

A hanging piece is:

- a. Attacked and safely defended
- b. Attacked and not safely defended
- c. A king in check

Before capturing a target, you should count:

Before capturing a target, you should count:

- a. Attackers and defenders
- b. Only piece color
- c. Only move number

A defended piece is always free material.

A defended piece is always free material.

- a. True
- b. False

One-Move Attacks And One-Move Defenses

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

See the opponent threat and answer it simply.

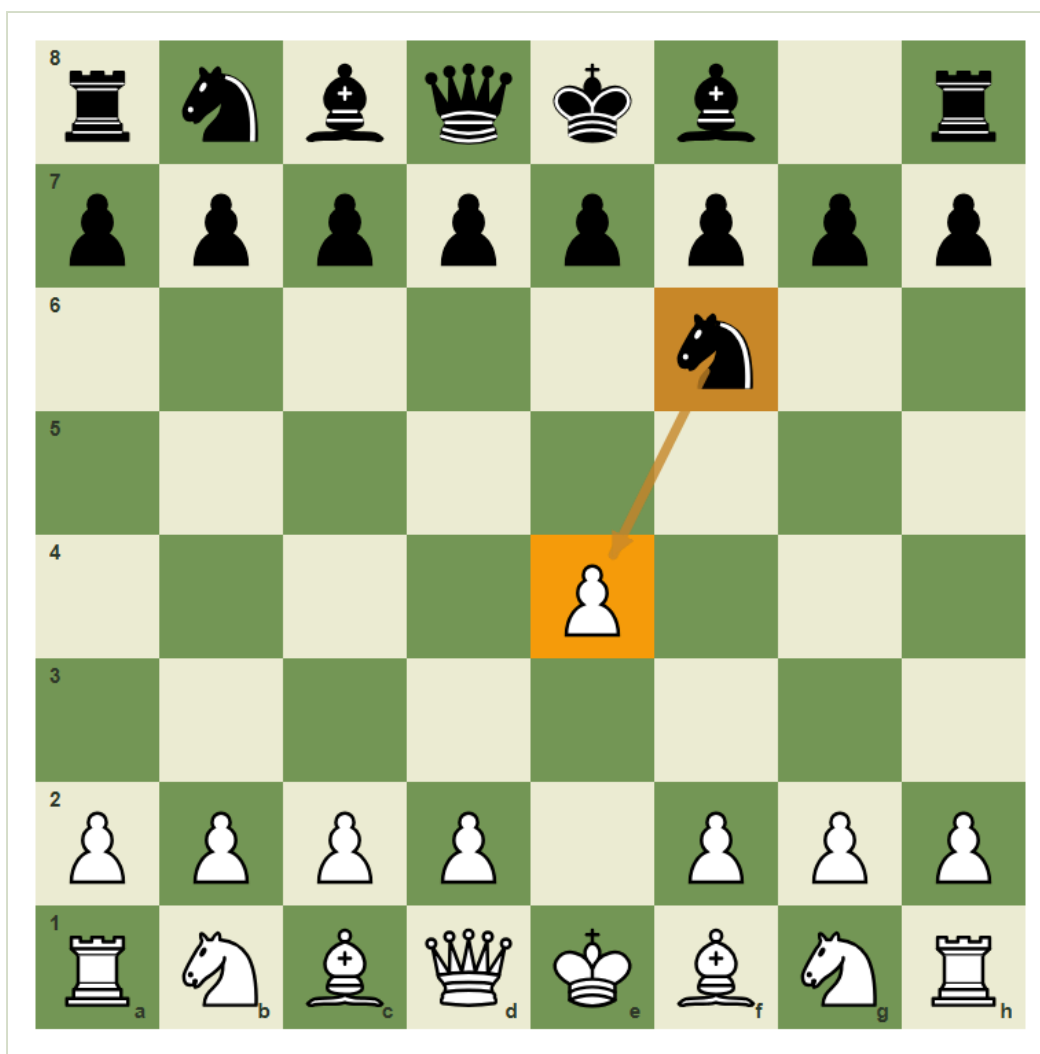
Learning objectives

- Notice direct one-move attacks.
- Choose a simple defense.
- Find moves that attack and defend at the same time.

One Move Is Enough

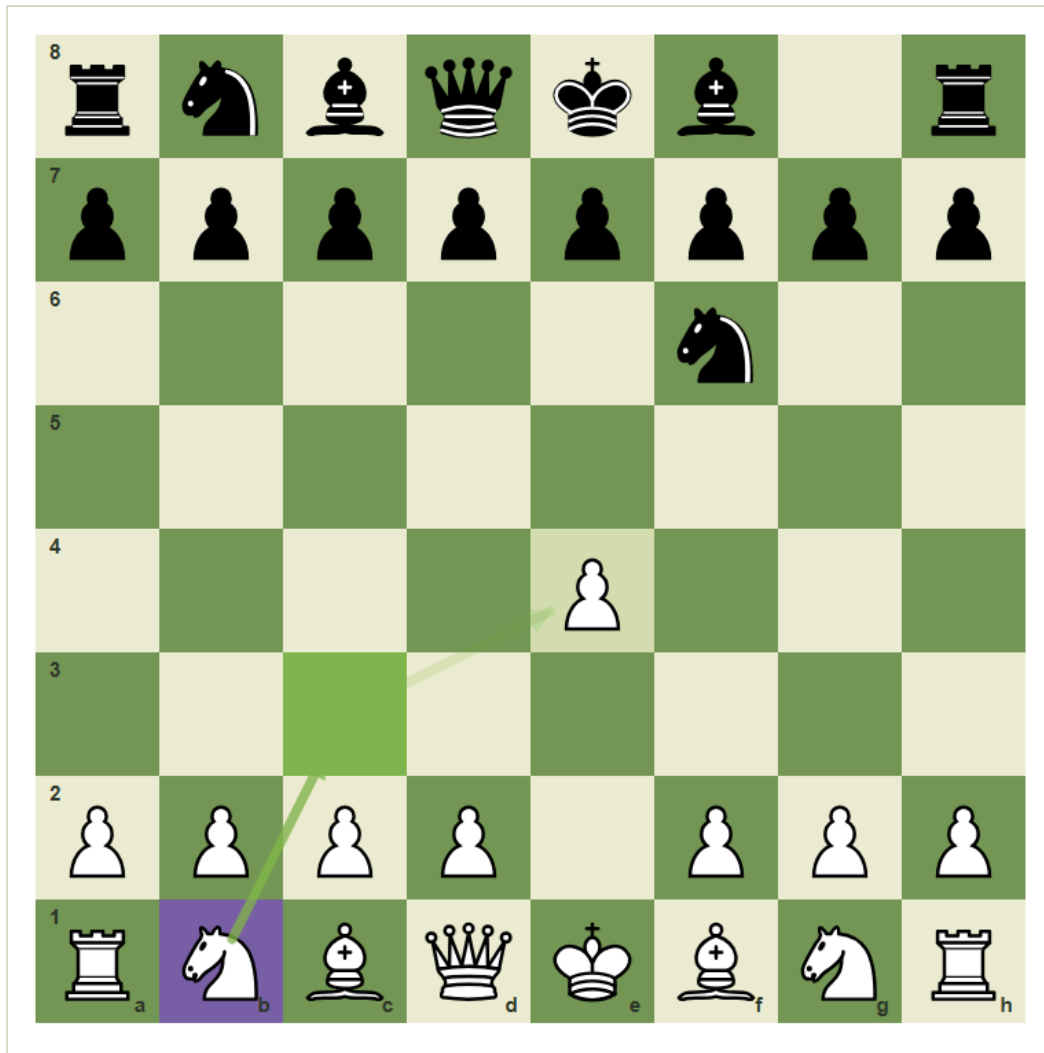
A beginner blunder often has a one-move story: one piece attacks, one piece is attacked, and nobody answered. Your job is to notice the story before it becomes material loss.

The e4 pawn is attacked



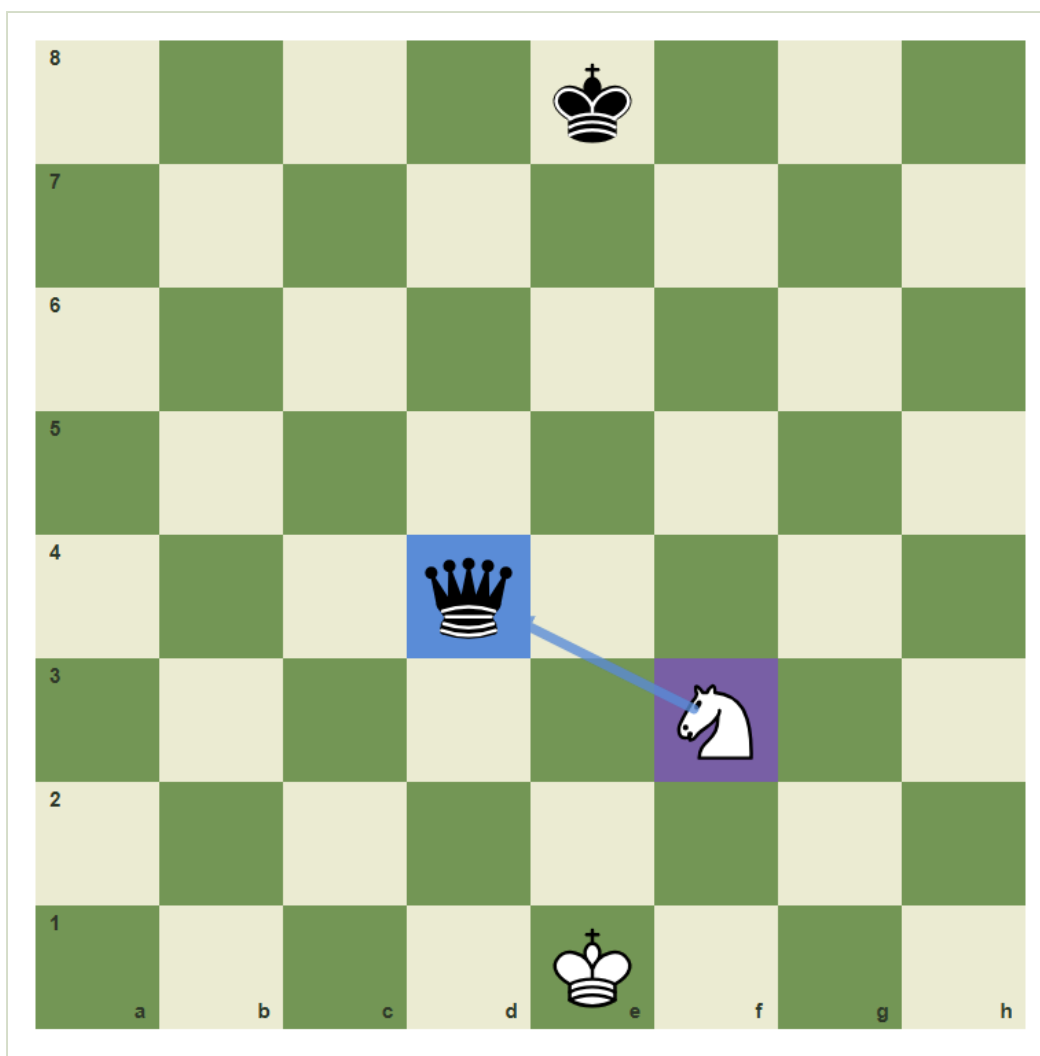
The knight on f6 points at e4. White should notice the attack.

Defend with b1-c3



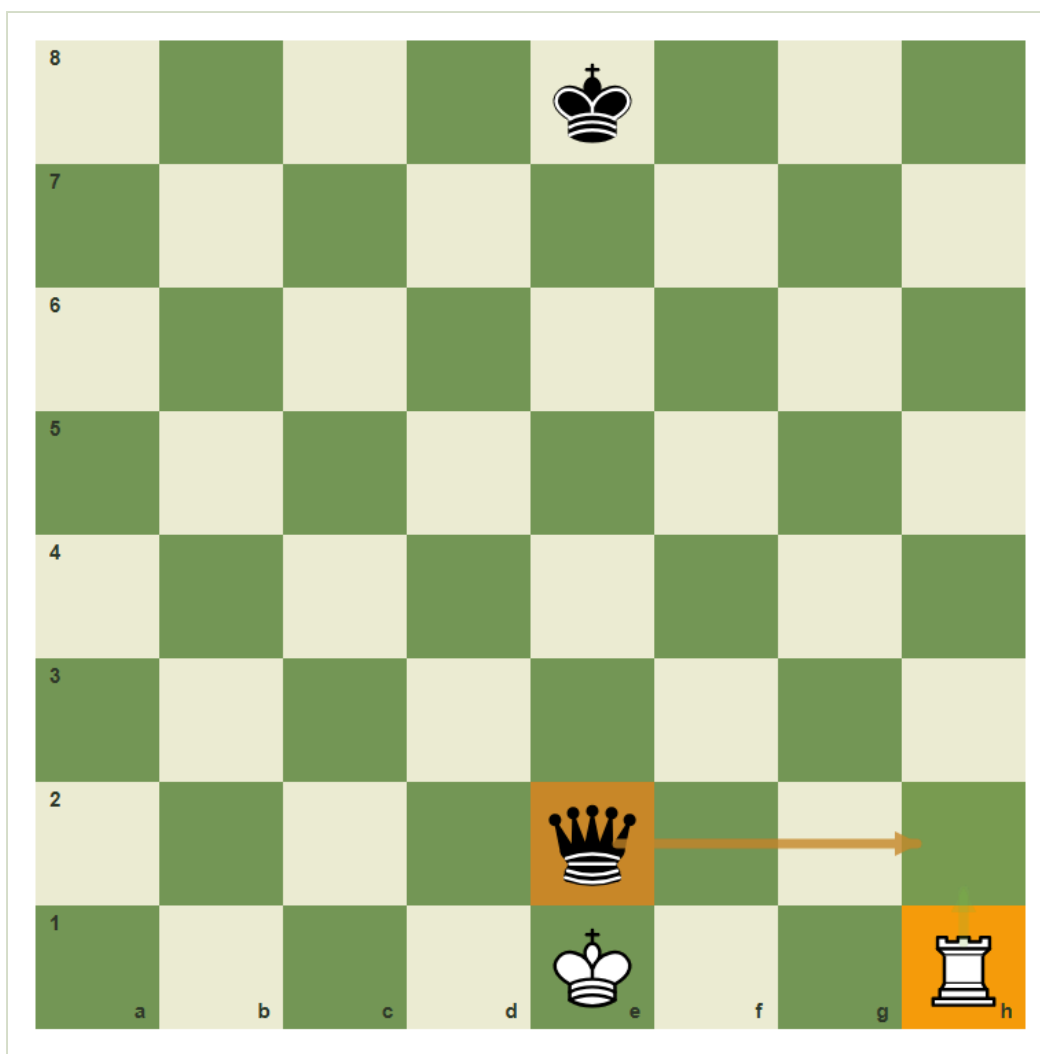
The move b1-c3 adds a defender to e4 while developing a knight.

A loose queen can be attacked



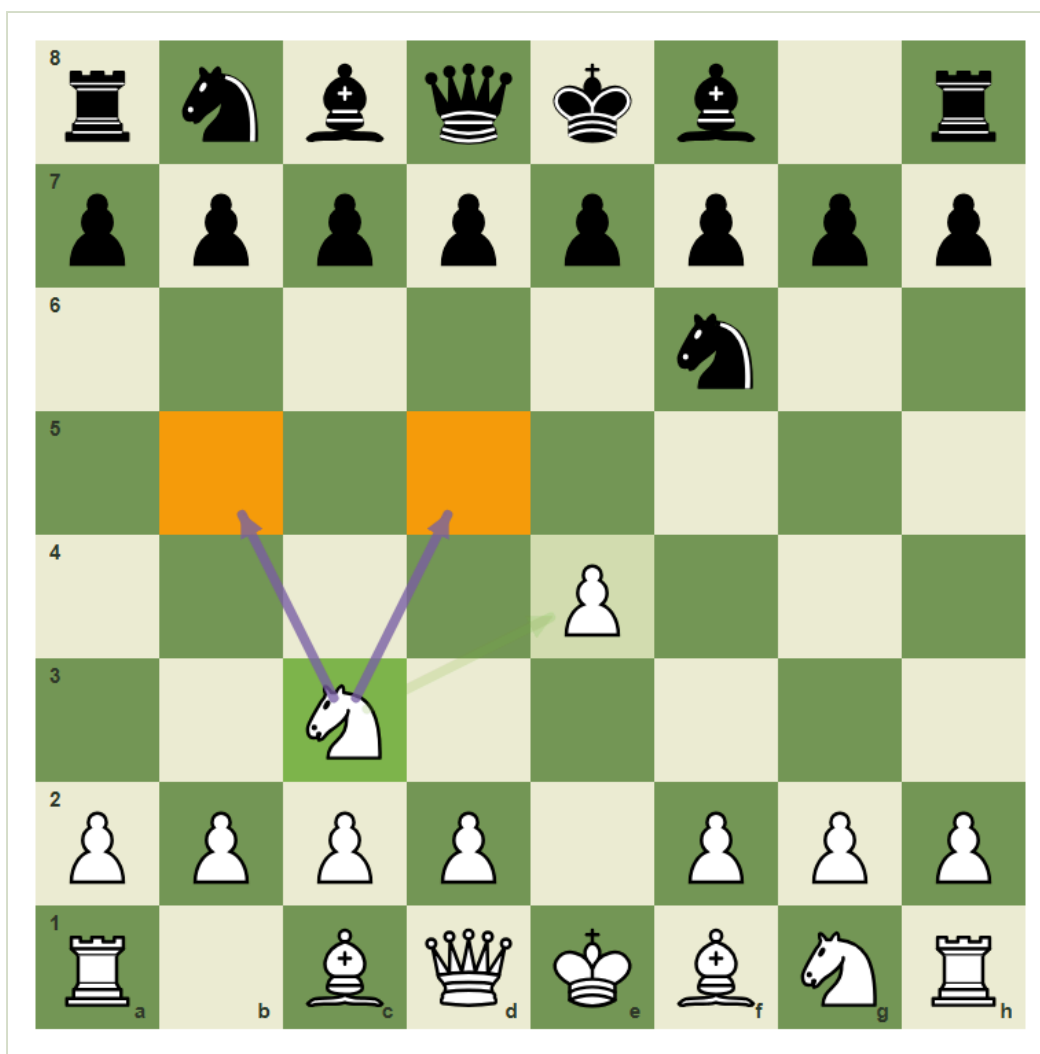
The knight on f3 attacks d4. Big targets count too.

Moving away is a defense



If the rook is attacked, one answer is to move it to a safe square.

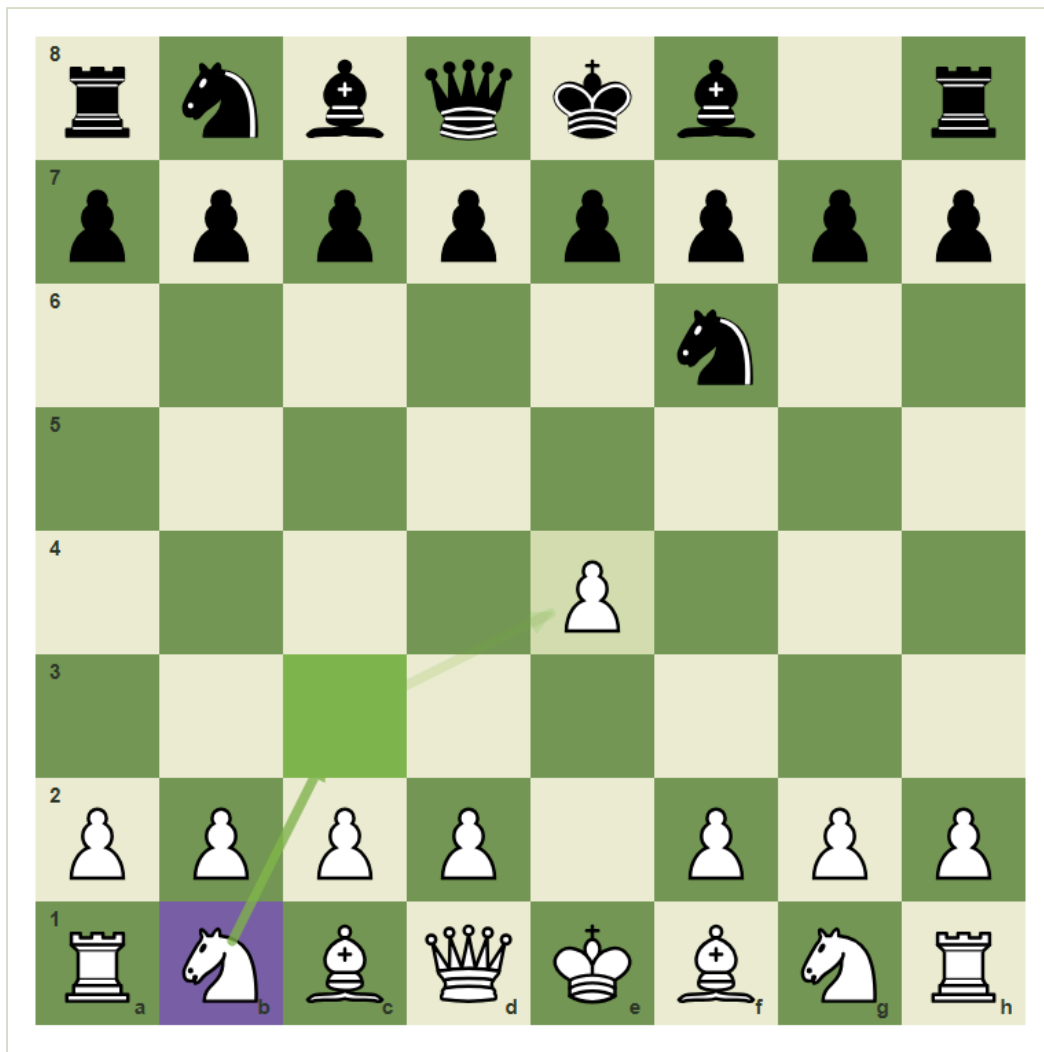
Attack and defend together



The knight on c3 defends e4 and also looks toward d5 and b5.

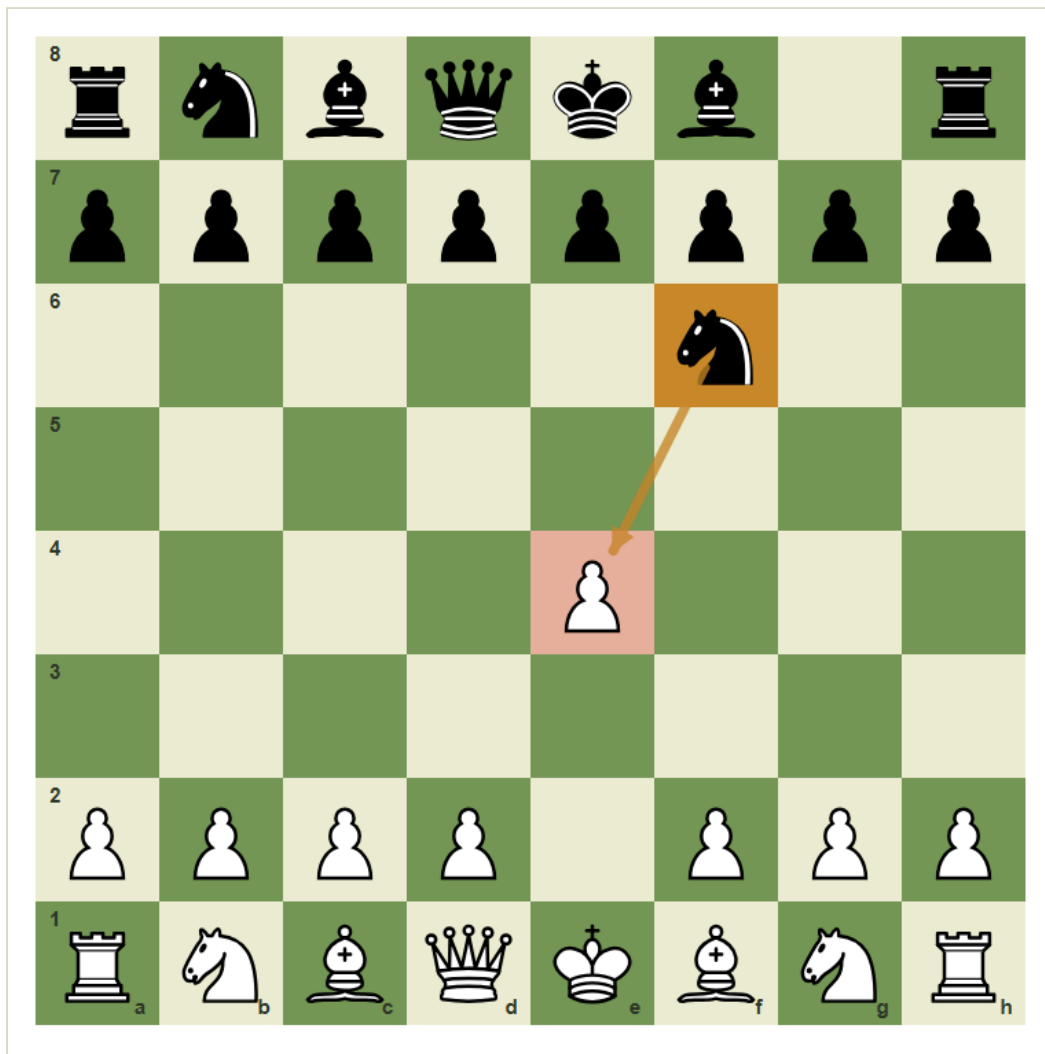
Defend the attacked pawn

The pawn on e4 is attacked. Develop the knight from b1 to c3.



Common mistake: ignore the direct attack

If White plays a random move, Black can take e4. One-move threats must be answered.



The arrow from f6 to e4 is the warning.

Chapter Checkpoint

A simple defense can be:

A simple defense can be:

- a. Move the attacked piece
- b. Pretend there is no threat
- c. Always move the queen

A developing move is especially good when it also:

A developing move is especially good when it also:

- a. Defends something important
- b. Loses a rook
- c. Blocks your king forever

If your opponent attacks a pawn, you should:

If your opponent attacks a pawn, you should:

- a. Scan ways to defend or move it
- b. Always resign
- c. Move instantly

Safe Squares For The King

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Escape check without walking into another one.

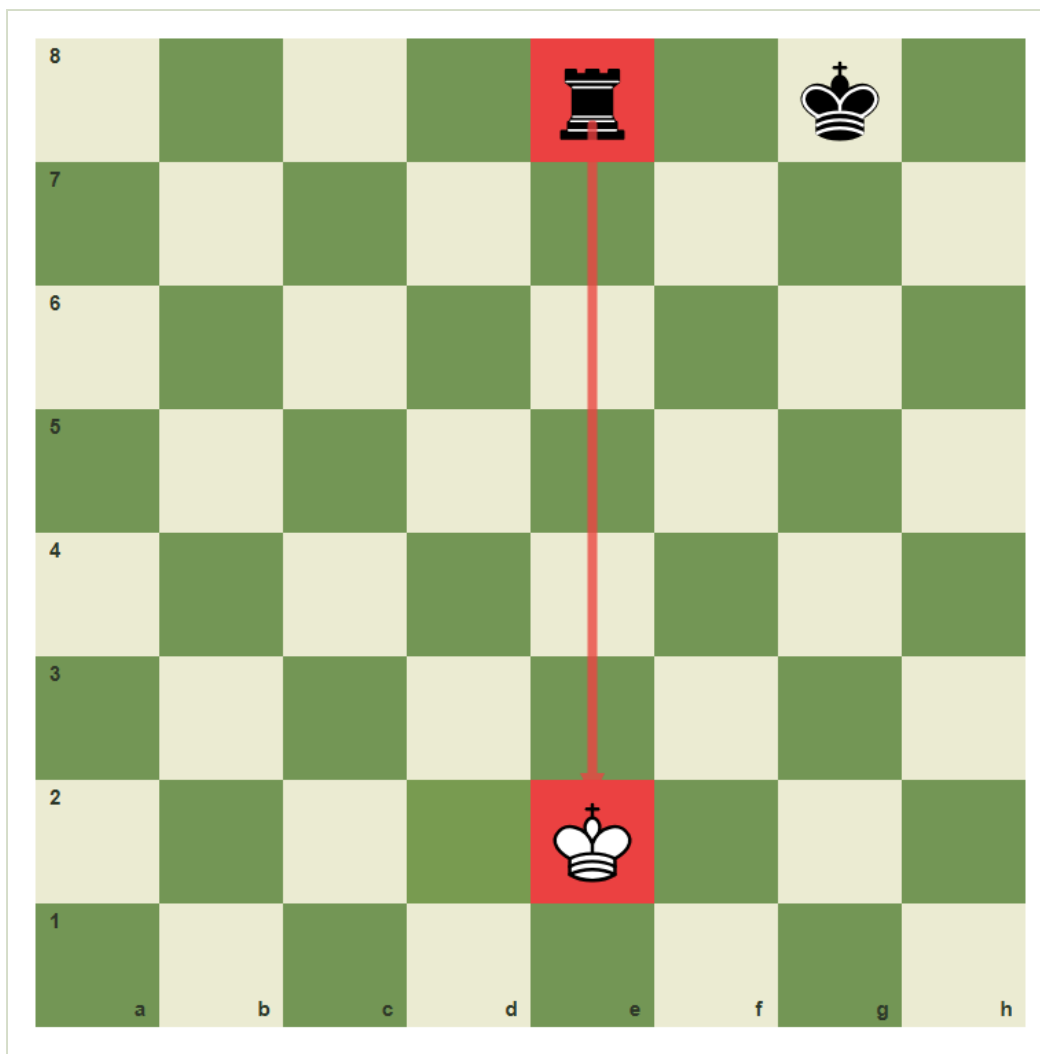
Learning objectives

- Identify the line of check.
- Choose king moves that leave danger behind.
- Compare moving, blocking, and capturing the checking piece.

The King Needs Legal Air

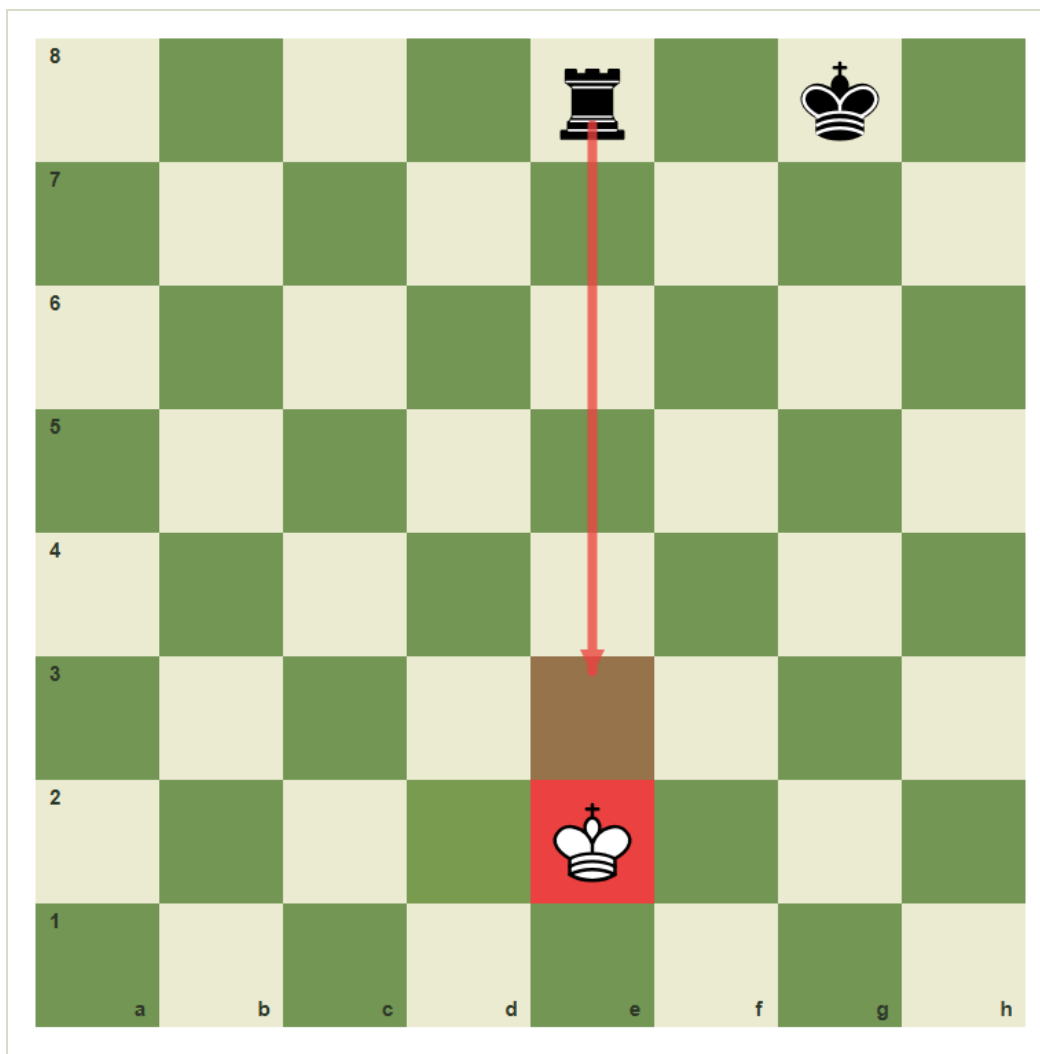
When your king is in check, normal plans stop. You must get out of check by moving the king, blocking the line, or capturing the checking piece.

The e-file check



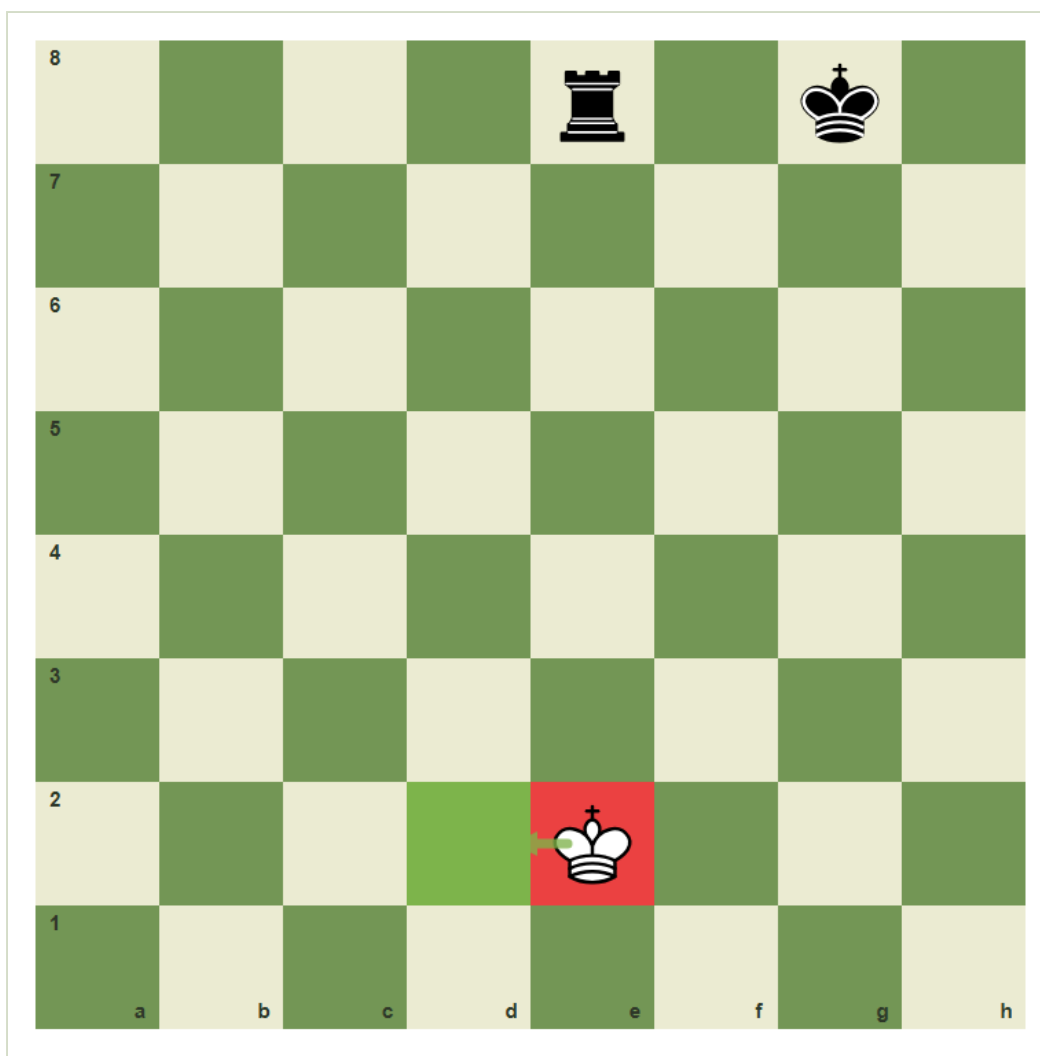
The rook checks down the e-file. The king on e2 must leave the line.

The e-file is still unsafe



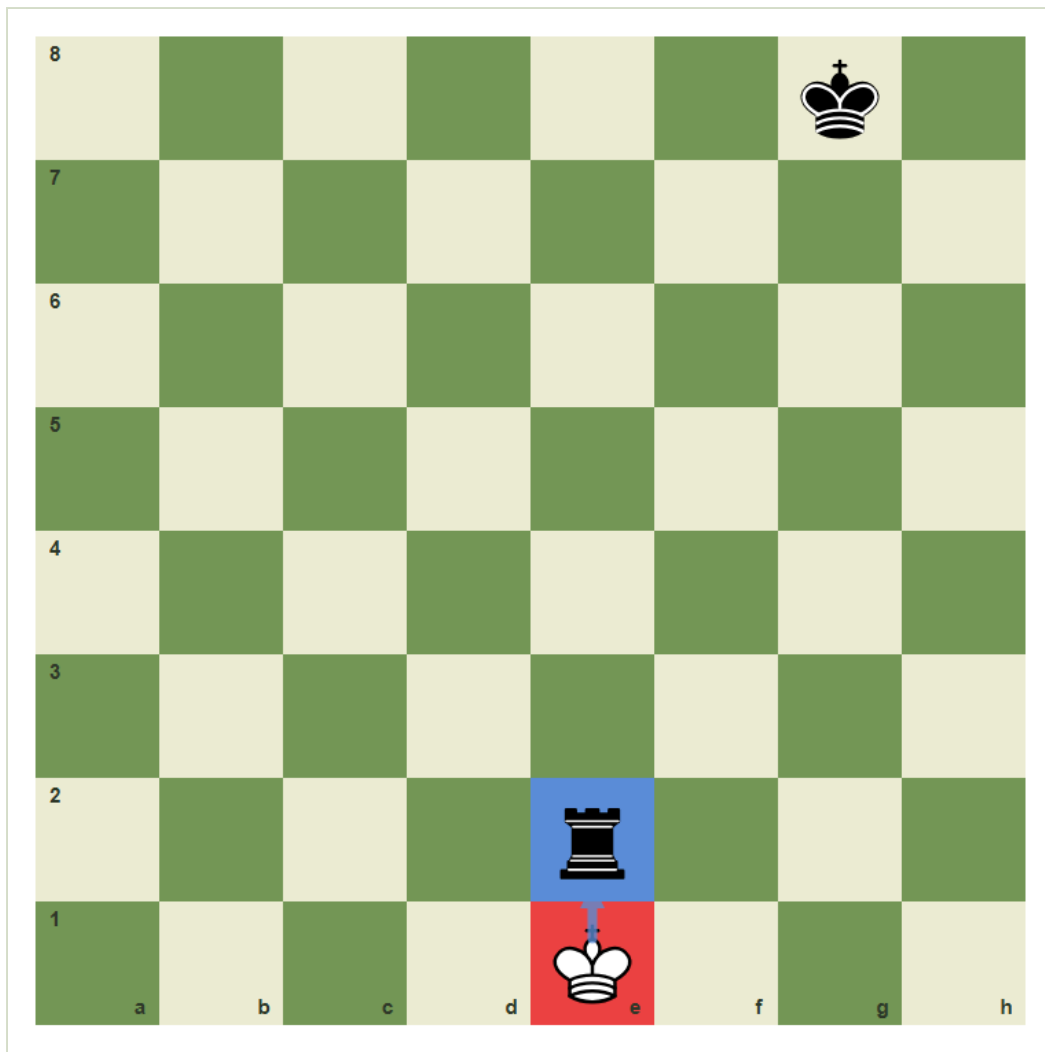
Moving along the same file can remain dangerous. Look for a square off the line.

Step to d2



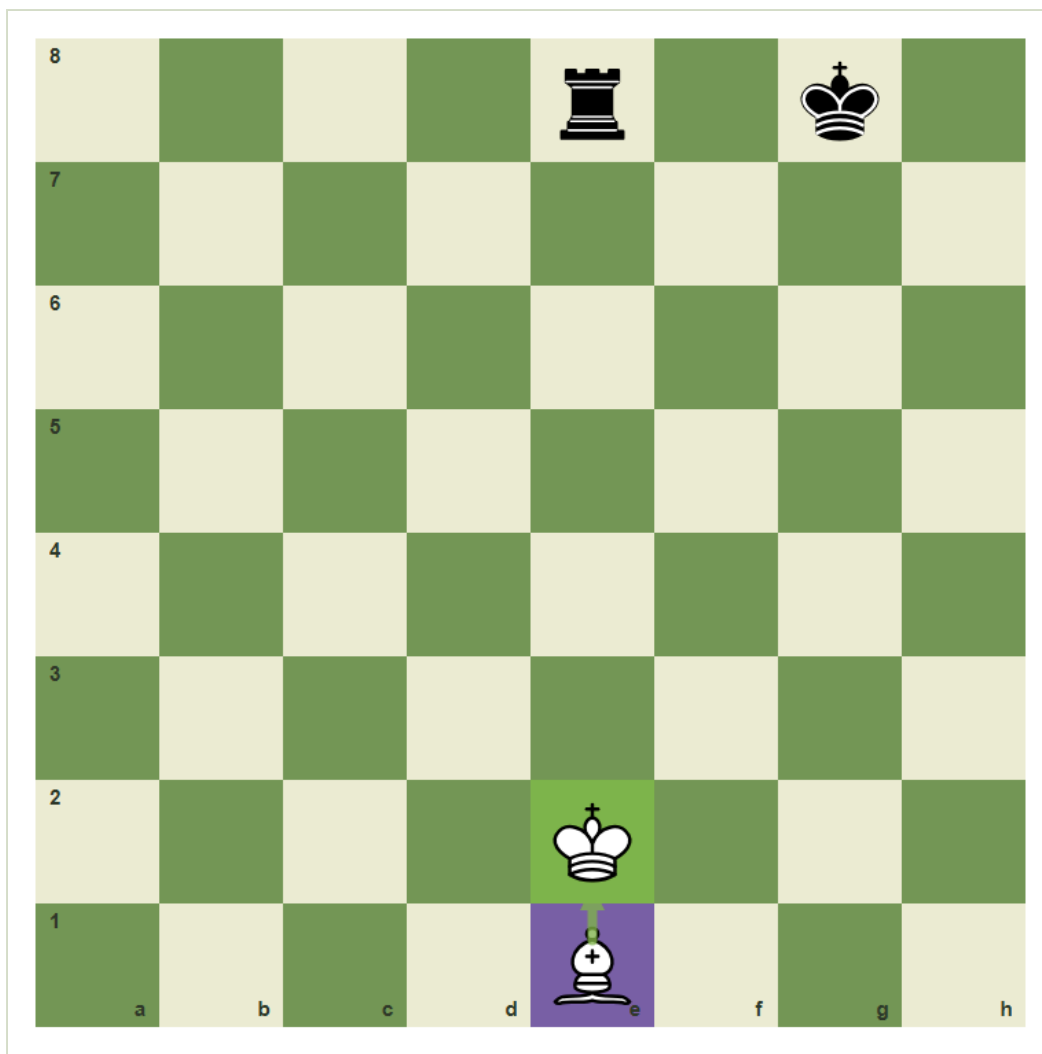
The square d2 is not on the rook line.

Sometimes capture the checker



If the checking piece is close and undefended, the king may capture it.

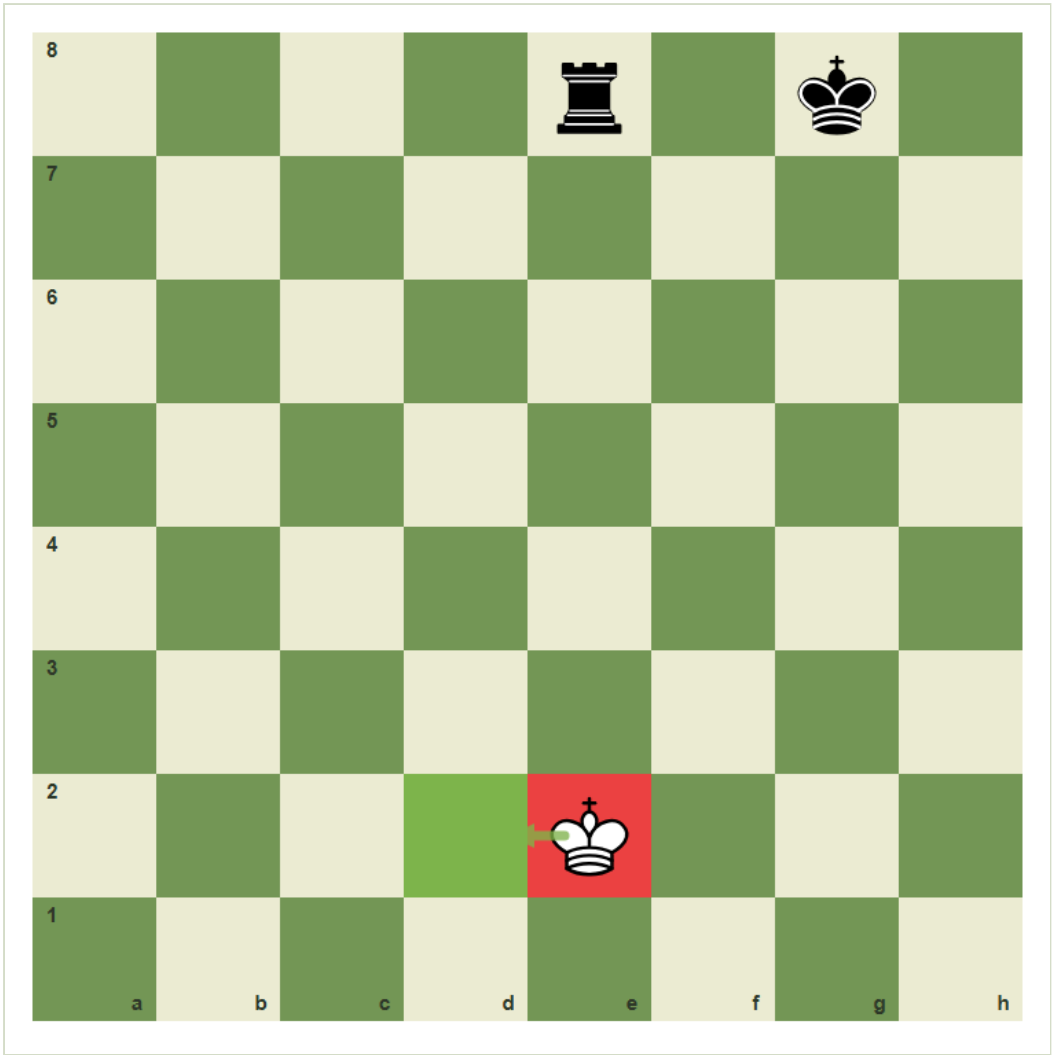
A block can also work



A bishop can block the rook line on e2 only if the square and piece movement allow it.

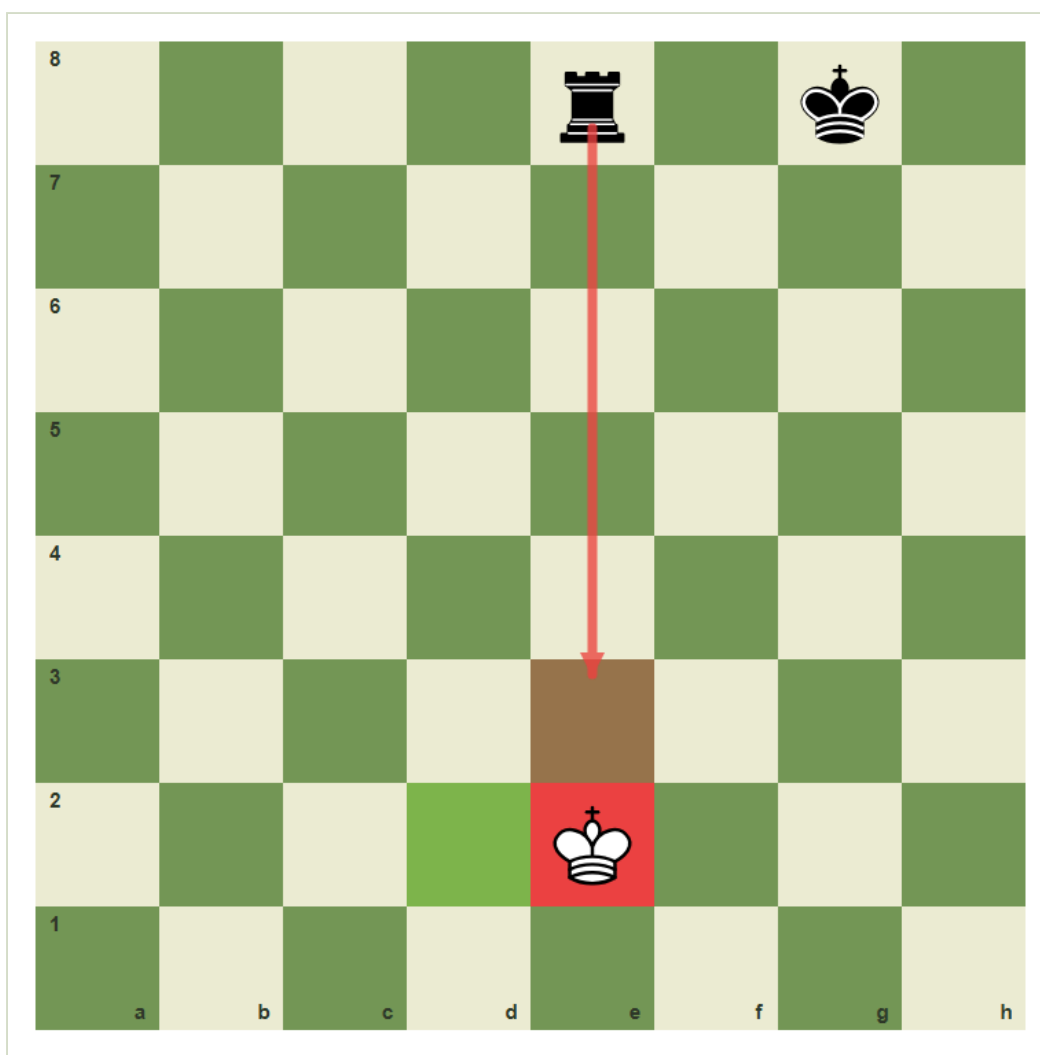
Escape the rook check

Move the king from e2 to d2.



Common mistake: stay on the checking line

If the rook controls the e-file, the king should not stay on that file.



The unsafe square e3 is still on the rook line.

Chapter Checkpoint

When in check, you may:

When in check, you may:

- a. Ignore it
- b. Move, block, or capture the checker
- c. Only move a pawn

A safe king square must be:

A safe king square must be:

- a. Not controlled by enemy pieces
- b. On the same line as a rook check
- c. Chosen quickly

The first priority in check is:

The first priority in check is:

- a. Win material
- b. Get legally out of check
- c. Castle later

Capturing Wisely: Good Trades And Bad Trades

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Use value and safety before every capture.

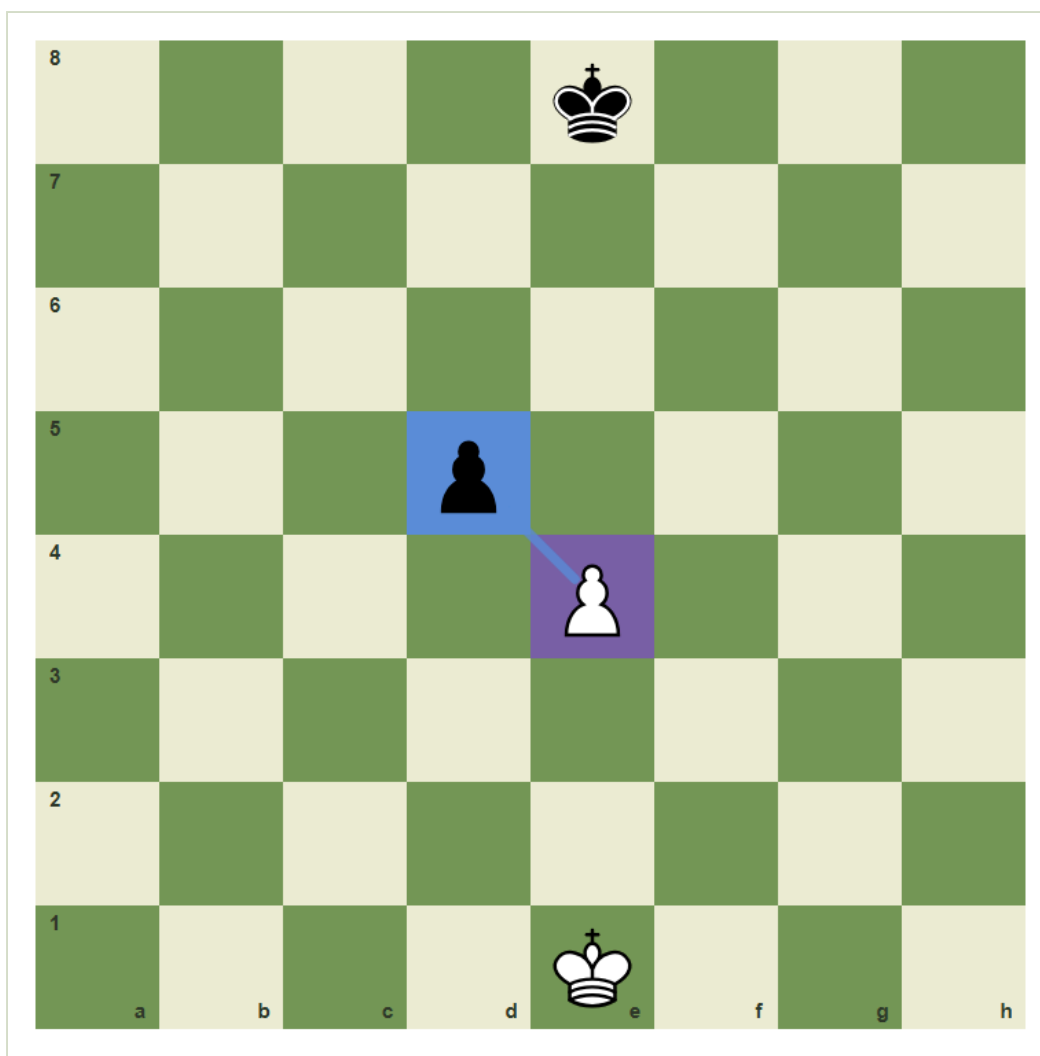
Learning objectives

- Compare simple material values.
- Separate winning material from equal trades.
- Notice recaptures before taking.

A Capture Is A Decision

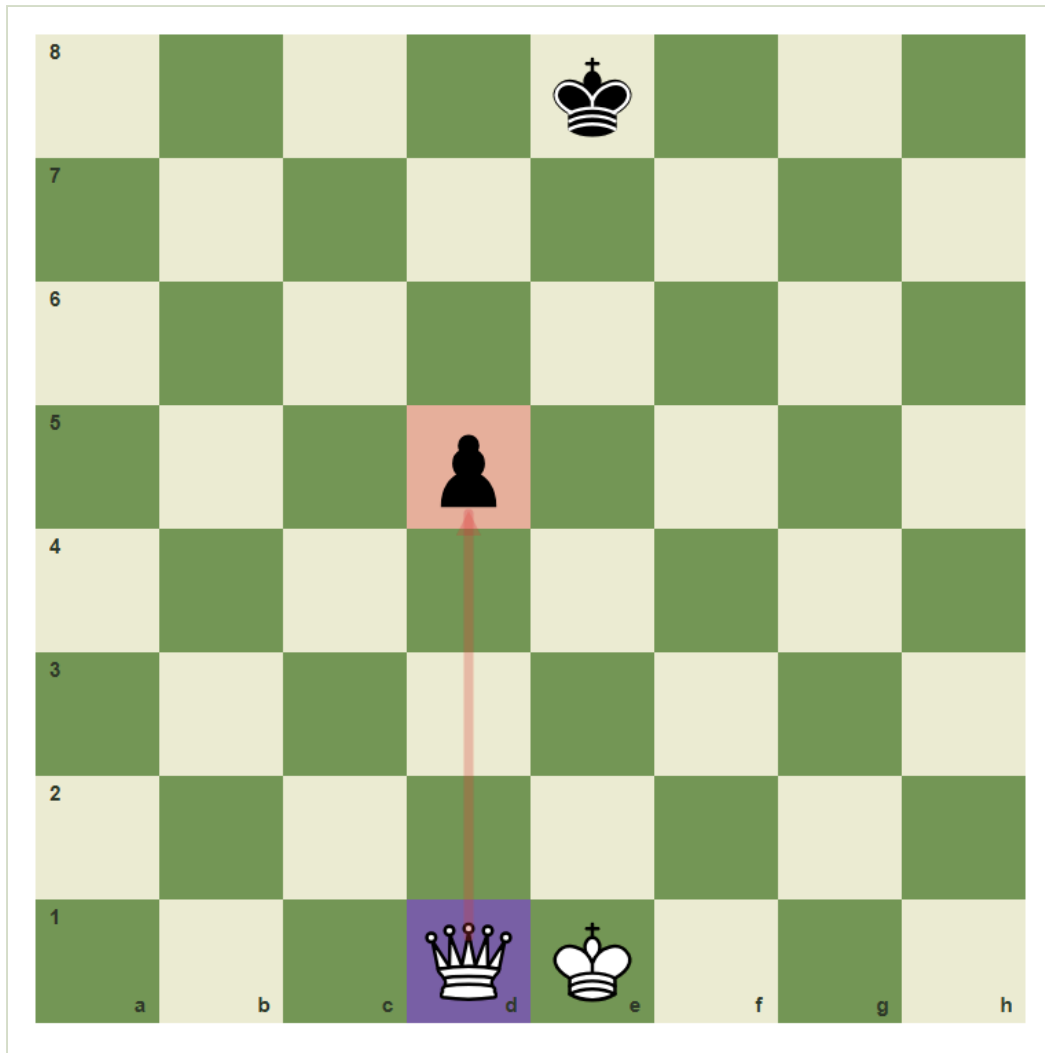
Captures feel satisfying, but not every capture is good. Ask: what do I win, what can recapture me, and what is the value exchange?

A simple pawn capture



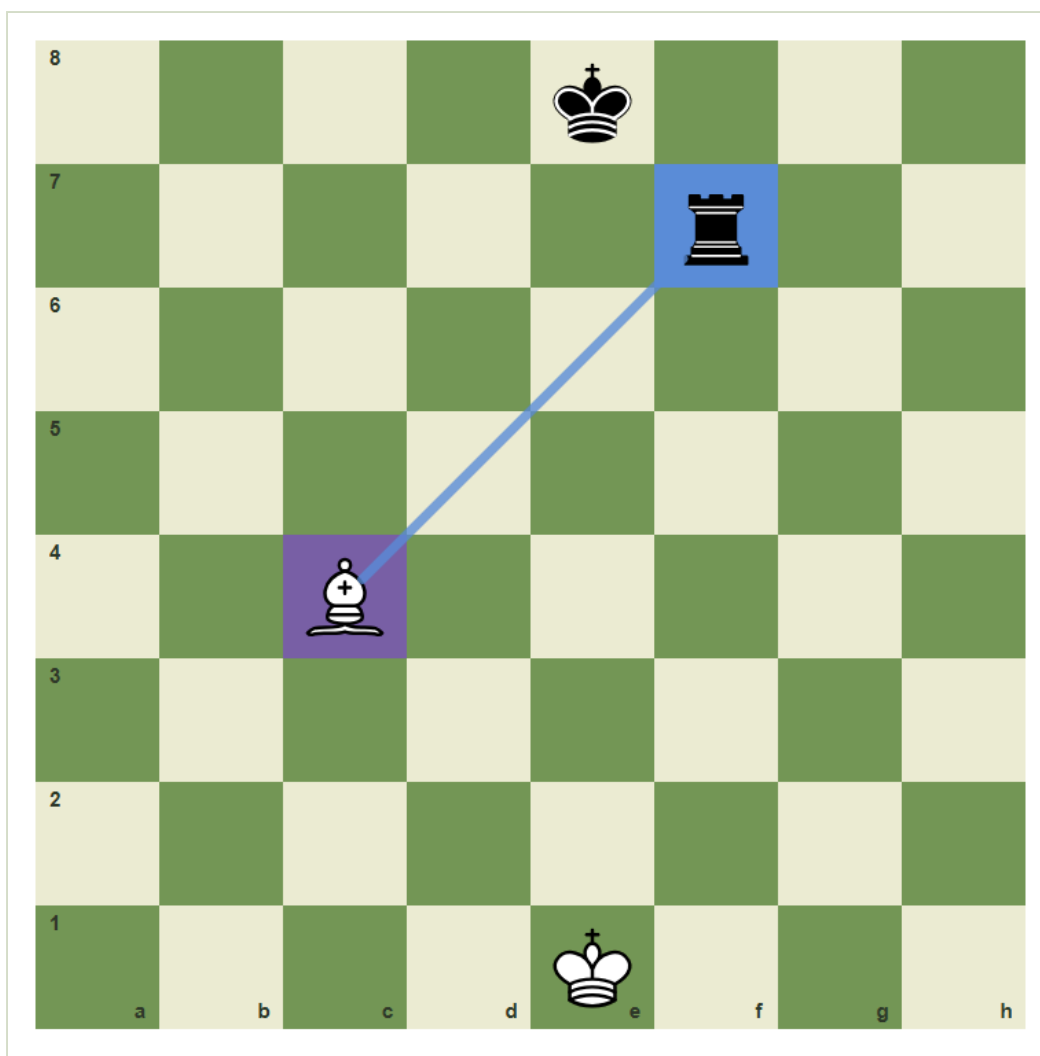
The e4 pawn can capture d5. Pawns often trade evenly.

Do not risk a queen for a pawn



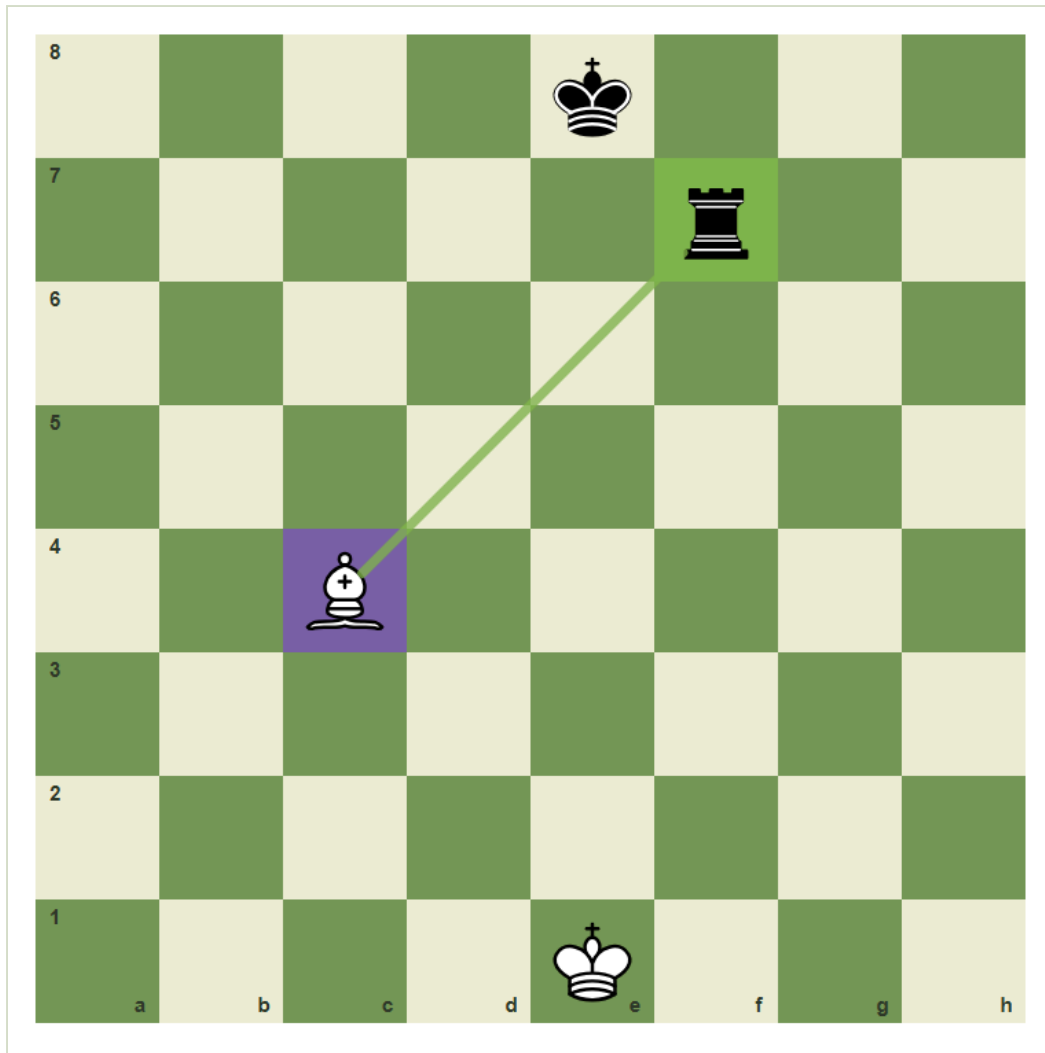
The pawn on d5 is small. A queen move to d5 must be checked for danger.

A bishop can win a rook



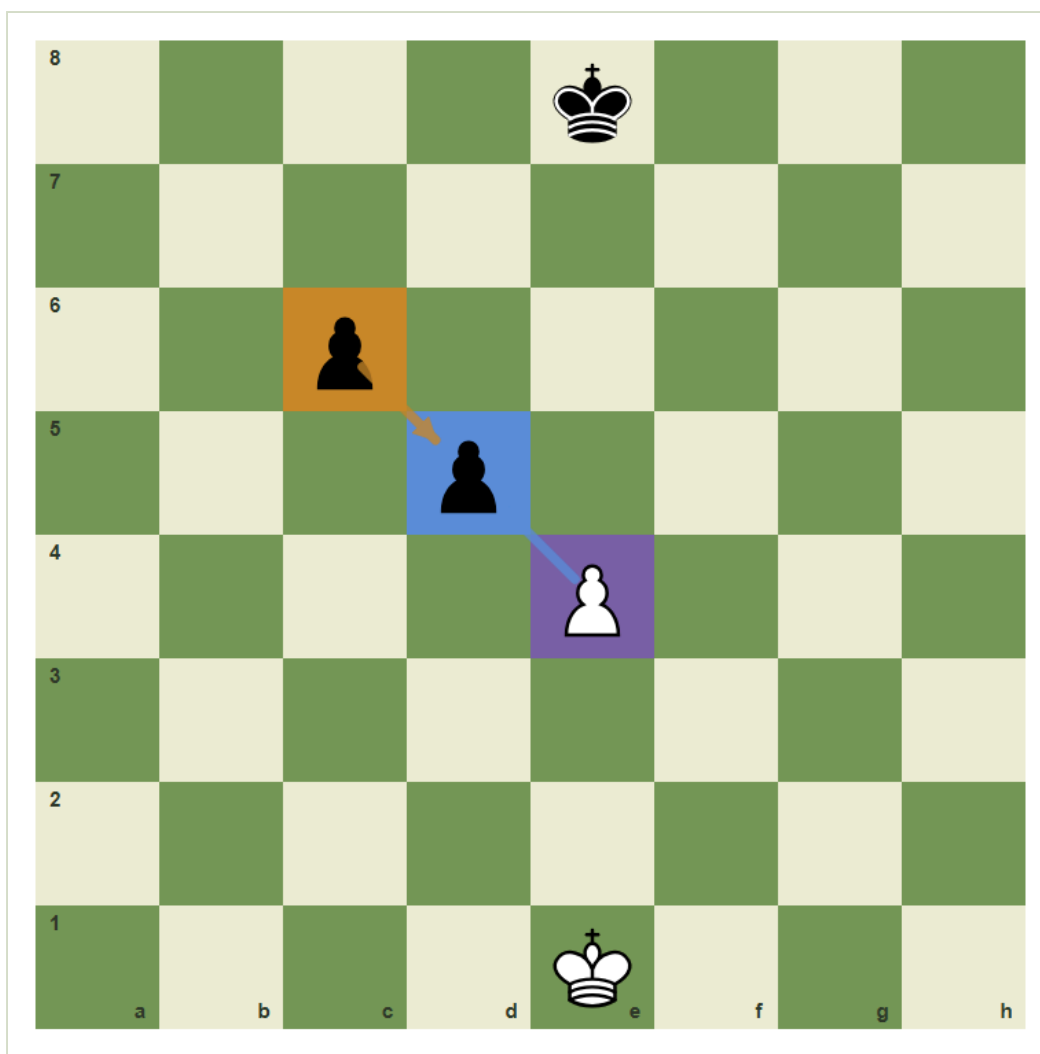
The bishop on c4 can capture the rook on f7.

Count value before capture



Bishop for rook is usually profitable because rook value is higher.

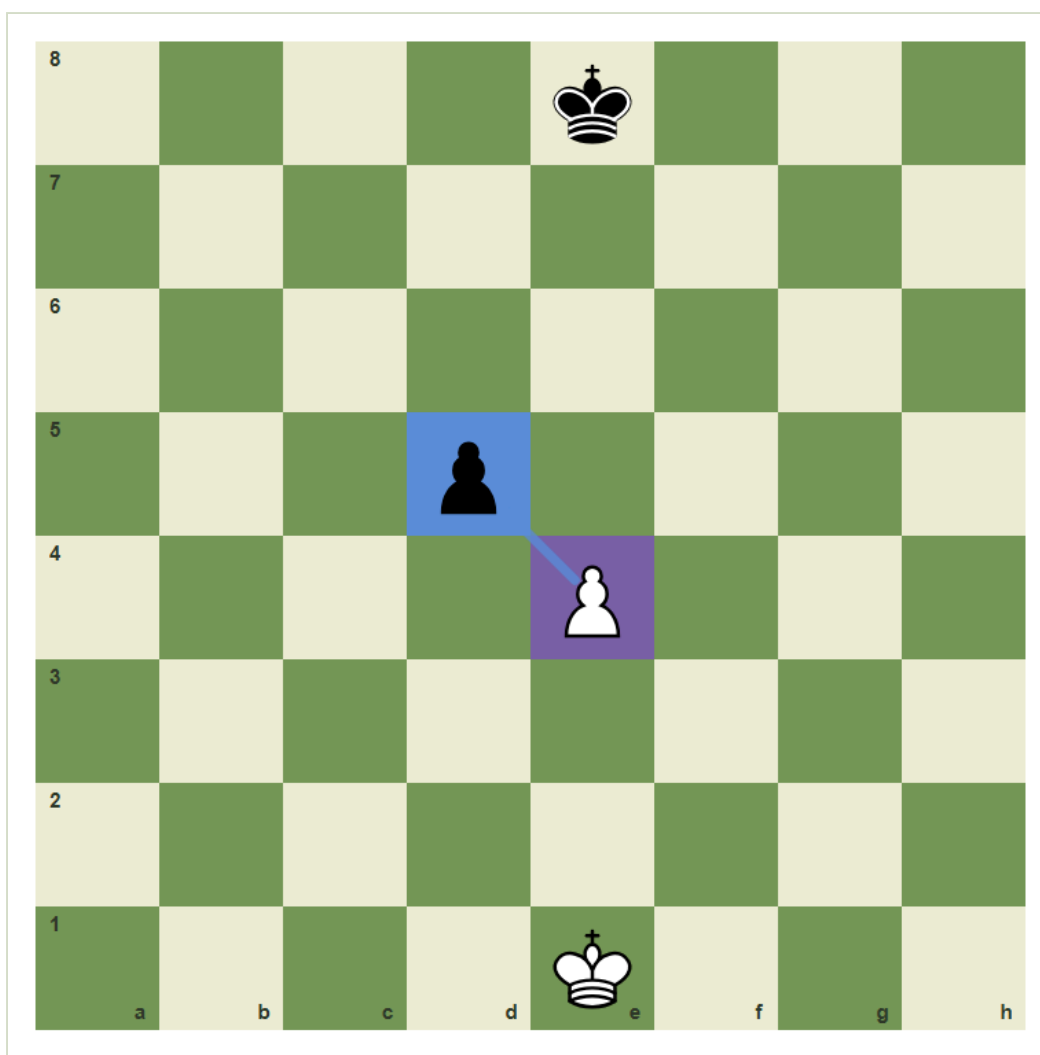
Look for the recapture



After e4xd5, the c6 pawn may recapture. Notice the second move.

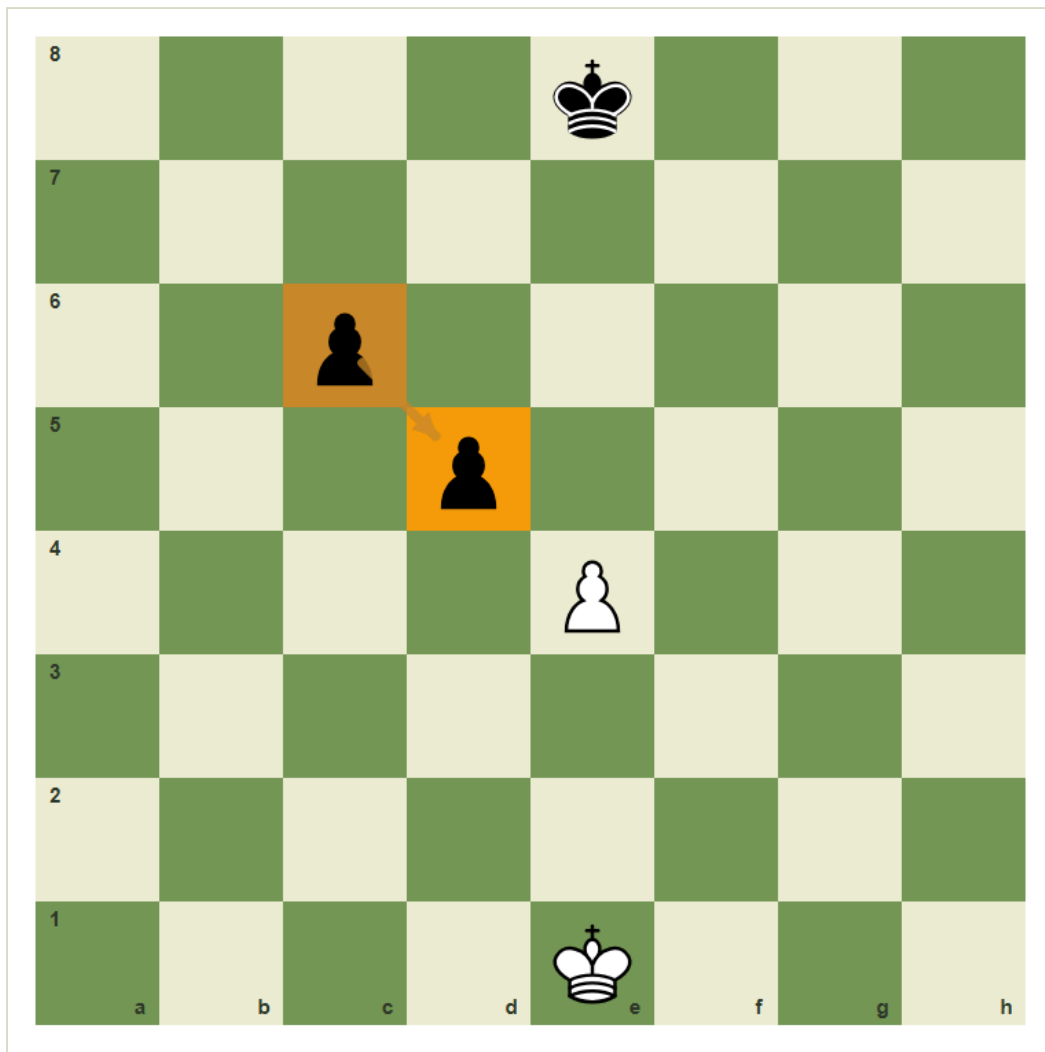
Make the equal pawn capture

Capture from e4 to d5.



Common mistake: forget the recapture

If another pawn can recapture, the first capture may only be a trade.



The c6 pawn points back to d5.

Chapter Checkpoint

Before a capture, ask what can:

Before a capture, ask what can:

- a. Recapture
- b. Rename the board
- c. Change the clock color

Winning a rook for a bishop is usually:

Winning a rook for a bishop is usually:

- a. Good
- b. Always illegal
- c. The same as losing a queen

A pawn capture may simply be:

A pawn capture may simply be:

- a. An equal trade
- b. Always checkmate
- c. Always a blunder

Basic Checkmates With Queen And Rook

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Turn a winning position into checkmate.

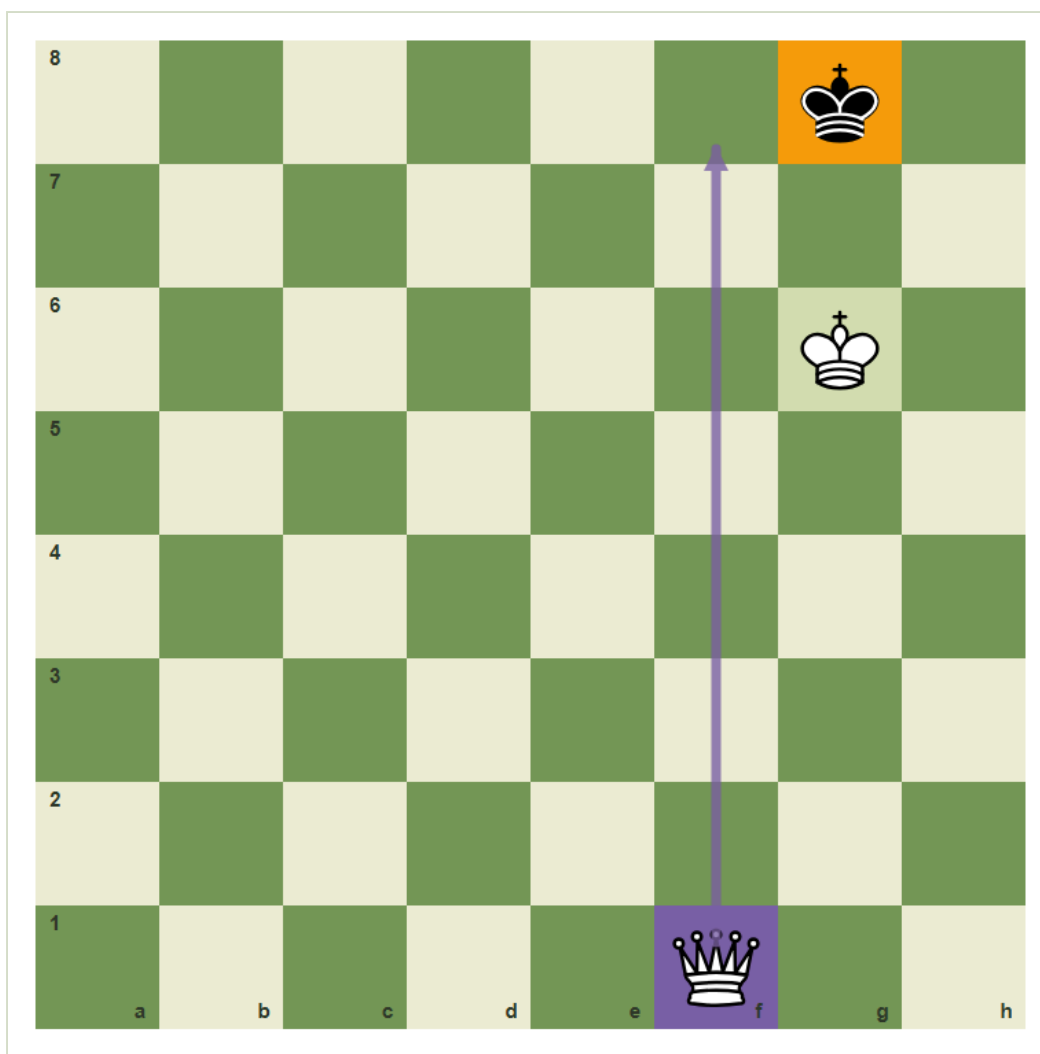
Learning objectives

- Use the queen or rook to cut off the king.
- Bring your king close enough to support mate.
- Deliver a final checking move.

Win The Won Game

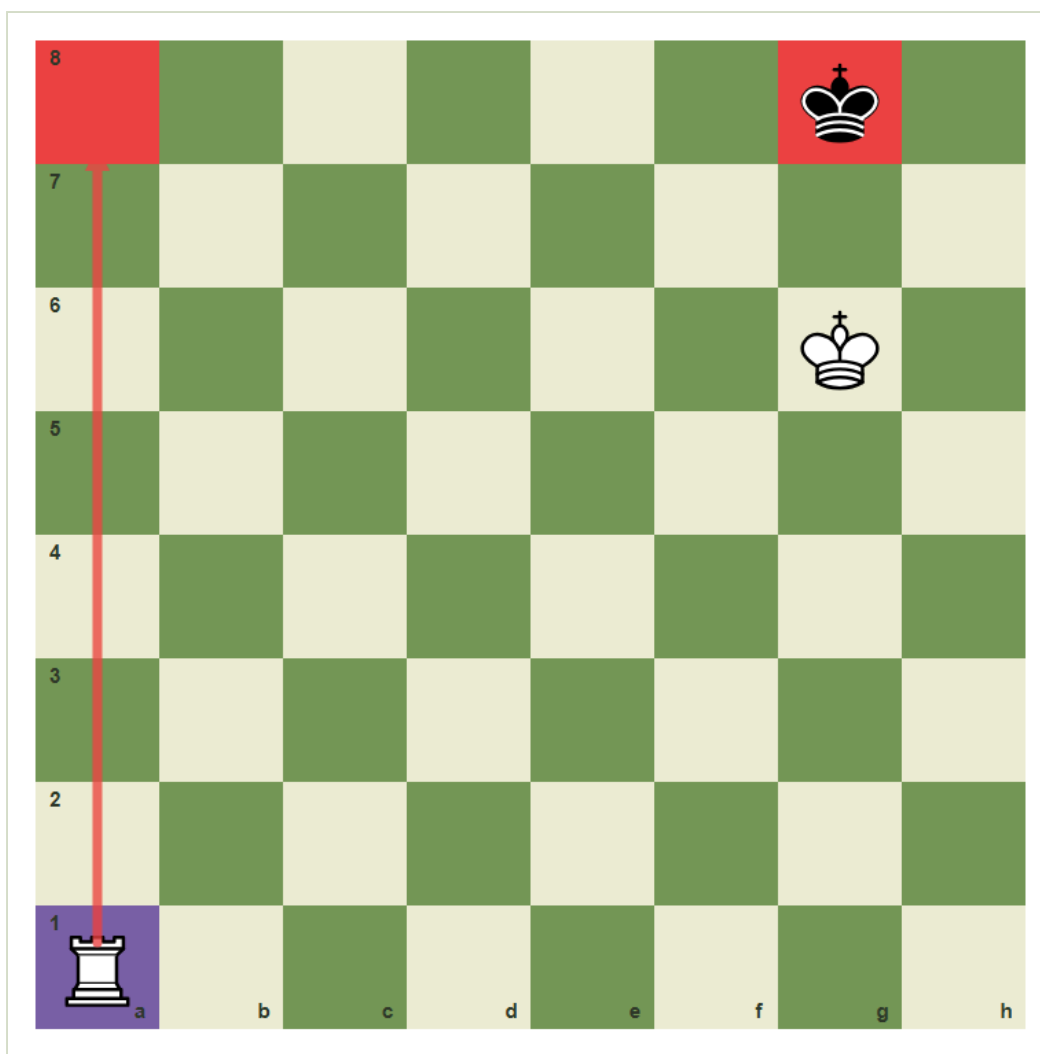
A big material advantage is not enough. You still need checkmate. Queen and rook mates work by making a box, bringing the king closer, and giving the final check.

The queen builds a box



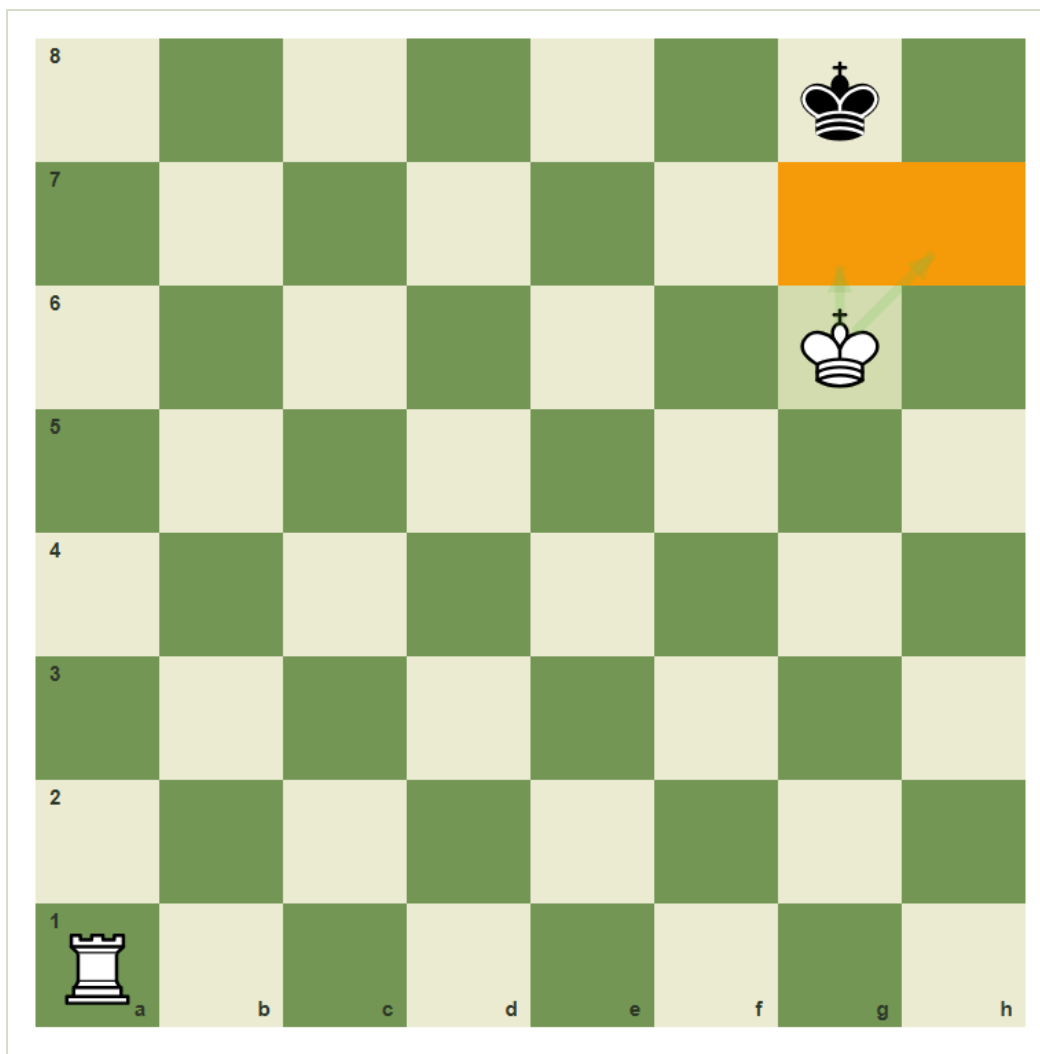
The queen can cut files and ranks while the king gives support.

The rook checks along a rank



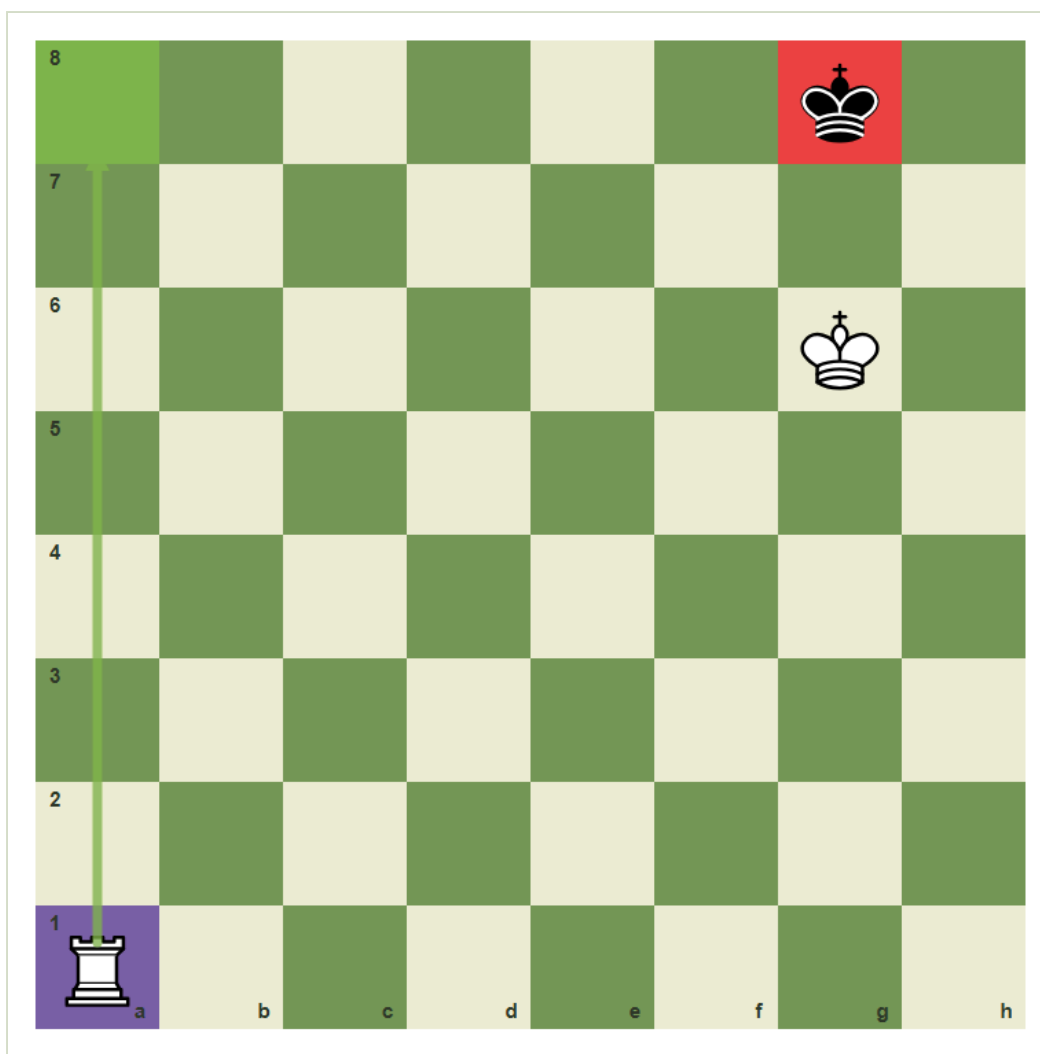
The rook can travel to a8 and check across the 8th rank.

The king takes escape squares



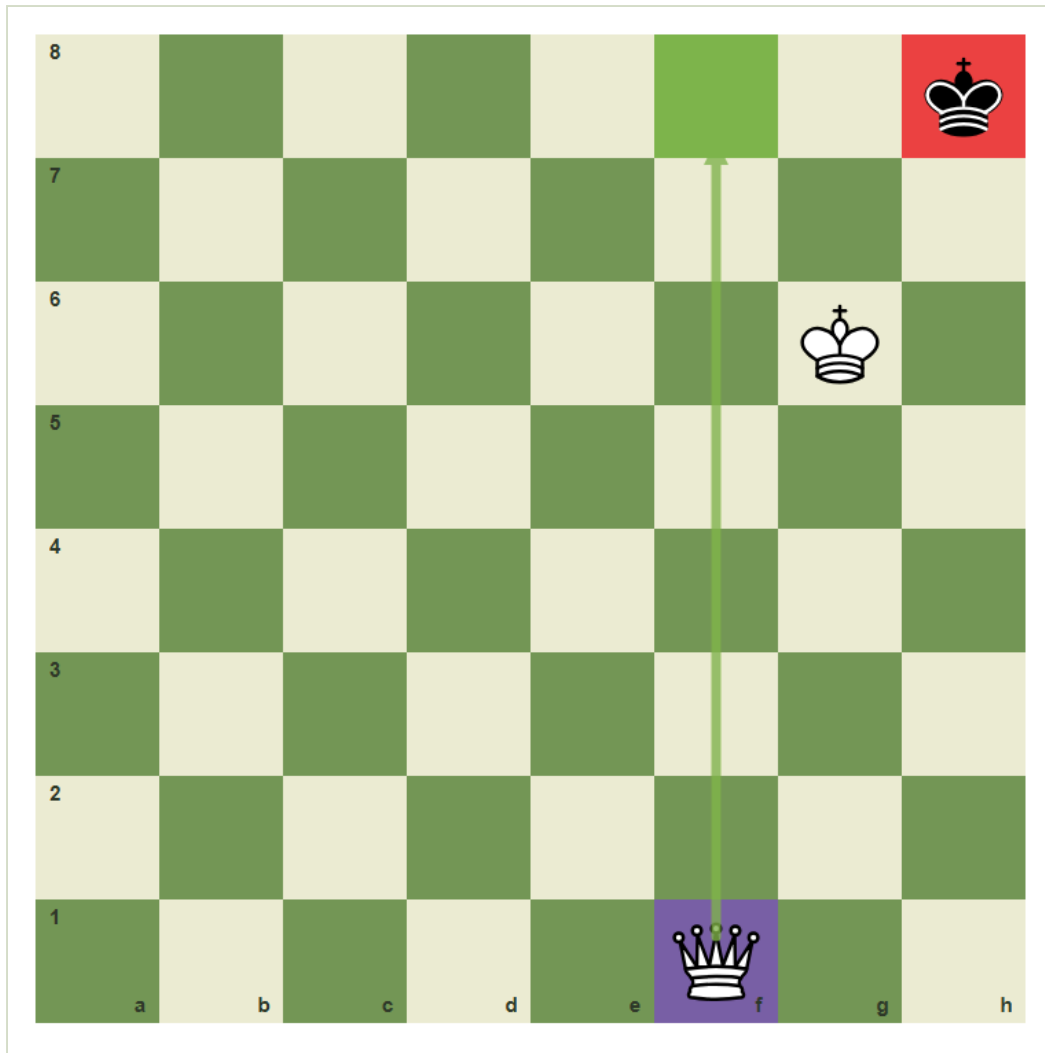
The king on g6 controls g7 and h7, so the enemy king has fewer exits.

Final rook mate pattern



Rook to a8 is the final checking move in this pattern.

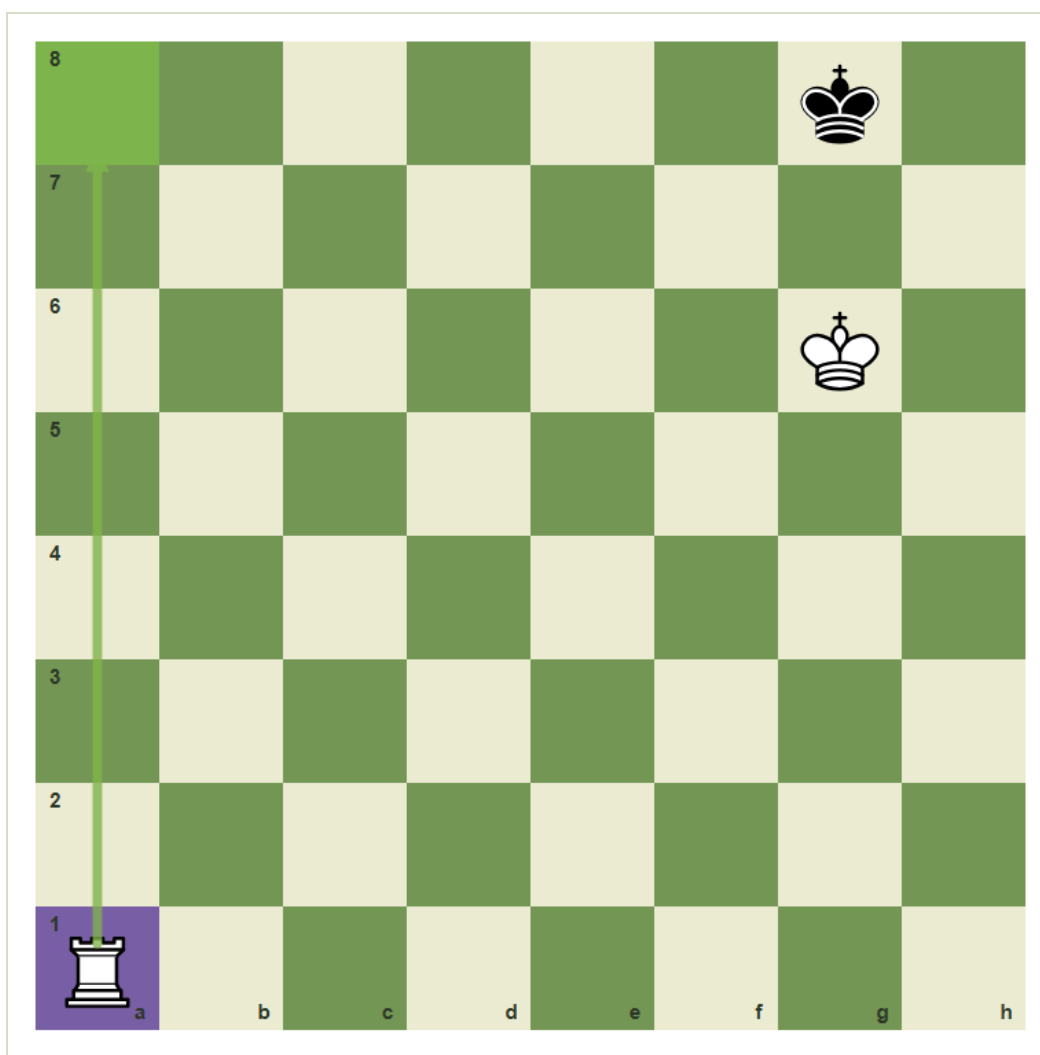
Queen mate uses the same idea



The queen should cut the king while your own king guards escape.

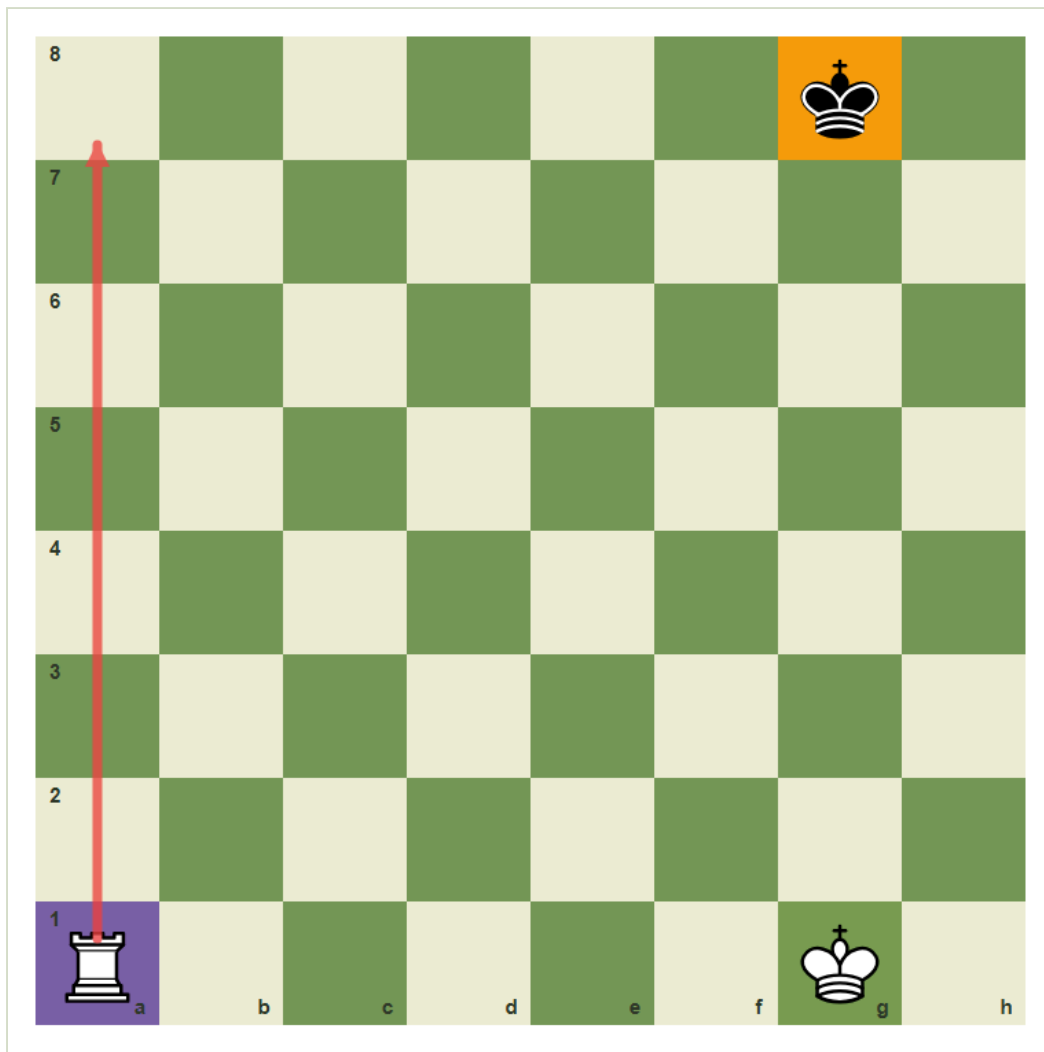
Deliver rook mate

Move the rook from a1 to a8.



Common mistake: check without a box

Random checks let the king run. First make a box and bring support.



The rook checks, but the white king is too far to control escape squares.

Chapter Checkpoint

Queen and rook mates usually need:

Queen and rook mates usually need:

- a. A box and king support
- b. Only random checks
- c. No king

The final mating move must give:

The final mating move must give:

- a. Check
- b. A draw offer
- c. A pawn value

Your king helps mate by:

Your king helps mate by:

- a. Controlling escape squares
- b. Standing far away forever
- c. Leaving the board

Avoiding Stalemate

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Do not turn a win into a draw.

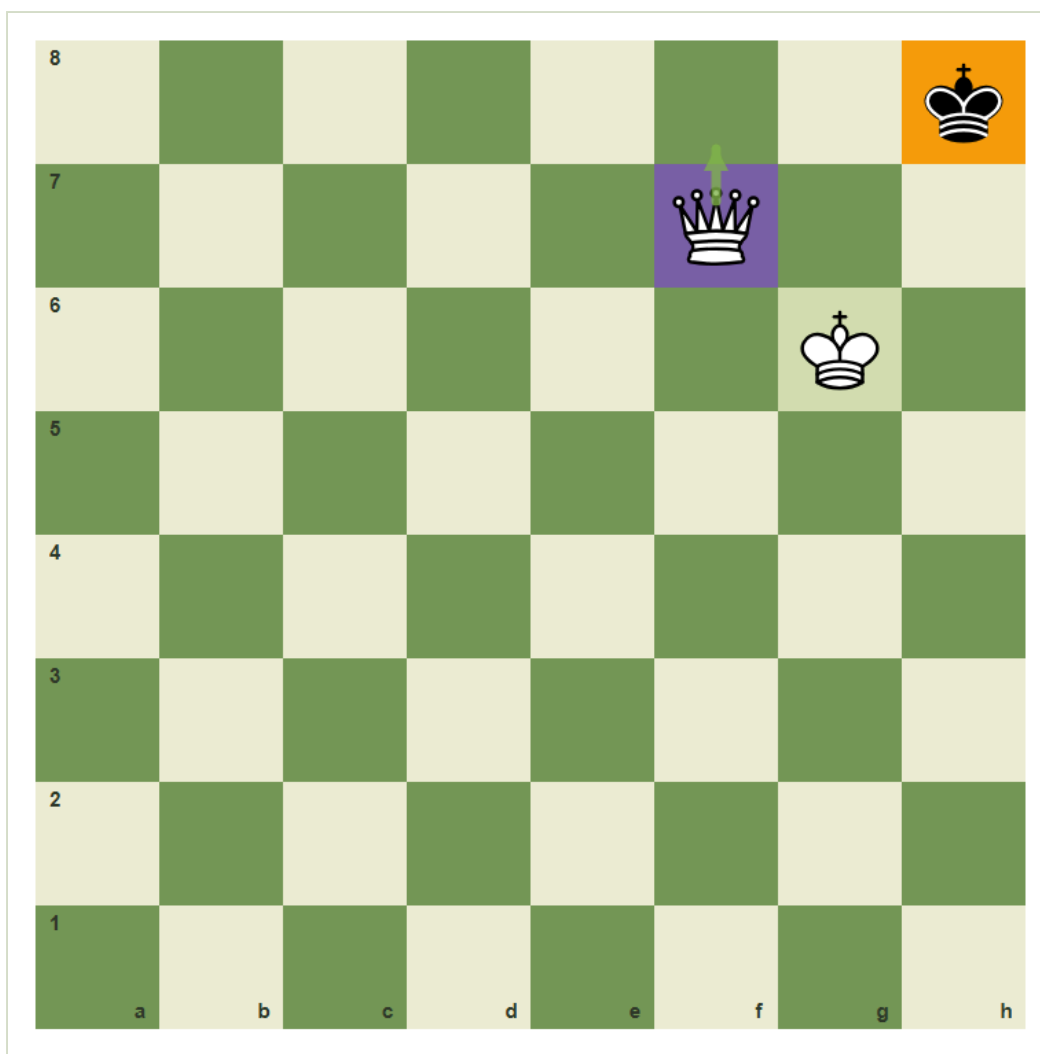
Learning objectives

- Recognize stalemate danger.
- Prefer checking moves in winning king hunts.
- Leave the defender legal moves until mate is ready.

Winning Still Needs Care

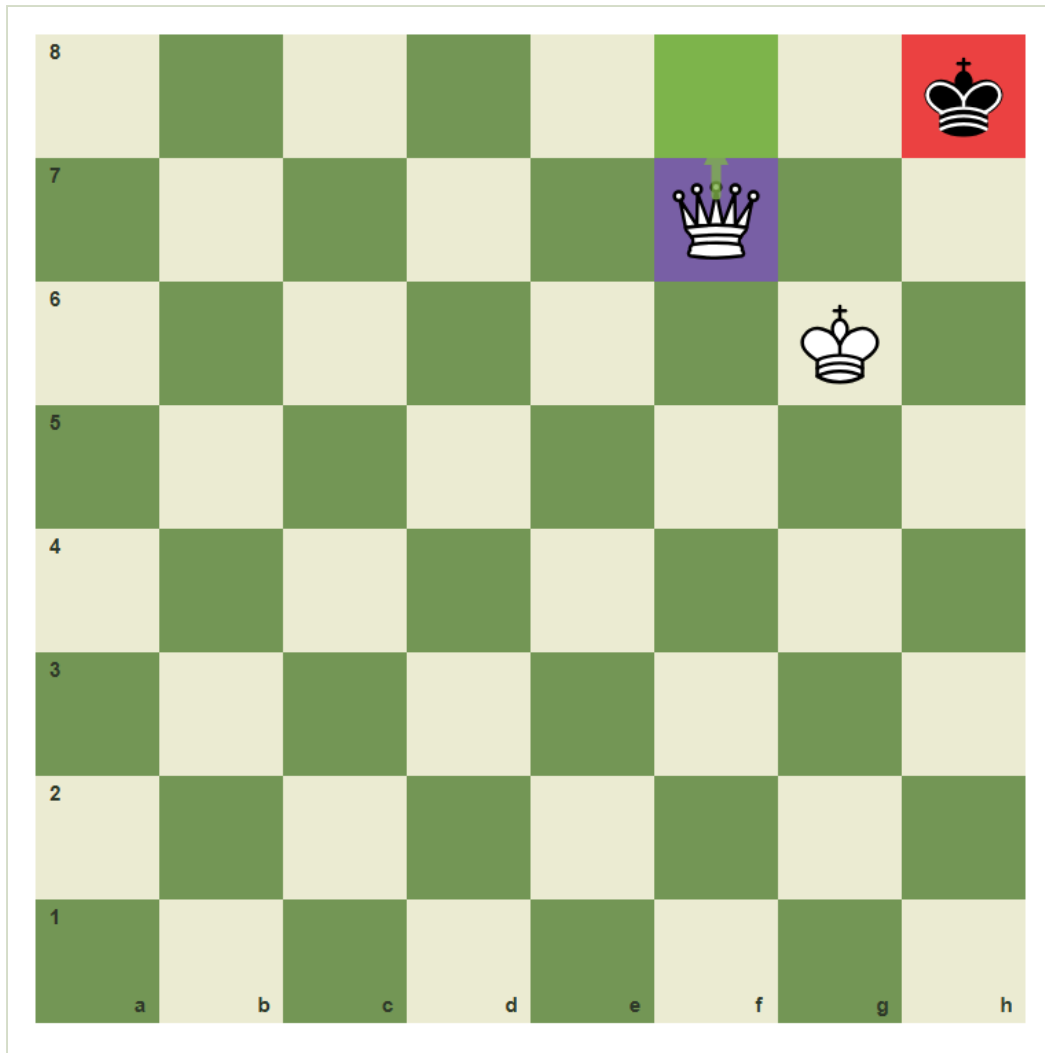
Stalemate happens when the side to move has no legal move but is not in check. Beginners often stalemate with a queen because they take every escape square without giving check.

The danger around h8



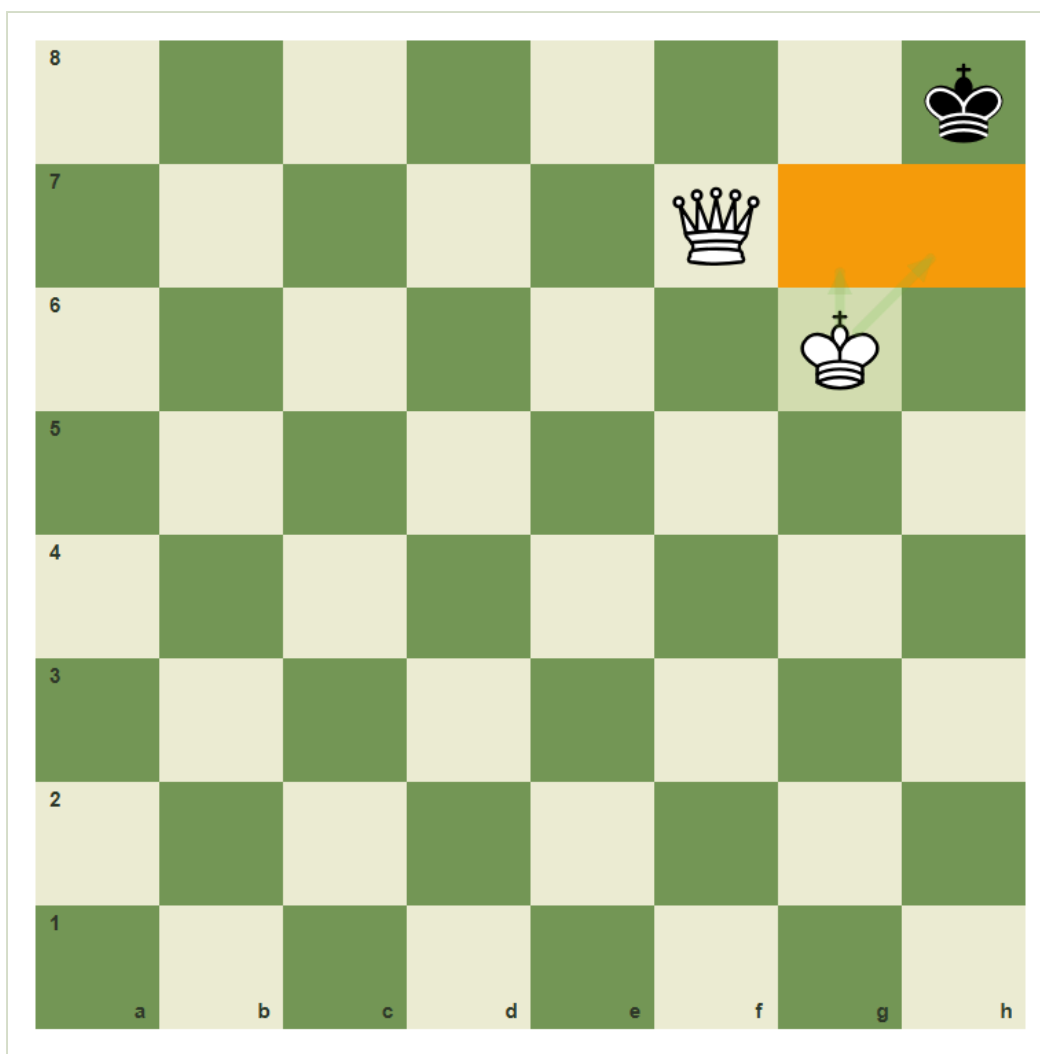
The black king has very little room. White must use checks carefully.

Give a checking move



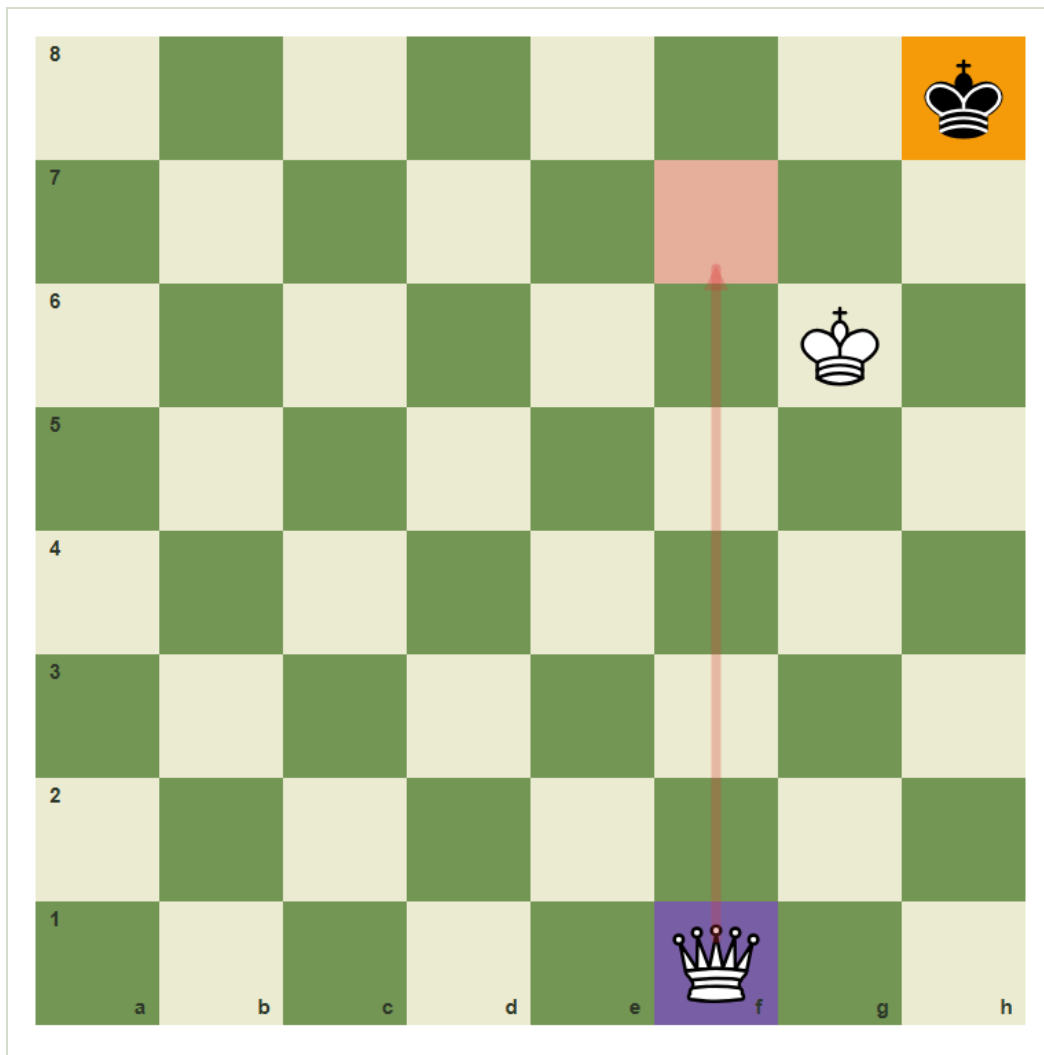
Queen f8 gives check instead of merely taking squares.

The king controls escape squares



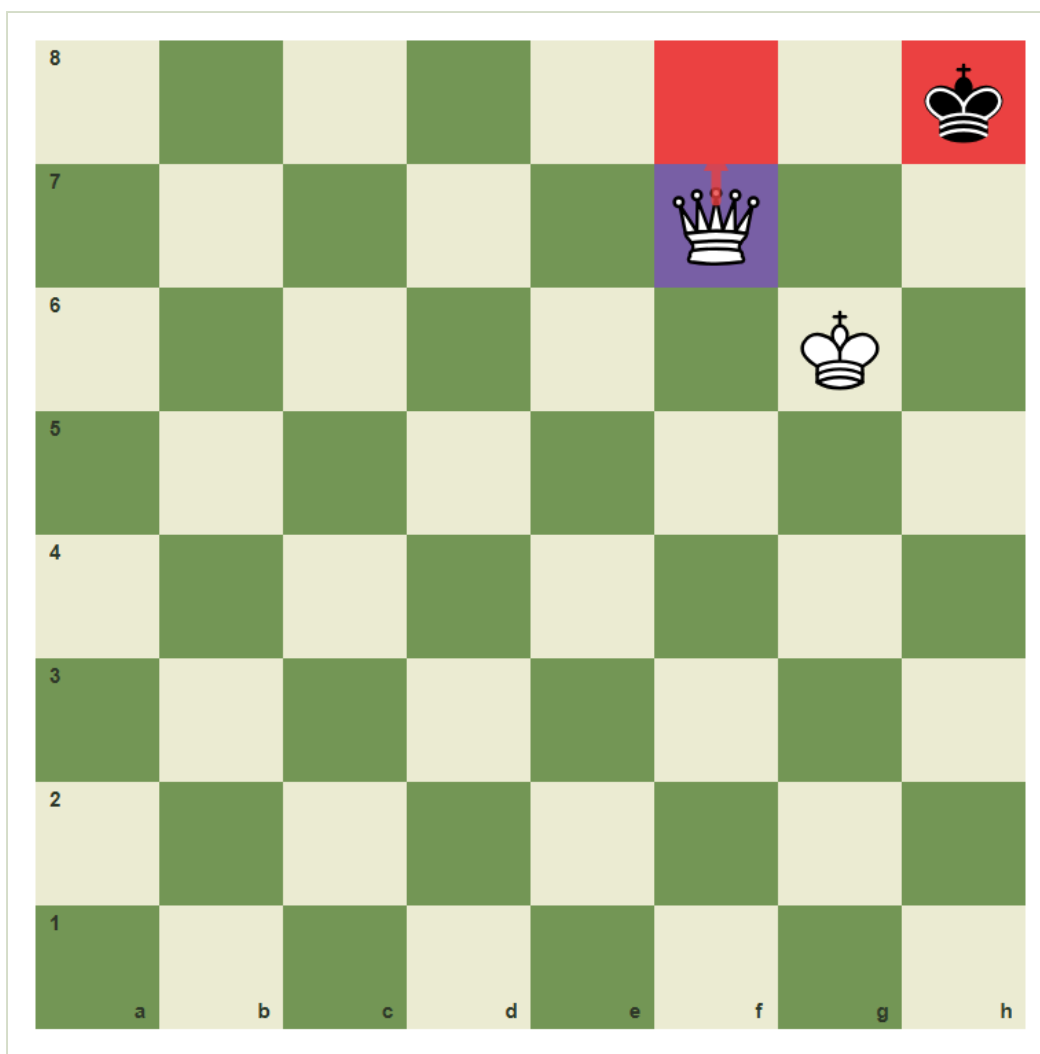
The white king on g6 controls h7 and g7.

A quiet squeeze can stalemate



If you only take squares and do not check, you may give the defender no legal move.

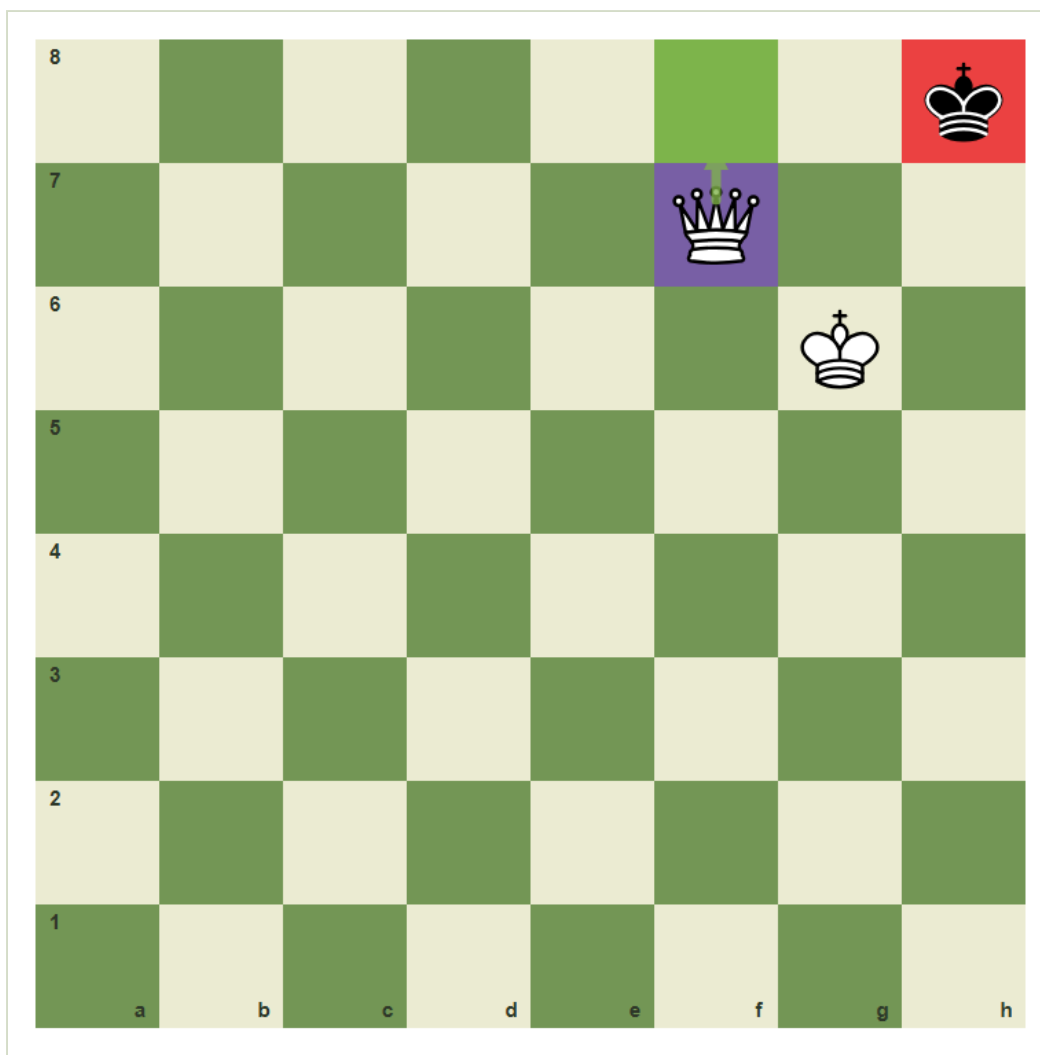
The survival rule: check before the box closes



When the enemy king is trapped, choose a move that gives check.

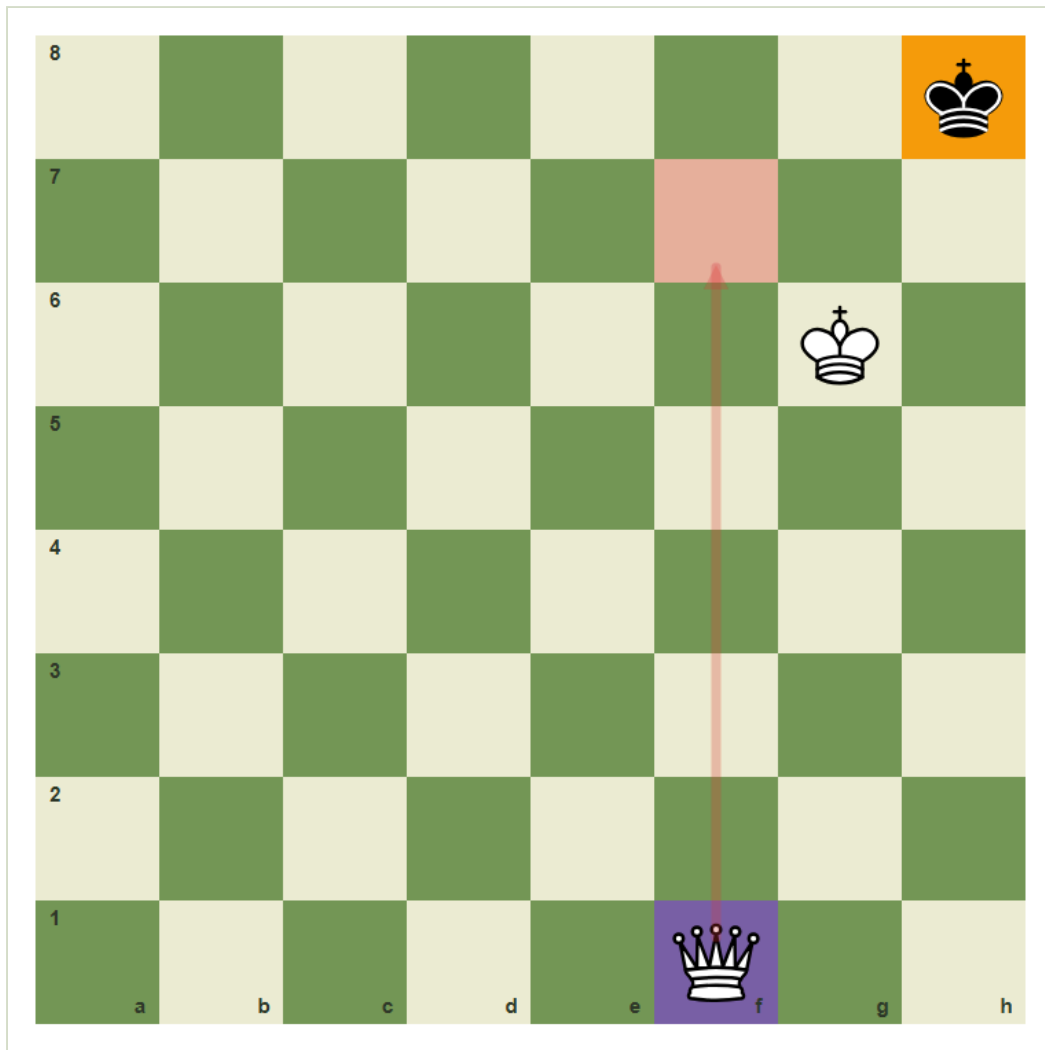
Avoid stalemate with check

Move the queen from f7 to f8.



Common mistake: squeeze without check

A quiet queen move can remove all moves without checking. In a won ending, ask if the defender is in check.



The wrong arrow shows a queen move that focuses only on the box.

Chapter Checkpoint

Stalemate is:

Stalemate is:

- a. No legal moves and not in check
- b. Any checkmate
- c. A pawn trade

Near a trapped king, prefer moves that:

Near a trapped king, prefer moves that:

- a. Give check
- b. Only take squares quietly
- c. Lose the queen

Stalemate makes a won game become:

Stalemate makes a won game become:

- a. A draw
- b. A bigger win
- c. An illegal board

Opening Safety: Stop Moving The Same Piece

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Develop, protect the king, and avoid early queen adventures.

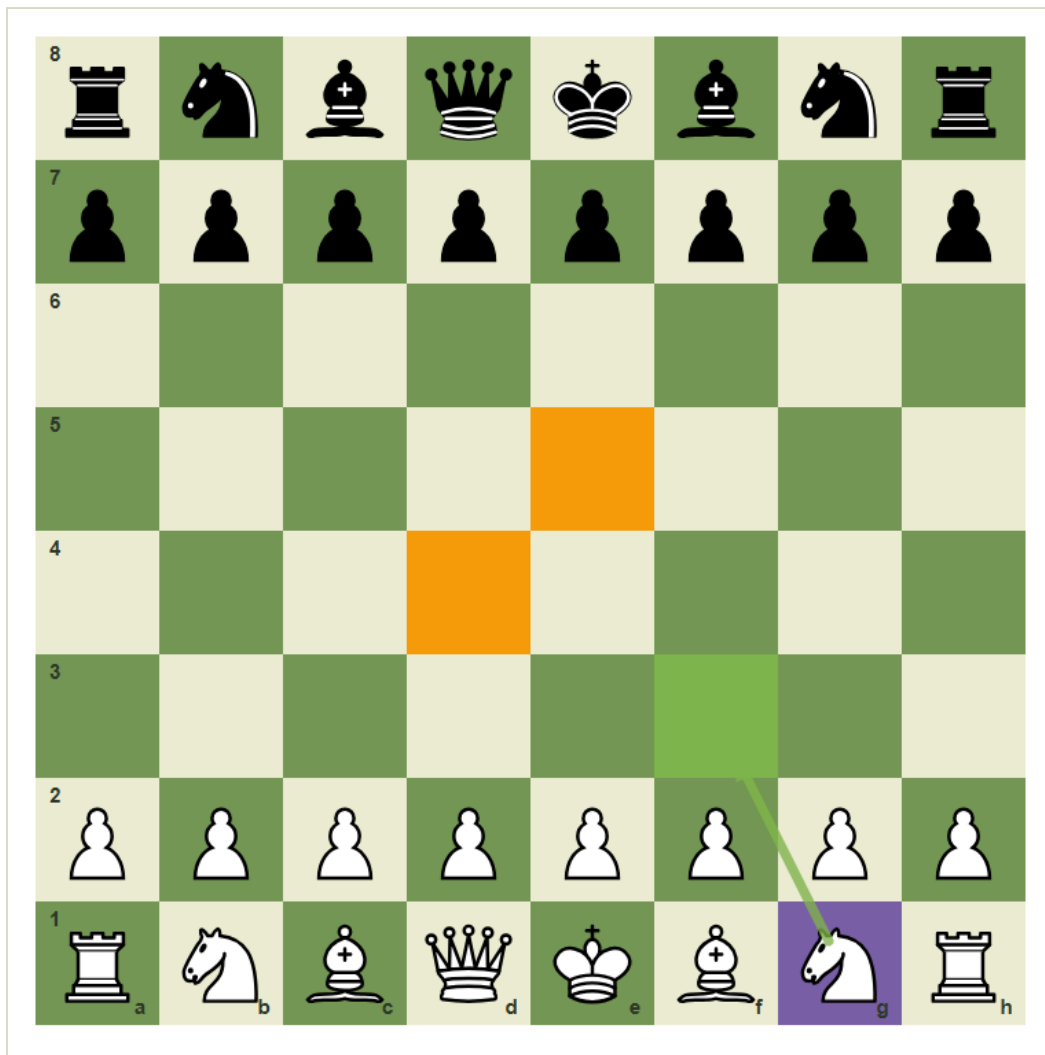
Learning objectives

- Develop pieces toward useful squares.
- Avoid moving one piece repeatedly without reason.
- Recognize why early queen moves can lose time.

Do Not Lose Before The Game Starts

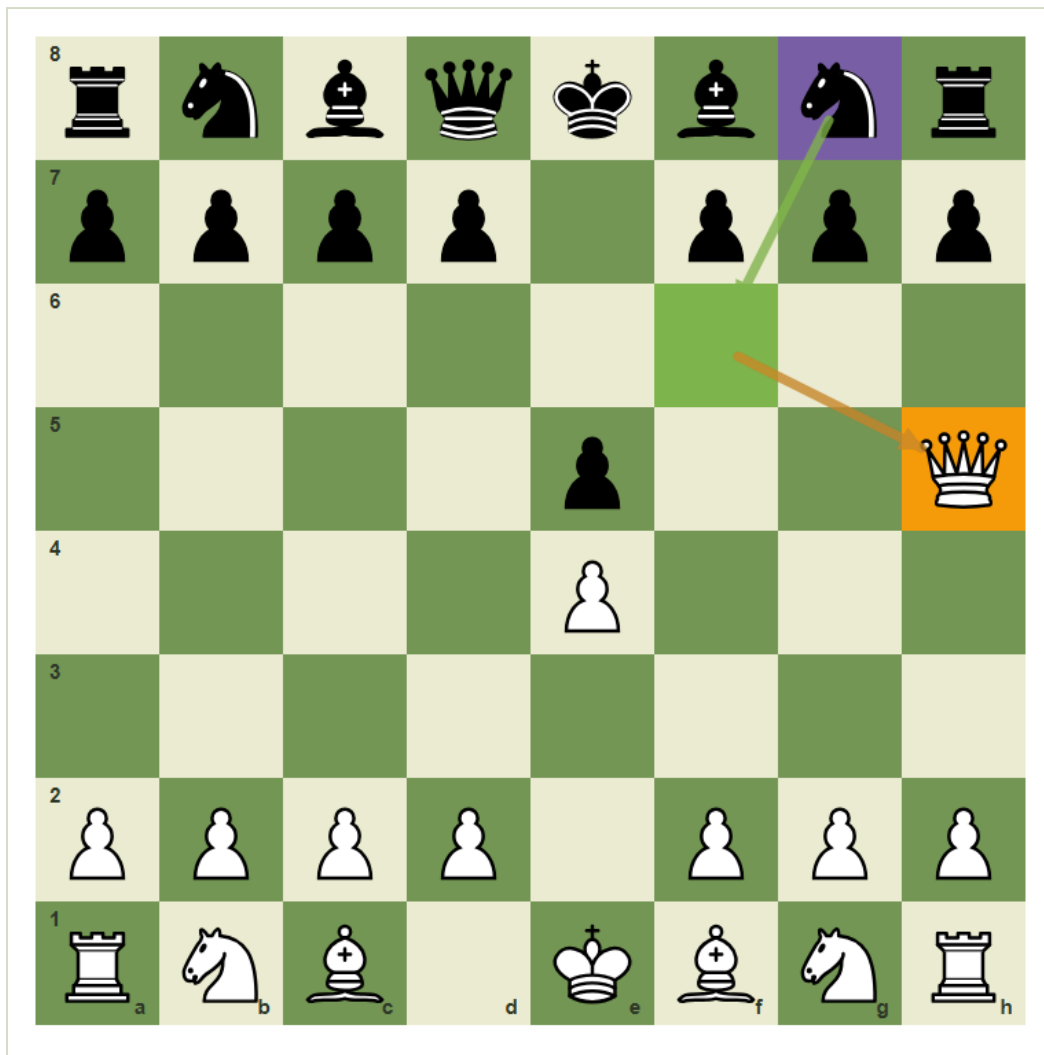
Opening survival is simple: control the center, develop pieces, protect the king, and do not chase tricks with the same piece again and again.

Develop toward the center



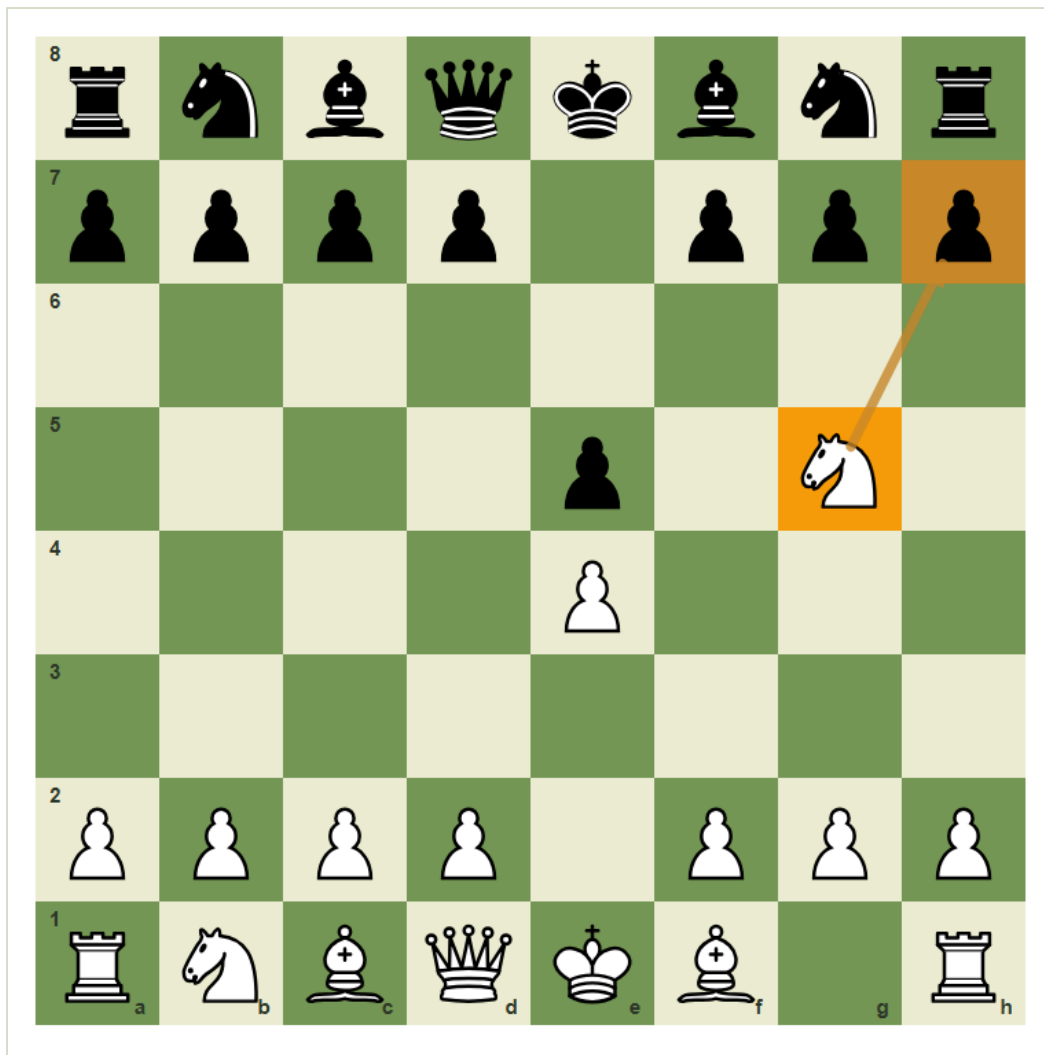
The knight move g1-f3 helps control central squares.

Early queen moves invite tempo



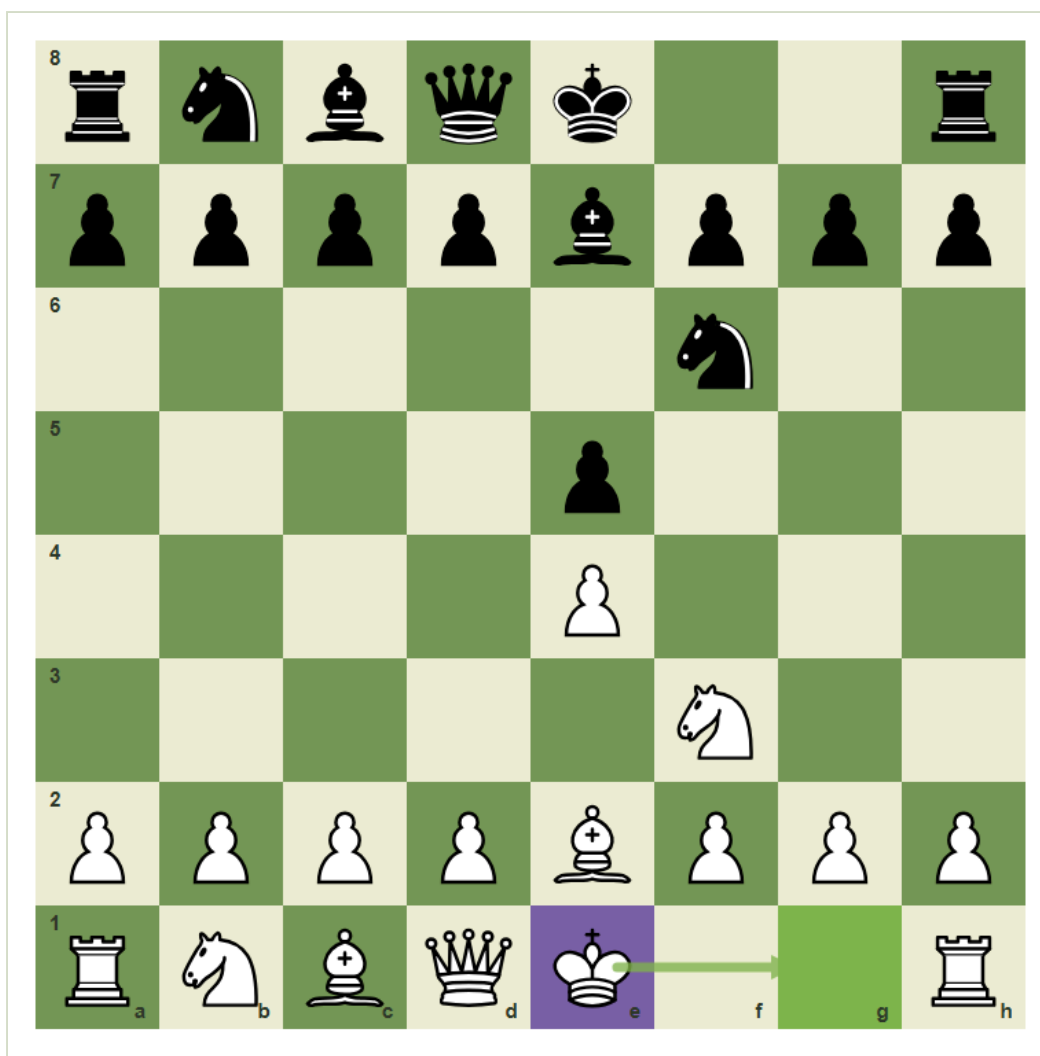
The queen on h5 can be attacked by a developing knight.

Moving one piece repeatedly costs time



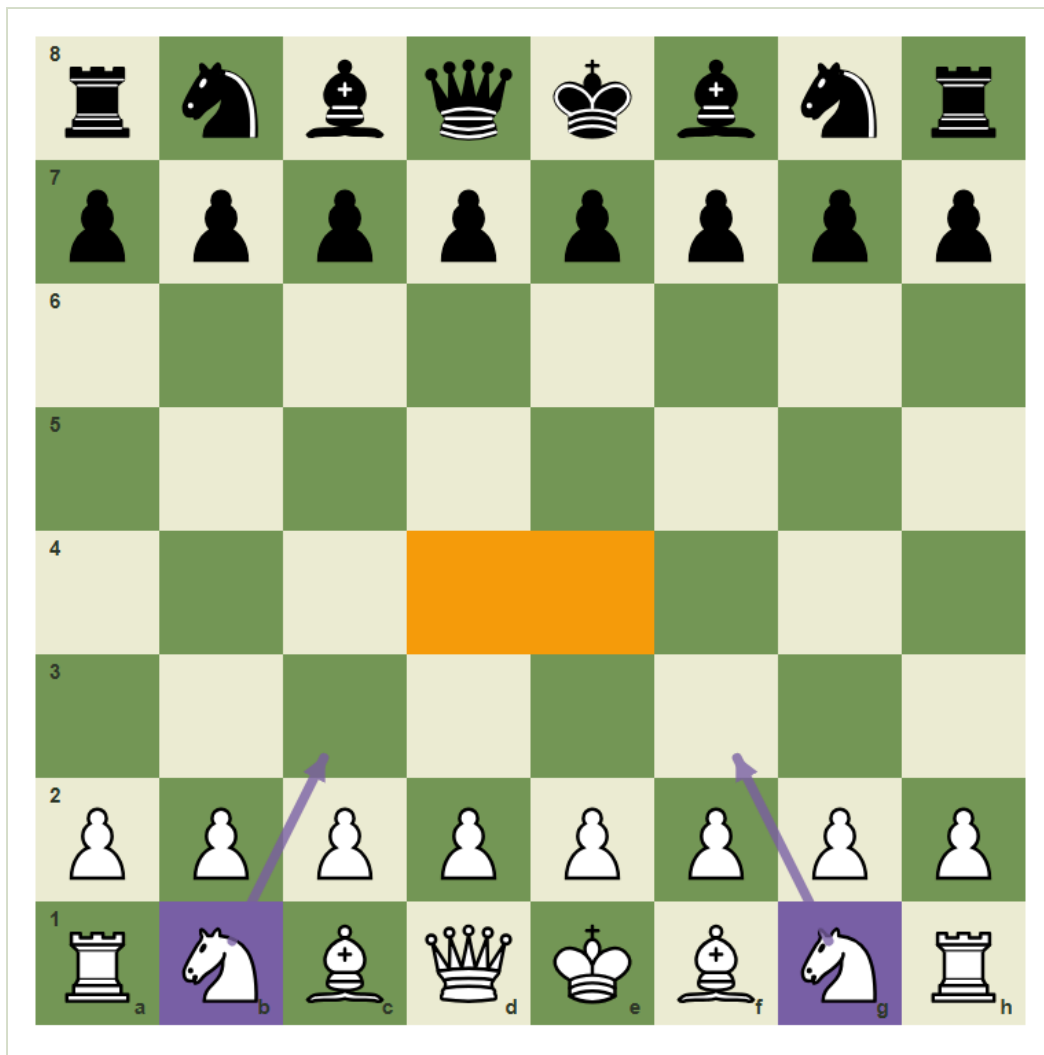
The knight on g5 moved early and can become a target.

King safety is part of development



When the path is clear and safe, castling protects the king.

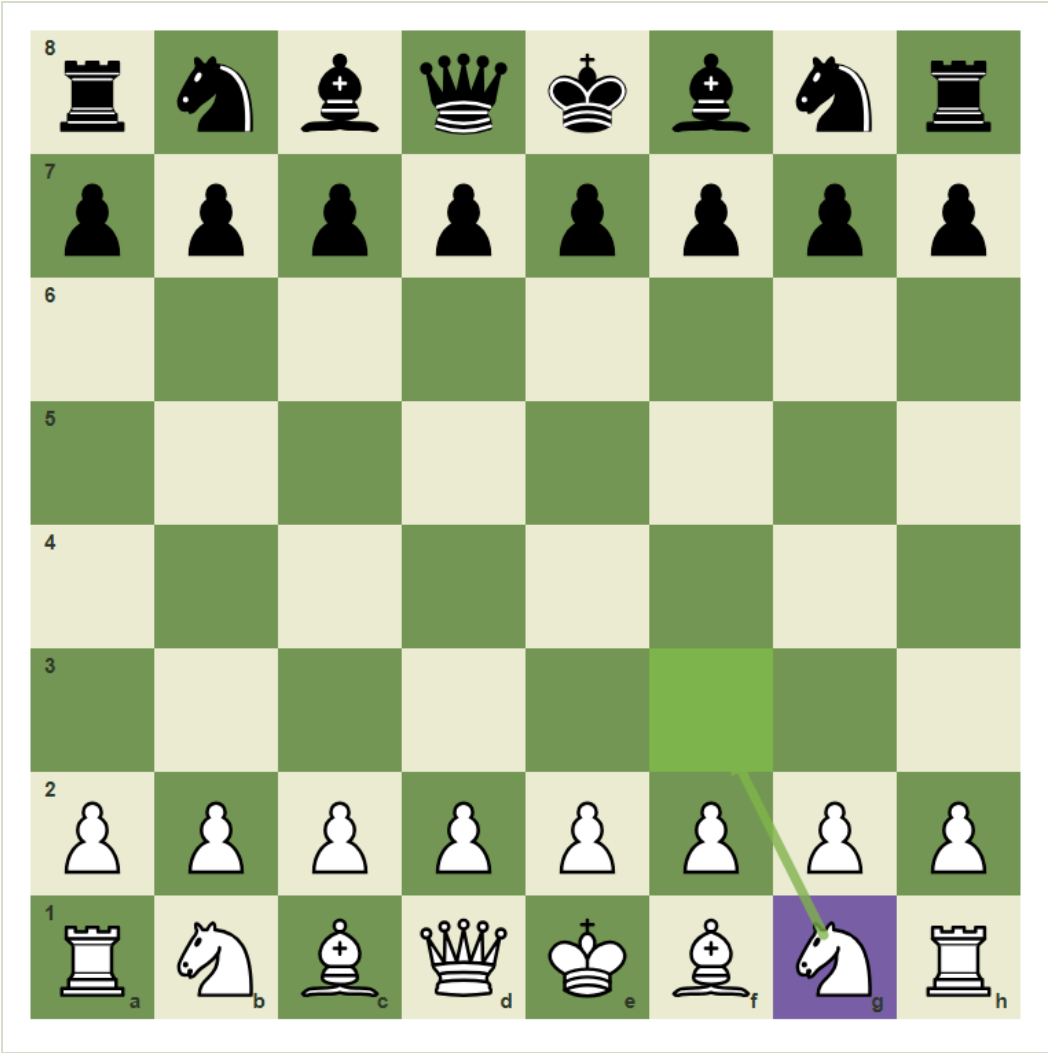
The opening safety checklist



Center, development, king safety. These three ideas beat most beginner opening traps.

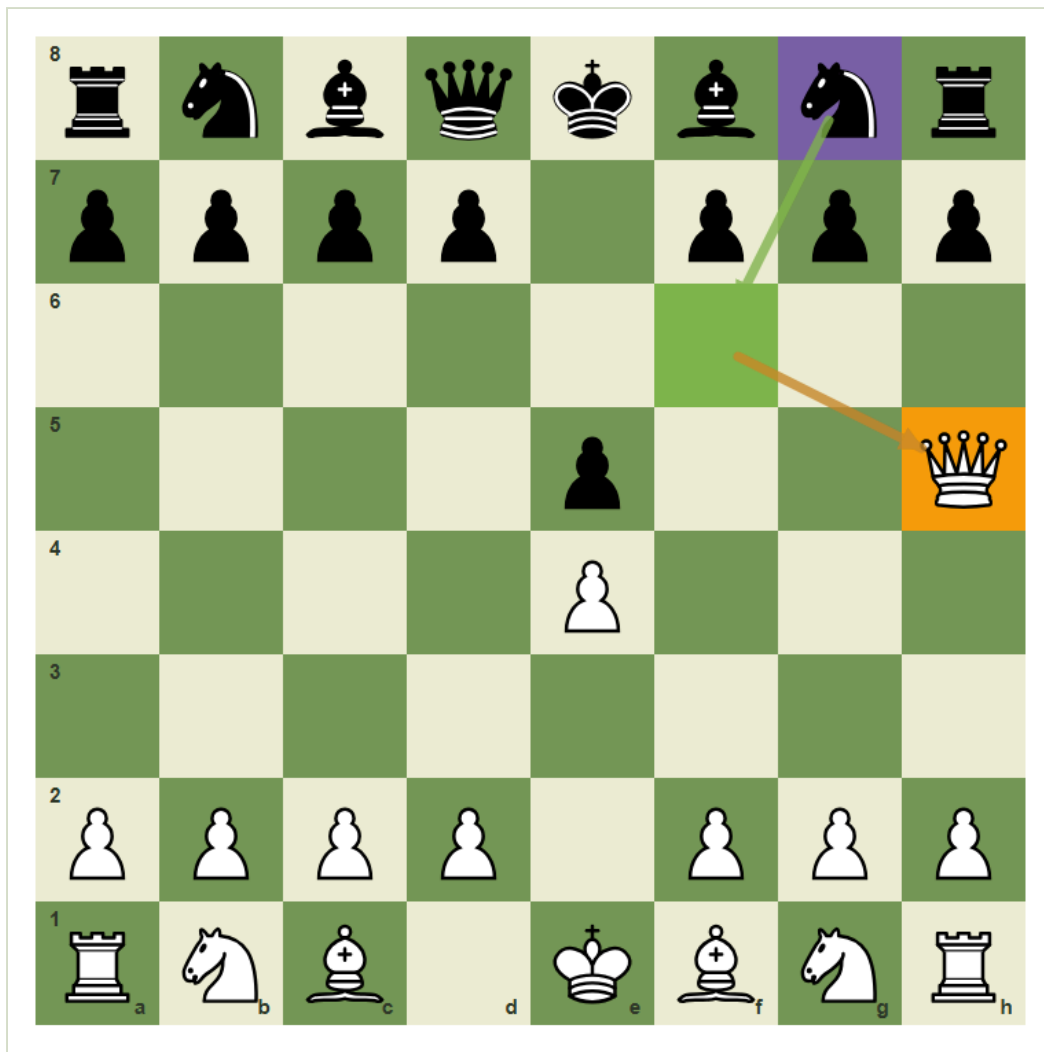
Play a safe developing move

Develop the knight from g1 to f3.



Common mistake: bring the queen out too early

If your queen becomes a target, the opponent develops while attacking it.



The knight move g8-f6 attacks h5 with tempo.

Chapter Checkpoint

A safe opening move often:

A safe opening move often:

- a. Develops a piece
- b. Moves the same piece for no reason
- c. Hangs the queen

Early queen moves can lose:

Early queen moves can lose:

- a. Time
- b. The board colors
- c. All legal moves immediately

Opening survival includes:

Opening survival includes:

- a. Center, development, king safety
- b. Only pawn hunting
- c. Never castling

Blunder-Check Before Every Move

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Pause once before the move leaves your hand.

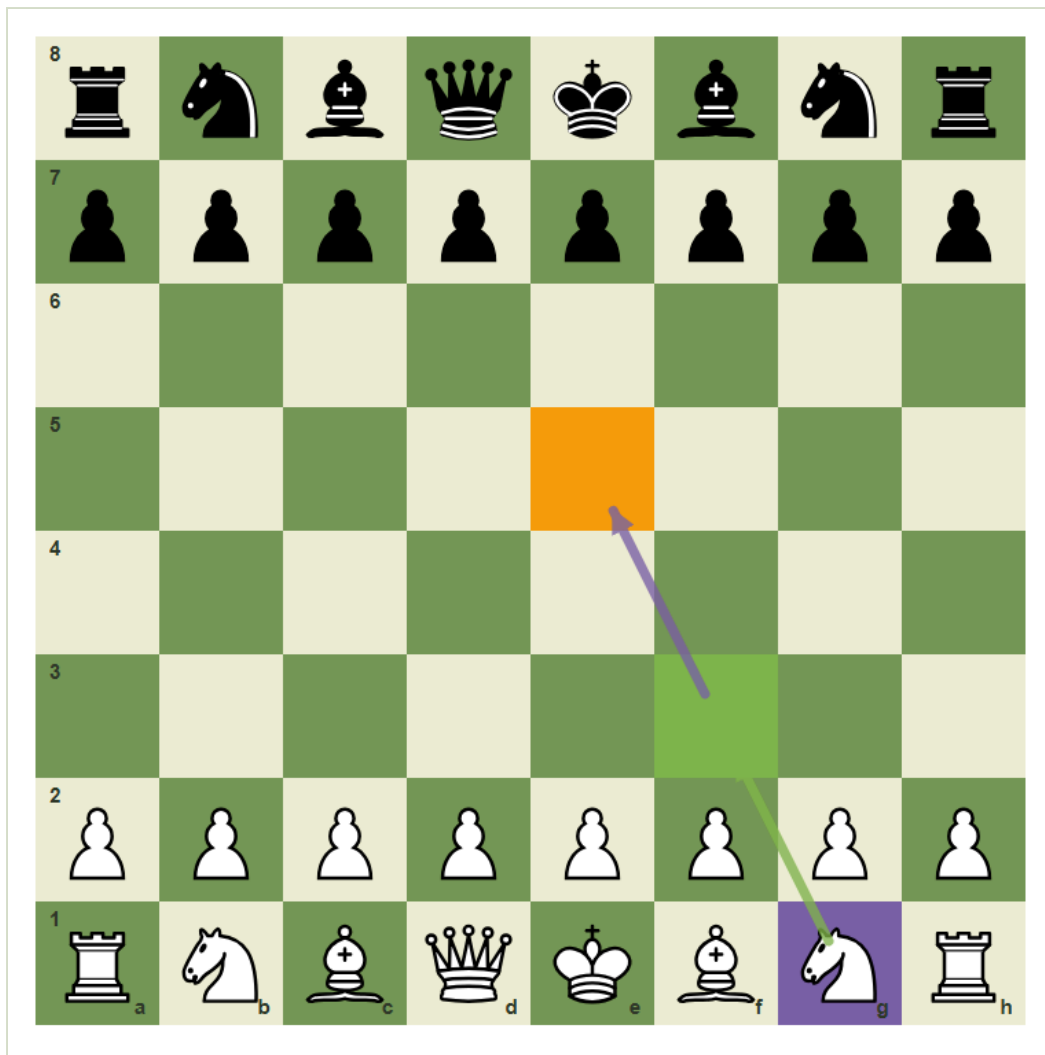
Learning objectives

- Ask what your move leaves behind.
- Check whether your moved piece becomes loose.
- Notice immediate checks and captures against you.

The One-Second Pause

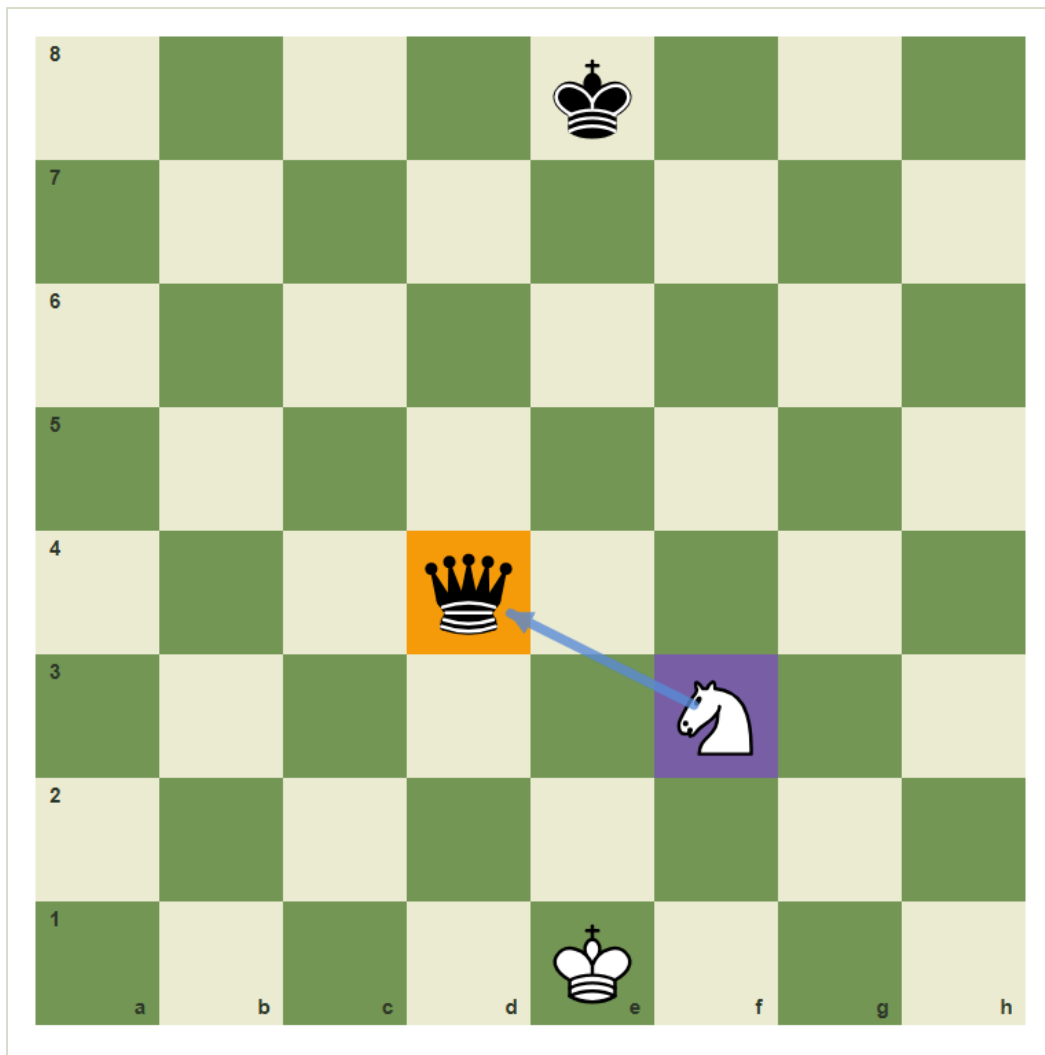
A blunder-check is the final pause before moving. Ask: after my move, what can my opponent check, capture, or threaten?

Develop with a final check



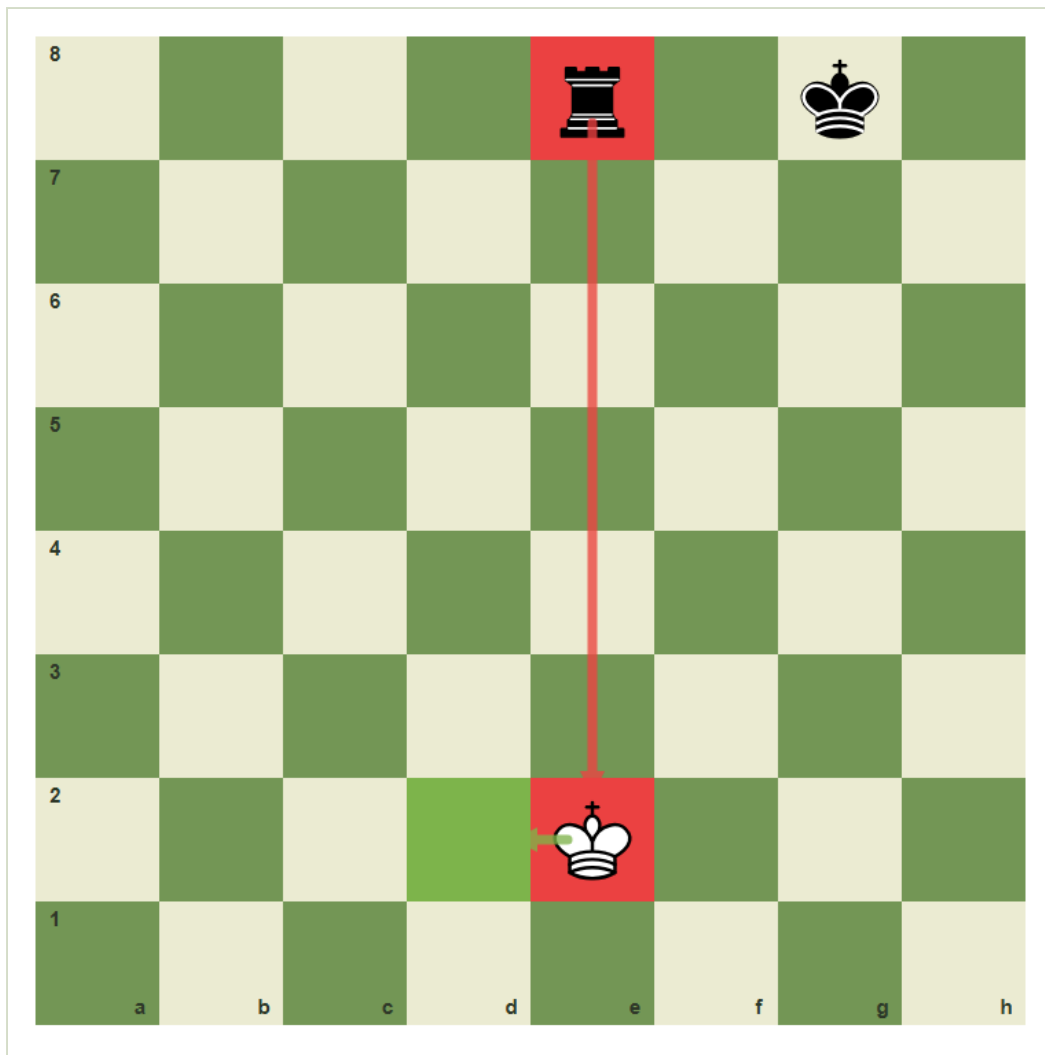
Before g1-f3, notice that the knight lands on a protected, useful square.

Do not leave the queen loose



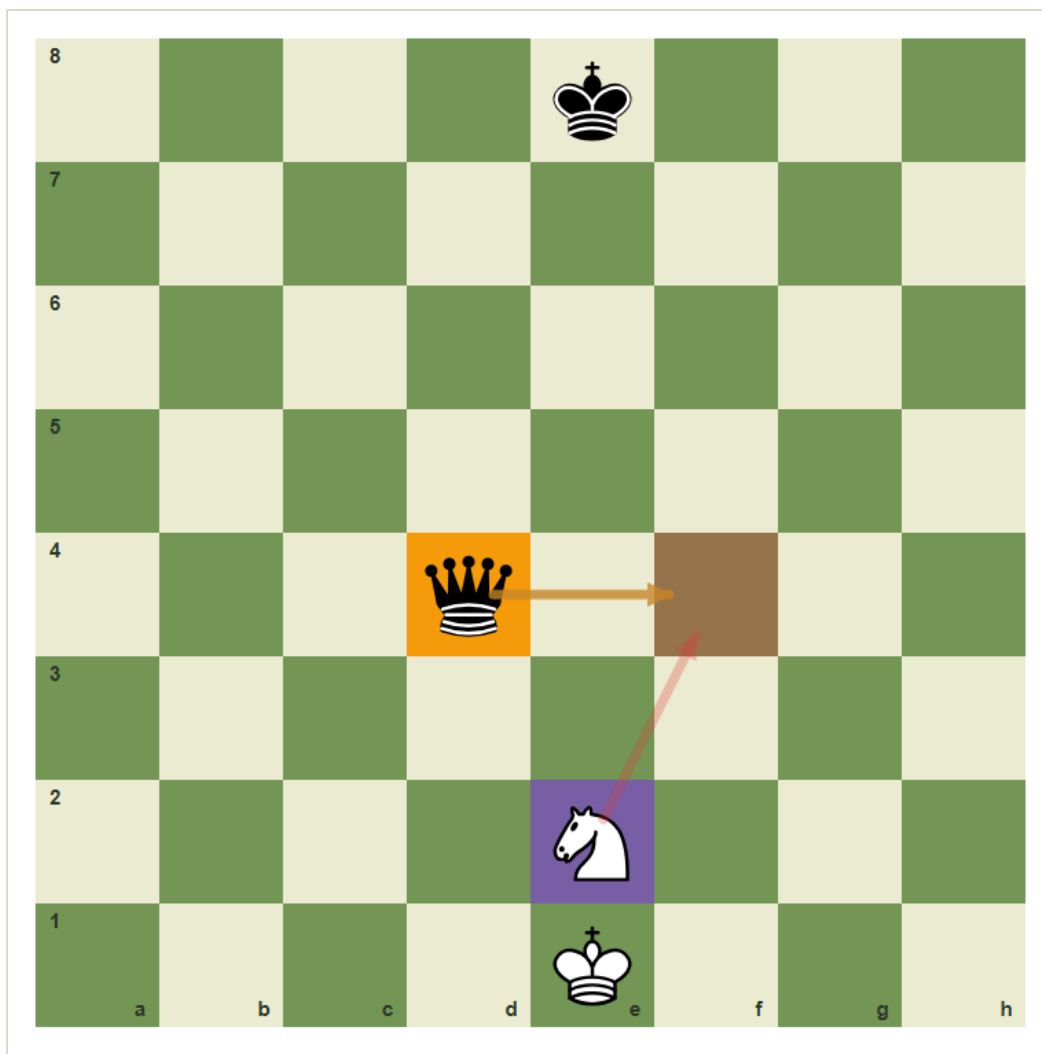
The queen on d4 is attacked. If it were your queen, you must notice it.

Check danger overrides plans



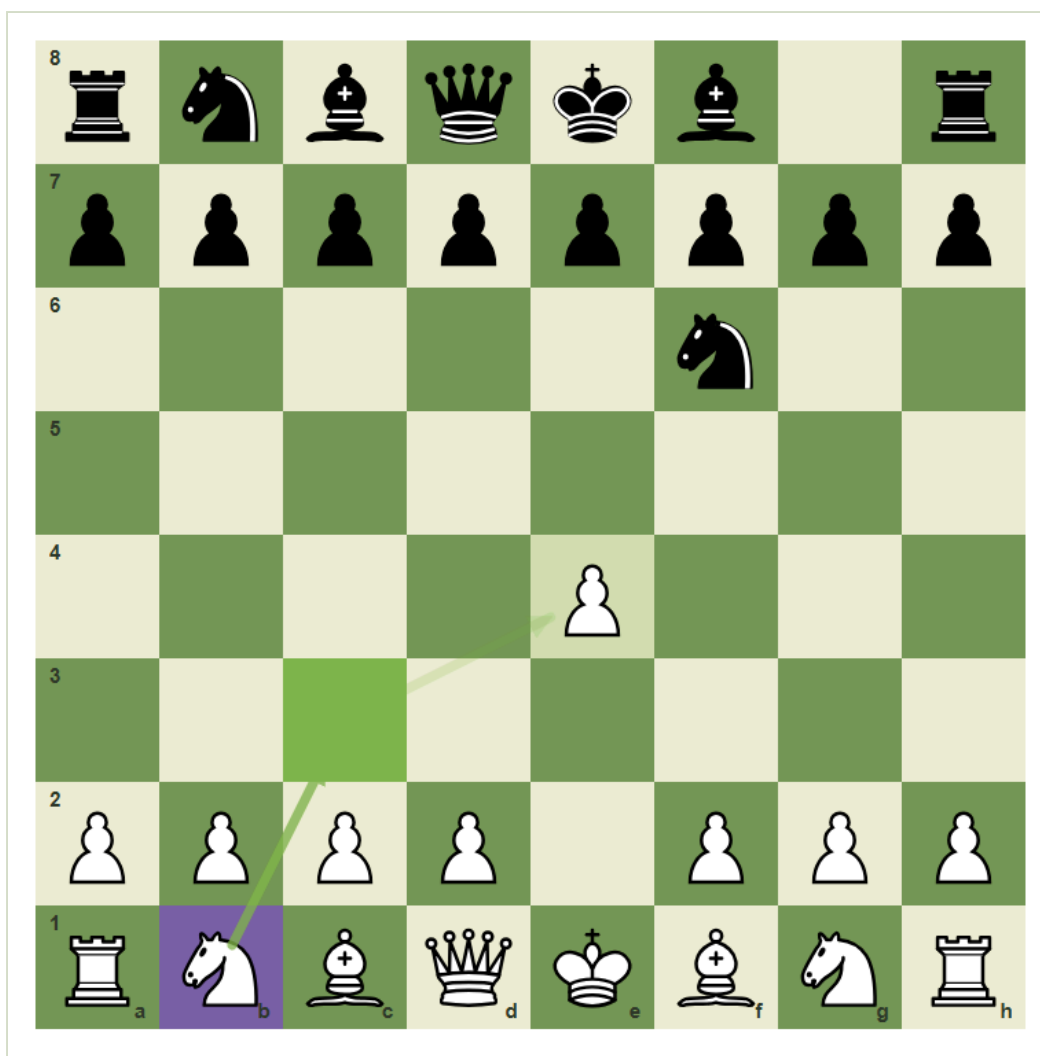
If your king is checked, the blunder-check has already found the emergency.

Your moved piece can become loose



A piece that moves into attack can become the new target.

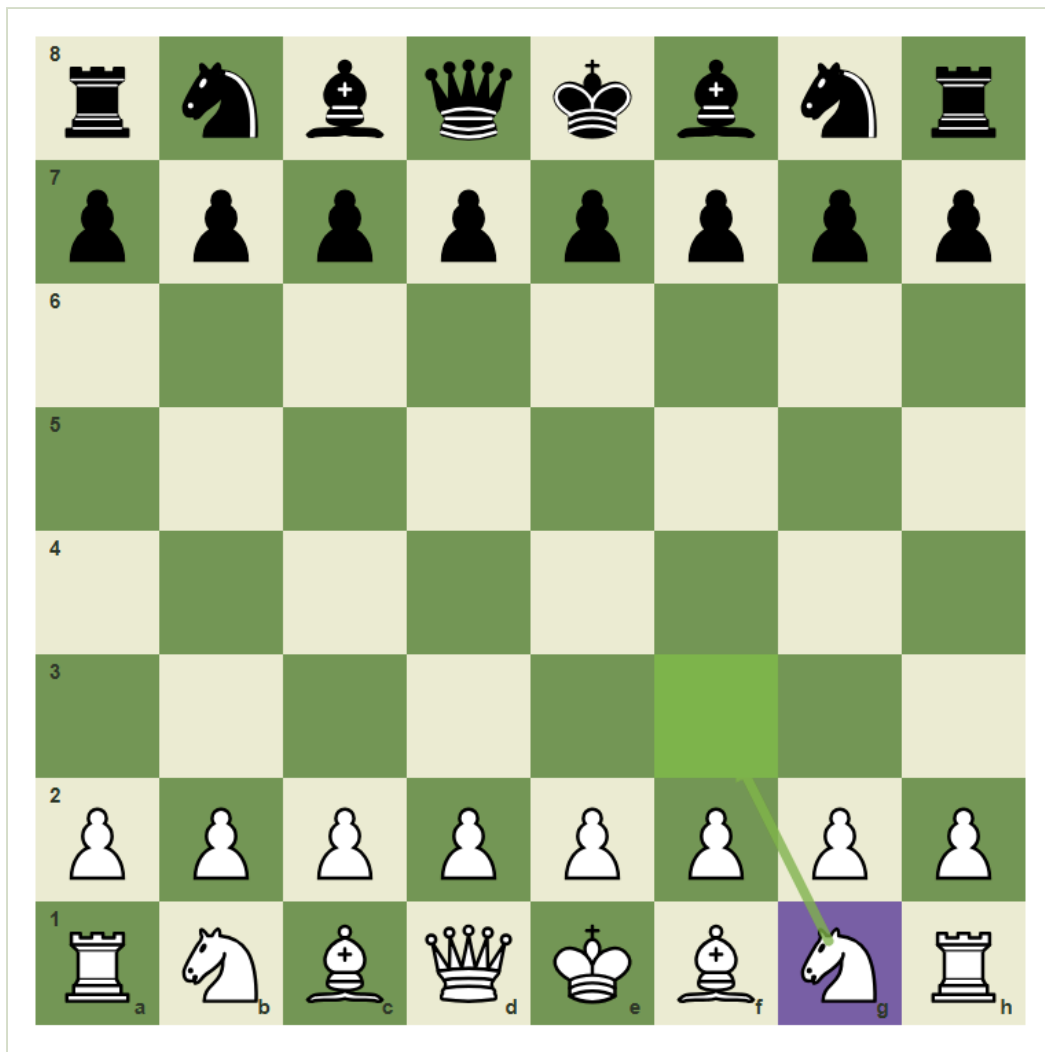
A safe move passes the scan



The move b1-c3 develops and helps e4, so it passes the scan.

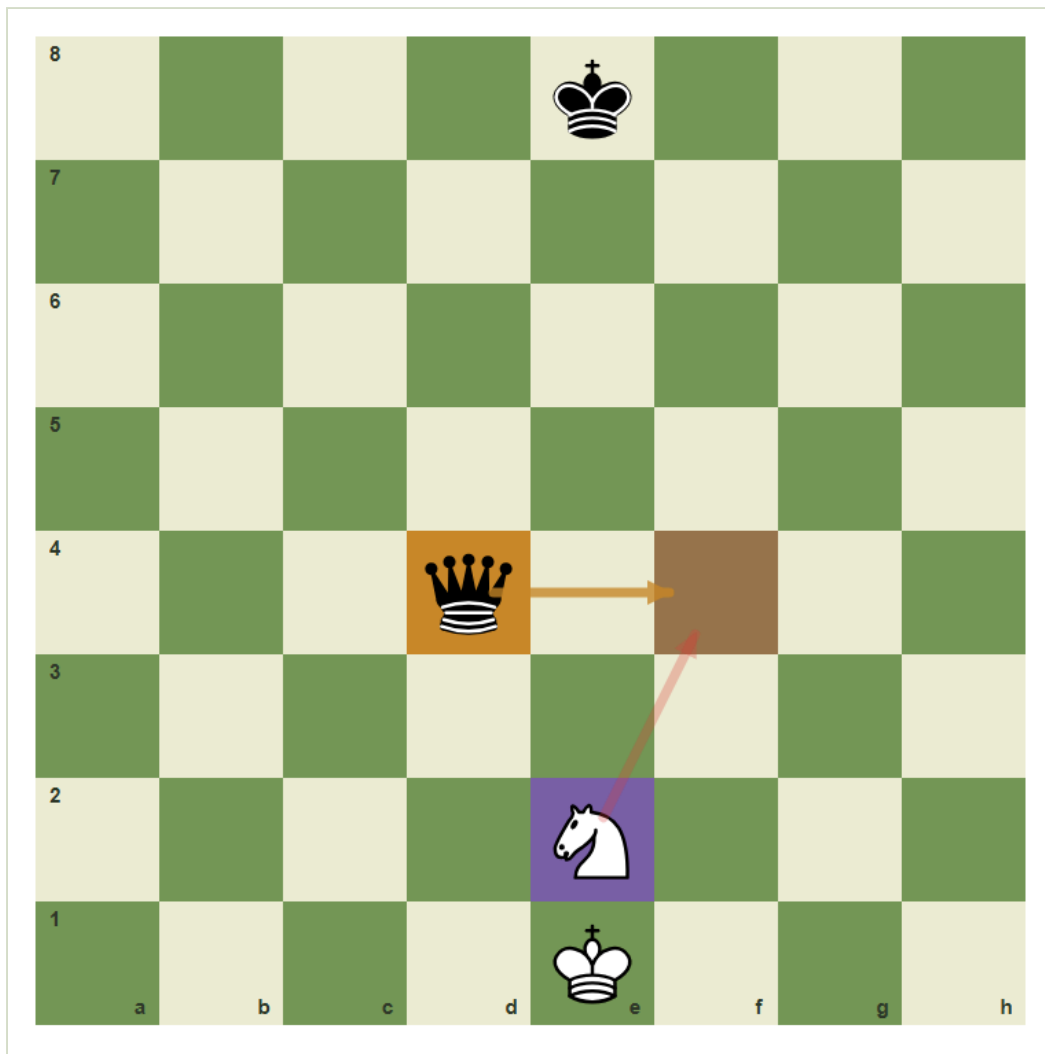
Make a move that passes the scan

Play g1 to f3 after checking that the piece lands safely.



Common mistake: move without the final pause

A fast move can walk into a simple capture. Slow chess is stronger chess.



The wrong square f4 is marked because it walks into the queen attack.

Chapter Checkpoint

A blunder-check asks what the opponent can:

A blunder-check asks what the opponent can:

- a. Check, capture, or threaten
- b. Eat for lunch
- c. Rename the pieces

The best time for a blunder-check is:

The best time for a blunder-check is:

- a. Before releasing the move
- b. After losing the queen
- c. Only after checkmate

Fast moves are always stronger than checked moves.

Fast moves are always stronger than checked moves.

- a. True
- b. False

Ten Survival Games: Find The Safe Move

Survival Chess | 300-700 | free

Apply the survival checklist in miniature game moments.

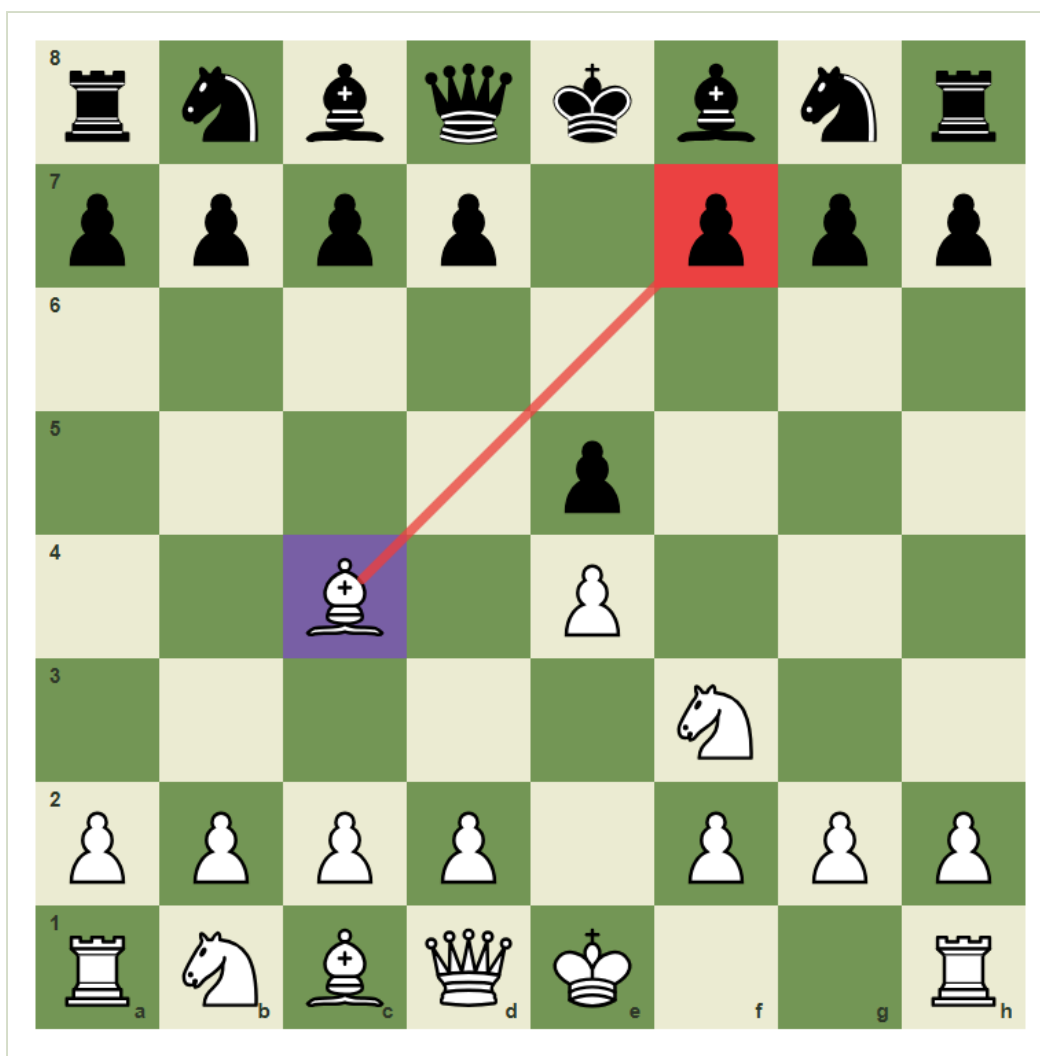
Learning objectives

- Use CCT in mixed positions.
- Choose safety over impulse.
- Convert advantages without stalemate or loose pieces.

Put The Habits Together

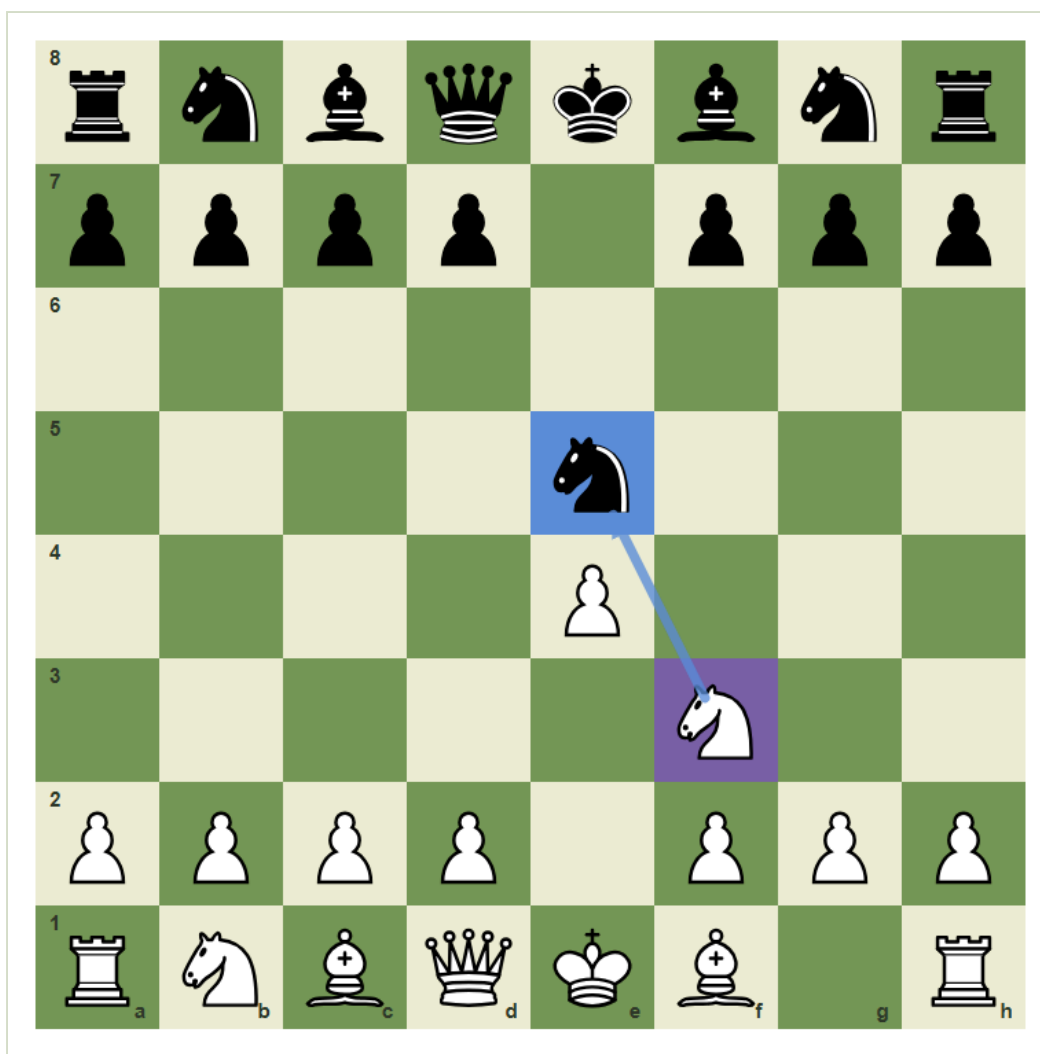
This final chapter mixes the whole book. Each position asks for the safest practical move, not the flashiest move.

Game moment: forcing check



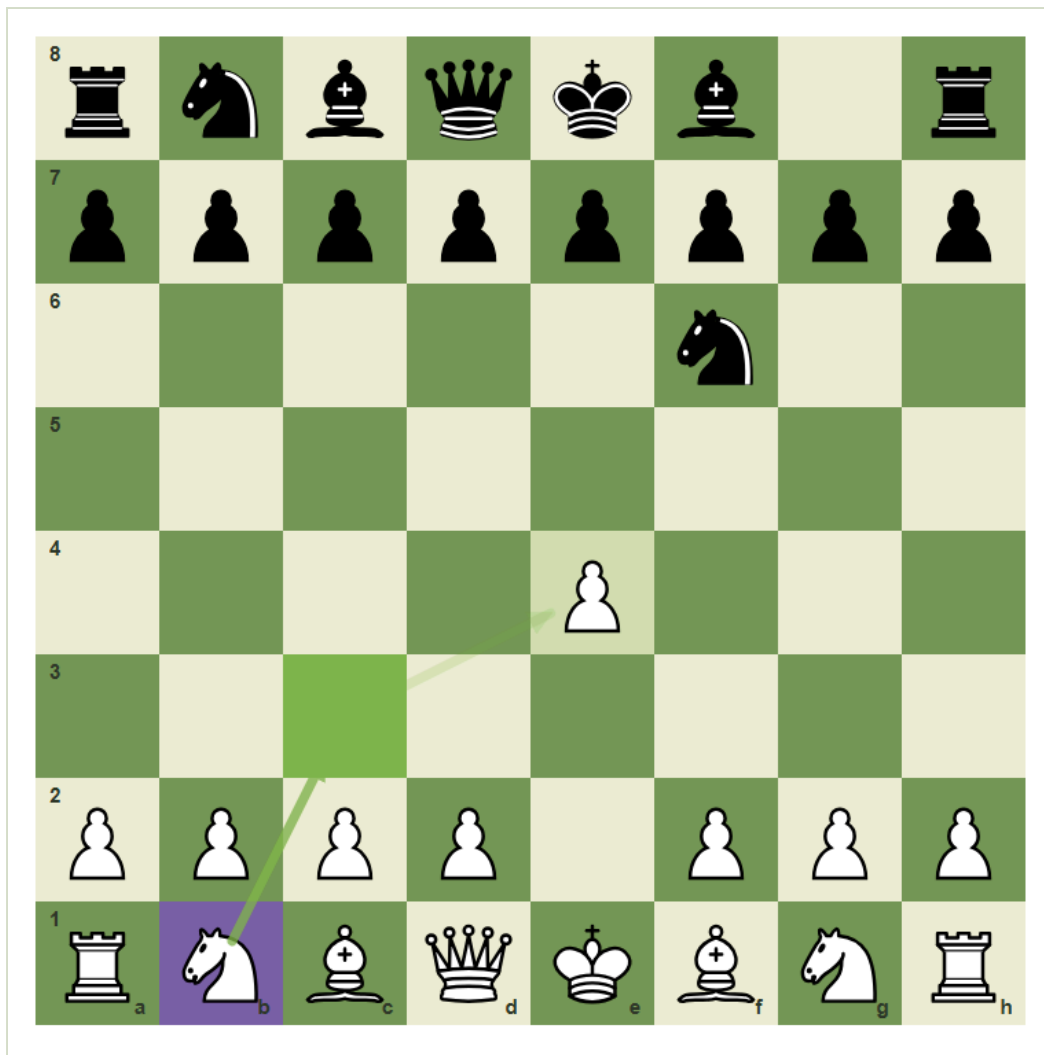
The CCT scan still begins with the check on f7.

Game moment: loose knight



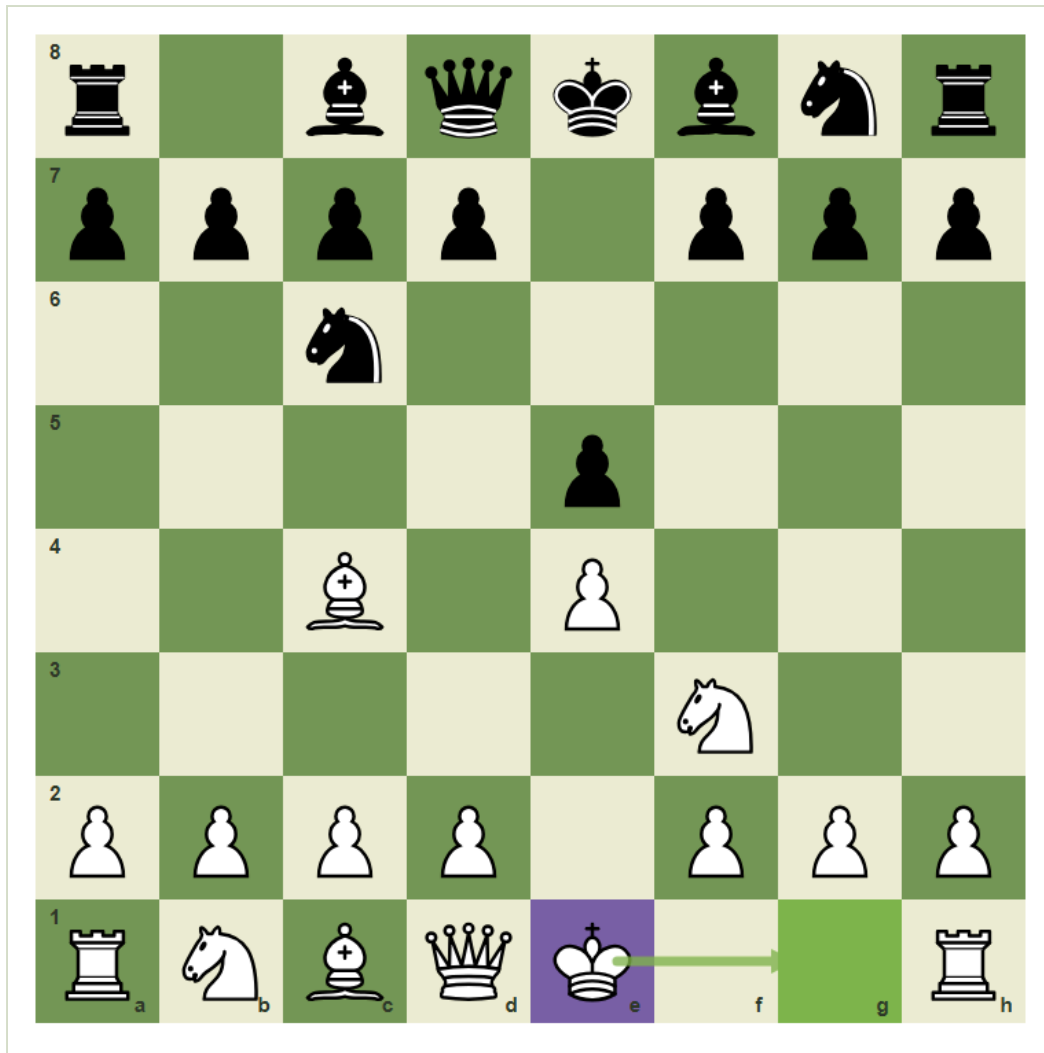
The knight on e5 can be captured after the scan.

Game moment: defend e4



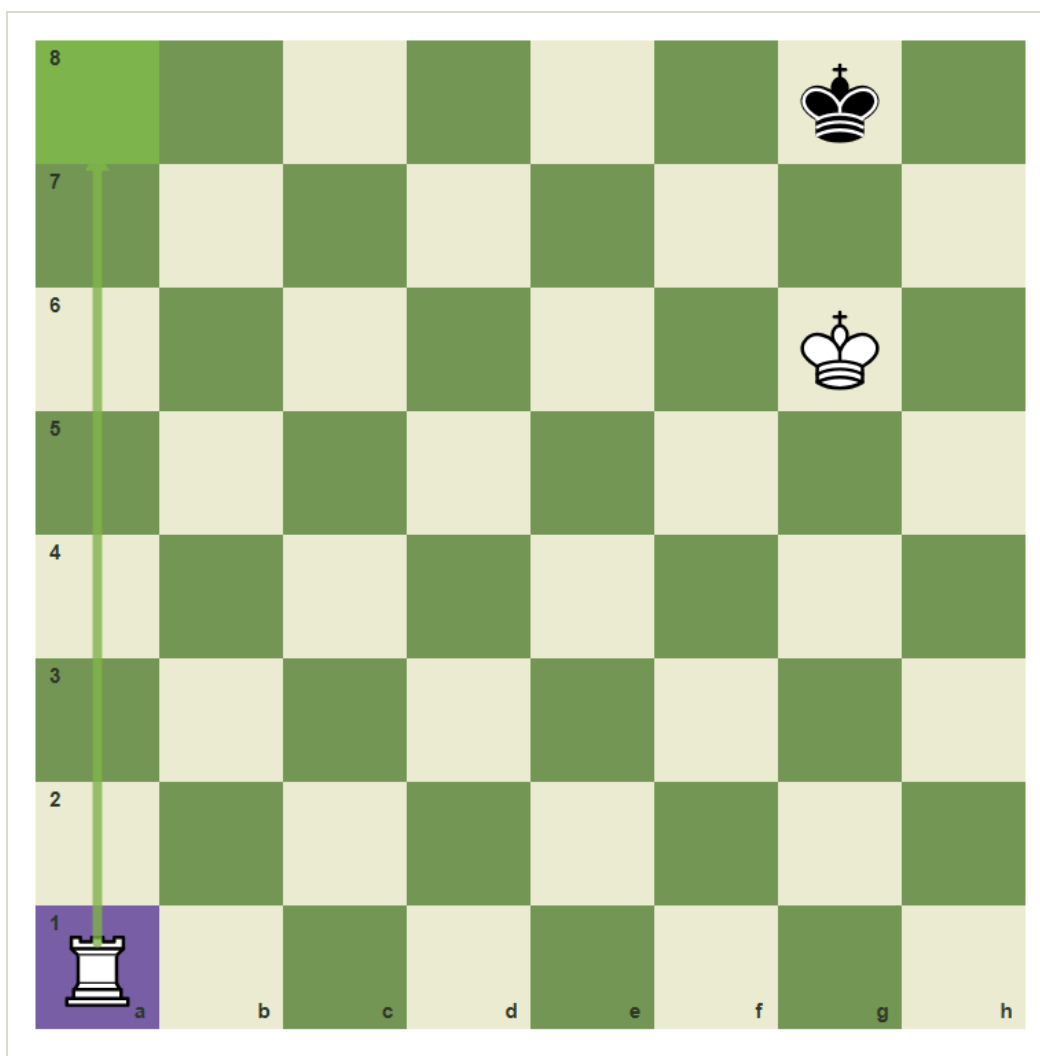
The move b1-c3 develops and defends.

Game moment: castle when ready



Castling is a survival move when the path is clear.

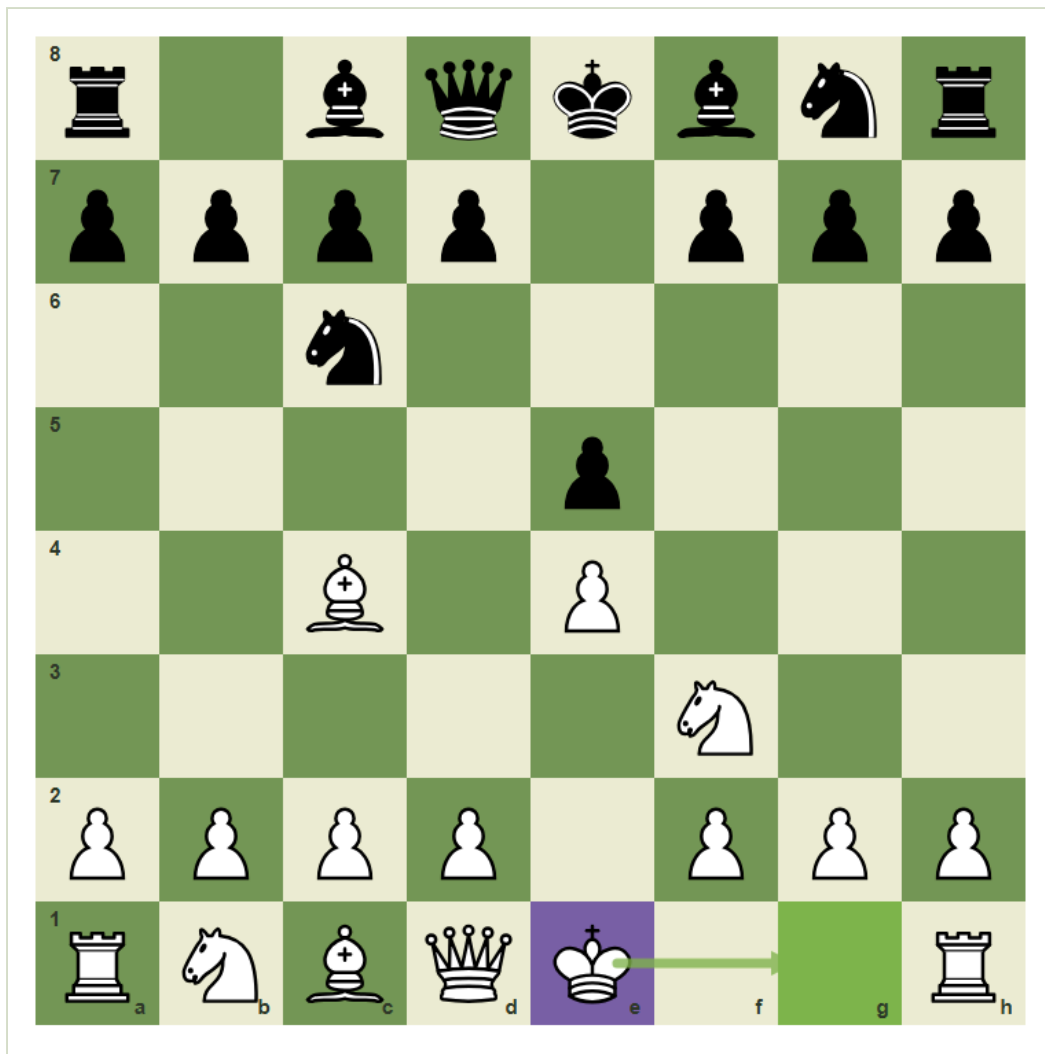
Game moment: finish cleanly



A won rook ending still needs the final mating check.

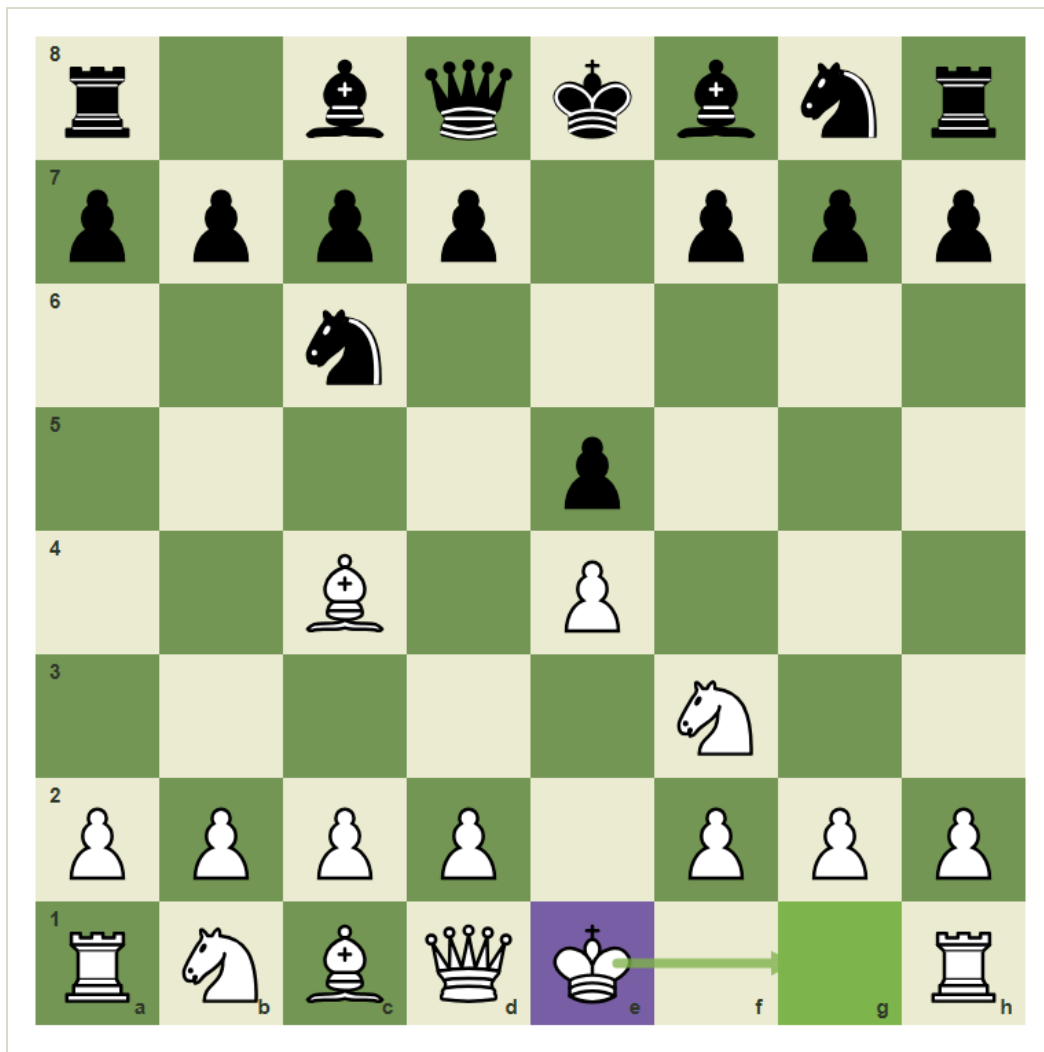
Find the safe game move

The king is ready. Castle from e1 to g1.



Common mistake: skip the survival checklist

In a real game, a safe developing or castling move often beats a pawn grab.



The safe arrow goes from e1 to g1.

Chapter Checkpoint

In mixed positions, start with:

In mixed positions, start with:

- a. Checks, captures, threats
- b. The prettiest move
- c. A random pawn

A safe practical move can be:

A safe practical move can be:

- a. Castling
- b. Hanging the queen
- c. Ignoring check

The goal of Survival Chess is to:

The goal of Survival Chess is to:

- a. Stop beginner losses
- b. Memorize every opening
- c. Avoid all captures forever